

SS1 VISUAL ARTS LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: INTRODUCTION TO VISUAL ARTS I

CONTENT

1. INTRODUCTION

Welcome to **Visual Arts**, one of the most creative and expressive subjects in human learning. Visual Art is not just “drawing pictures” — it is about *seeing, imagining, and creating*. It is the study and practice of how humans **communicate visually**, using **lines, colours, forms, textures, and materials** to express ideas, emotions, culture, and beauty.

From the paintings of **Leonardo da Vinci** to the **terracotta sculptures of Nok culture**, and from **modern graphic design** to **traditional Adire cloth**, Visual Arts help us understand how people live, think, and express themselves.

Visual Arts combine **skill, creativity, and purpose** — making it both an intellectual and practical field.

2. MEANING OF VISUAL ARTS

Simple Definition:

Visual Arts are forms of art that can be seen with the eyes and appreciated through sight.

Comprehensive Definition:

Visual Arts refer to all artistic creations that are **consciously produced by humans** to express ideas, emotions, or skills through **visible forms** such as drawing, painting, sculpture, design, and crafts.

Let's break down the deeper definition:

Concept	Meaning	Example
Consciously Created	The artist intends to make it; it's not an accident.	A potter moulds a clay pot carefully.
Expression of Skill	Technical mastery or craftsmanship.	A painter's steady hand when shading.

Concept	Meaning	Example
Expression of Imagination	Creativity — forming new ideas or perspectives.	A sculptor invents an abstract figure.

Note: Every artwork is a blend of *skill* and *imagination*. Without **skill**, art cannot be executed. Without **imagination**, art lacks originality.

3. VISUAL ARTS AS SKILLFUL USE OF MATERIALS

All visual art involves the creative use of **materials** to make something **useful or meaningful**.

Artist	Material	Product	Purpose
Painter	Paint, canvas	Portrait	Pleasure, communication
Sculptor	Wood, metal, clay	Statue	Decoration, worship
Textile Designer	Fabric, dye	Clothing	Utility and beauty
Potter	Clay	Bowl, vase	Utility and design

4. CLASSIFICATION OF VISUAL ARTS

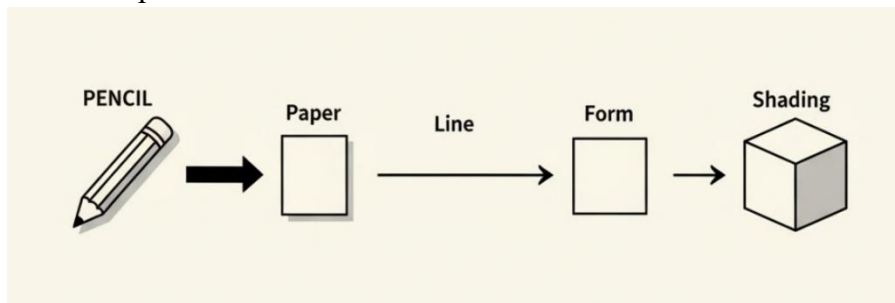
Visual Arts can be broadly divided into two main categories:

A. FINE ARTS (Art for Art's Sake)

Fine Arts exist primarily to **express beauty, ideas, or emotions**. They are appreciated mainly for their **aesthetic** (beauty) and **intellectual** value, not practical use.

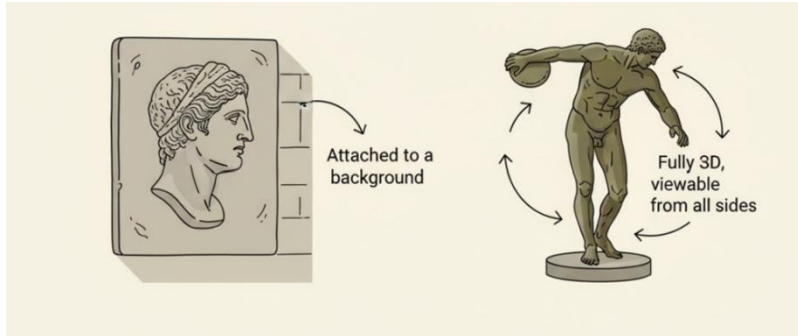
Main Branches of Fine Arts:

1. **Drawing** – The art of representing forms on a two-dimensional surface using lines, tones, or shading.
 - Tools: Pencil, charcoal, ink, pastel, pen.
 - Importance: It is the foundation of all other visual arts.



2. **Painting** – The application of colours on a surface (canvas, wall, paper, wood) to create images that express ideas or emotions.

- Types: Oil painting, Watercolour, Acrylic painting, Fresco.
 - Famous Example: “Mona Lisa” by Leonardo da Vinci.
3. **Sculpture** – The art of forming **three-dimensional (3D)** objects.
- Methods: Carving (wood/stone), Modelling (clay), Casting (metal), Construction (joining materials).
 - Types:
 - **Sculpture in the round:** Viewable from all sides (e.g., human statue).
 - **Relief sculpture:** Raised from a flat background (e.g., coin surface).

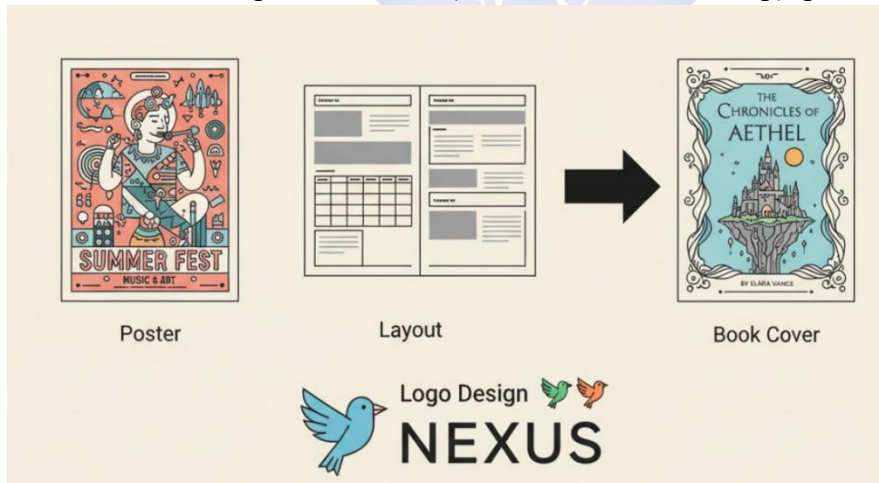


B. APPLIED ARTS (Art for Function's Sake)

Applied Arts combine beauty with **utility**. They serve practical functions but are designed with **aesthetic principles**.

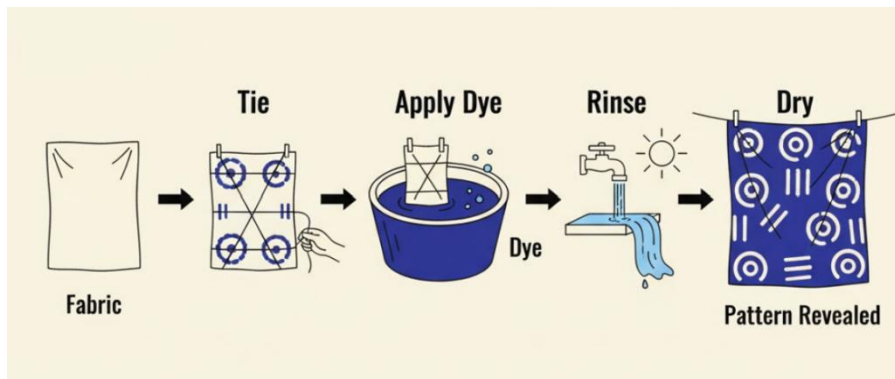
Main Branches of Applied Arts:

1. **Graphic Design** – The art of visual communication using text and images to convey messages effectively.
 - Examples: Logos, billboards, posters, book covers, web design.
 - Tools: Computer software (CorelDRAW, Photoshop), pencils, colours.



2. **Textile Design** – The art of creating decorative and functional designs for fabric production.

- **Methods:**
 - Weaving (interlacing threads)
 - Dyeing (tie-dye, Adire)
 - Printing (block or screen printing)
 - Embroidery (stitching decorative patterns)
- **Nigerian Example:** Yoruba *Adire* (indigo-dyed fabric).



3. **Ceramics** – The art of making and firing clay objects in a kiln.

- Products: Pots, bowls, vases, tiles, cups.
- Process: Moulding → Drying → Firing → Glazing → Re-firing.
- Traditional Example: The *Nok Terracotta* sculptures in Nigeria.

5. **OTHER BRANCHES OF VISUAL ARTS**

In addition to Fine and Applied Arts, modern classification includes:

- **Photography:** Capturing images using light-sensitive media.
 - **Architecture:** Designing buildings that are functional and artistic.
 - **Industrial Design:** Designing everyday products (phones, furniture, tools).
 - **Animation and Digital Art:** Using computers to create moving images or 3D models.
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6. **IMPORTANCE OF VISUAL ARTS**

Visual Arts are not only aesthetic but also essential in modern society. They:

1. Develop **creativity and imagination**.
 2. Preserve **cultural heritage** (e.g., Benin bronzes, Nok sculptures).
 3. Serve as **communication tools** (e.g., posters, logos, signs).
 4. Provide **employment and income** for artists, designers, and craftsmen.
 5. Beautify our environment (e.g., murals, sculpture parks).
 6. Improve **manual dexterity** and **critical thinking**.
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7. KEY NOTES

- Every object designed by humans has artistic value if it is visually and functionally pleasing.
- Drawing is the foundation — every designer, painter, sculptor, or architect begins with sketches.
- Fine Art = Expression and Beauty; Applied Art = Beauty + Function.

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

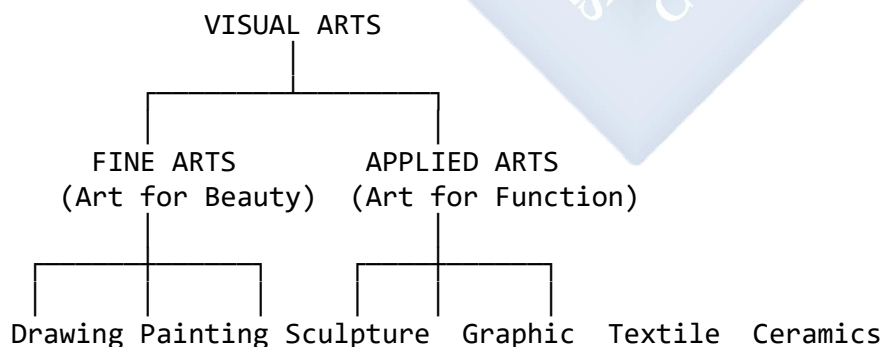
1. Define *Visual Arts* using the concepts of skill and imagination.
2. Mention and explain two major branches of Visual Arts.
3. State three differences between Fine Arts and Applied Arts.
4. List three branches under Fine Arts and three under Applied Arts.
5. Explain why Drawing is called the “foundation of all Visual Arts.”

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Make a two-column chart labeled “**Fine Arts**” and “**Applied Arts.**” Identify **five objects** around your home and classify each.
2. What is the difference between a **sculpture in the round** and a **relief sculpture**?
3. Name **one Nigerian traditional textile art** and describe its process.
4. Identify the **main material used in ceramics** and describe its preparation.
5. Why do we say that “Fine Arts appeal to the mind while Applied Arts appeal to use”?

ILLUSTRATIVE SUMMARY (TEXT DIAGRAMS)

[FIGURE 6: Classification of Visual Arts]



TEACHER’S NOTE / INSTRUCTIONAL GUIDE

- Use real-life examples and locally available materials (e.g., Adire cloth, pots, posters).

- Display images of both *Fine Art* (paintings, sculptures) and *Applied Art* (decorated fabric, logos).
 - Encourage sketching practice: ask students to draw a simple household item (cup, shoe, or spoon).
 - Use classroom charts to show **types of visual arts** and **materials used**.
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WEEK 2: INTRODUCTION TO VISUAL ARTS II (FUNCTIONS OF VISUAL ARTS)

1. INTRODUCTION

Last week, we explored **what Visual Arts are**—the skills, imagination, and creativity that humans use to produce works of beauty and purpose.

This week, we move deeper by asking an important question:

Why do we create art?

Art is not made just for decoration. It is one of the **oldest and most powerful forms of human expression**, helping societies **live, worship, govern, teach, record, and communicate** ideas for thousands of years.

From the **rock paintings of the Nok and San people**, to the **digital art and logos** we see today, art continues to serve practical, emotional, spiritual, and social functions.

2. FUNCTIONS OF VISUAL ARTS

The functions of visual arts can be grouped into **five major categories**:

A. UTILITARIAN (FUNCTIONAL) FUNCTION

Meaning: The term *utilitarian* comes from *utility*, meaning “usefulness.” This refers to artworks that are **created primarily for use**, not just for display.

Concept: Although these objects serve practical purposes, artists design them beautifully to make them **pleasing to the eye** as well as **useful to life**.

Examples:

- **Ceramics:** Pots, cups, bowls, water jars (for cooking and storage).
- **Textiles:** Woven or printed cloth (Adire, Aso-oke, Ankara) used for clothing and ceremonies.
- **Graphic Design:** Posters, calendars, packaging labels, company logos.
- **Architecture & Furniture:** Houses, chairs, tables, carved doors, and stools.

Illustration:

[FUNCTIONAL OBJECTS]

CERAMIC POT (Adire bowl)
Purpose: stores water
Design: curved body
Decoration: motifs

In Nigerian culture, a *calabash* carved and decorated for carrying palm wine is a good example — both **useful** and **beautiful**.

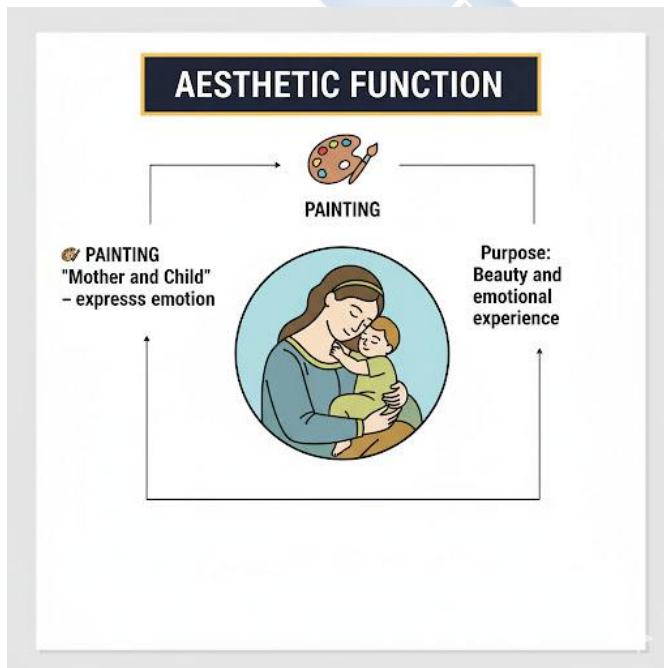
B. AESTHETIC (BEAUTY) FUNCTION

Meaning: The *aesthetic function* refers to art created **for beauty, admiration, or emotional expression**.

Concept: These works do not need to “do” anything practical — their purpose is to be **looked at, felt, and appreciated**. This is the main focus of **Fine Arts** (drawing, painting, sculpture).

Examples:

- Paintings on gallery walls.
- Sculptures in parks or museums.
- Portraits or decorative murals.
- Non-functional ceramics or ornaments.



In Nigerian art, the **Ife bronze head** is a good example of an aesthetic artwork admired for its **perfection and beauty**.

C. RELIGIOUS (SPIRITUAL) FUNCTION

Meaning: Art that is created to **honour or connect with spiritual beings**—gods, ancestors, or divine forces.

Concept: In traditional and modern religions, art is used in **worship, rituals, and ceremonies**, serving as a **bridge between the physical and the spiritual world**.

Examples:

- **Traditional African Art:**
 - Masks (Yoruba *Egungun*, Igbo *Mmanwu*).
 - Shrine sculptures (Benin and Ife heads).
 - Divination trays (*Opon Ifa*).
- **Christian Art:**
 - Stained-glass windows, crucifixes, church murals.
- **Islamic Art:**
 - Calligraphy, geometric patterns, mosque decorations.

In the Benin Kingdom, **bronze plaques** were created to **honour ancestors** and record royal events—merging religion with history.

D. POLITICAL (AUTHORITY) FUNCTION

Meaning: Art used to **show power, authority, or identity** in governance and leadership.

Concept: Throughout history, rulers and governments have used art to **legitimize their authority, celebrate achievements, and promote national unity**.

Examples:

- Royal regalia: Crowns, coral beads, sceptres.
- National symbols: Flags, coats of arms, monuments.
- Propaganda art: Political posters, currency designs.
- Historical reliefs: Benin bronze plaques showing the Oba's court.

The **Benin bronze plaques** (15th–16th century) are political artworks that show the **Oba (king)** surrounded by attendants—demonstrating power and status.

E. EDUCATIONAL (INFORMATIONAL) FUNCTION

Meaning: Art that teaches, explains, or records information for future generations.

Concept: Visual art communicates **ideas more clearly than words**. It is used in education, documentation, and history.

Examples:

- Diagrams and illustrations in textbooks.
- Safety posters and instructional graphics.
- Historical murals or carvings showing past events.
- Currency images depicting national heroes.

Art is therefore a **visual language** — a means of **teaching, reminding, and preserving knowledge**.

3. SUMMARY TABLE OF FUNCTIONS

Function	Meaning	Examples	Purpose
Utilitarian	Useful and functional	Pots, furniture, textiles	For daily use
Aesthetic	For beauty and pleasure	Paintings, sculptures	To please the eye
Religious	For worship or rituals	Masks, idols, stained glass	To connect with the spiritual
Political	For authority and unity	Flags, coats of arms, royal regalia	To show power
Educational	For learning and communication	Posters, diagrams, coins	To inform or teach

4. ASSESSMENT (WEEK 2)

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What does the “utilitarian” function of art mean?
 2. Give two examples of art with a utilitarian function.
 3. The “aesthetic” function of art appeals to our sense of _____.
 4. Give one example each of religious and political functions of art.
 5. A diagram in your science textbook serves which function of art?
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ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Choose one traditional Nigerian artwork (e.g., Nok head, Ife bronze, Benin mask, Adire cloth). In one paragraph, describe its primary function and explain why.
 2. What is the difference between the aesthetic and utilitarian functions? Can an object have both? Give an example.
 3. Find a picture of a national flag or coat of arms. What political messages do its symbols and colours communicate?
 4. How does a mask serve a religious or spiritual function in African culture?
 5. Examine a Naira note. What political and educational functions do the images on it serve?
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5. EXTENSION NOTE (TEACHER'S COMMENTARY)

- Encourage students to bring samples or pictures of **everyday art objects** from their homes.
 - Use **charts, photographs, and artefacts** to show the **interconnection between function and beauty**.
 - Discuss **traditional vs. modern uses** — e.g., how the same function (communication) can appear in both a Benin plaque and a billboard poster.
 - Emphasize that **art is part of life**—we sit on it, wear it, live in it, and communicate through it.
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WEEK 3: VISUAL SENSE

1. INTRODUCTION

Most people *look* at things — but artists *see* them. Seeing like an artist means observing beyond surface appearance — noticing **shapes, tones, colours, reflections, textures, and relationships** between objects. This ability is called **developing the visual sense**.

Visual sense is the foundation of all **drawing, painting, design, and sculpture**, because before you can draw something, you must first learn to **see it truthfully** — not as you *think* it looks, but as it *really* appears.

Artistic Seeing = Observation + Analysis + Interpretation

Developing this skill involves:

- Breaking objects down into **basic forms** (geometry in nature)
- Observing **light, shadow, and colour reflections**
- Recognizing and reproducing **textures (surface qualities)**

2. DYNAMICS OF BASIC SHAPES IN OBJECTS

Concept

Everything around us — from buildings to faces — can be broken down into a few **basic geometric forms**. These are the **visual building blocks** of the visible world. Understanding them helps artists construct accurate drawings and paintings.

The Four Basic 3D Forms

Form	Description	Examples in Real Life	Art Application
Sphere	Round form, equal in all directions. Has light, midtone, and shadow.	Ball, orange, head, sun	Used for heads, fruits, globes
Cube	Box-like form with equal faces and right angles.	Book, house, box, die	Used for buildings, tables, boxes
Cylinder	Has circular top and bottom connected by a curved surface.	Bottle, pipe, tree trunk, arm	Used for limbs, pillars, containers
Cone	Has a circular base that tapers to a point.	Funnel, roof, pencil tip, ice cream cone	Used for roofs, hats, sharp forms

Illustration: Basic Forms and Real Objects

BASIC FORM		REAL OBJECT	
			
			
CUBE	CYLINDER		
CONE			

Tip for Students: When drawing a person, think in *construction lines*:

- The head → sphere
- The torso → cube
- The arms and legs → cylinders
- The nose → small wedge or cone

This technique is called **constructive drawing**, used by professional artists and designers.

3. COLOUR REFLECTIONS AND MIXTURES

Concept

Colour is not a fixed property of an object — it depends on **light**. An object appears coloured because it **reflects certain wavelengths of light** and absorbs others. Artists must learn to see these *reflections, mixtures, and nuances* to make their paintings realistic and alive.

A. Colour Reflections

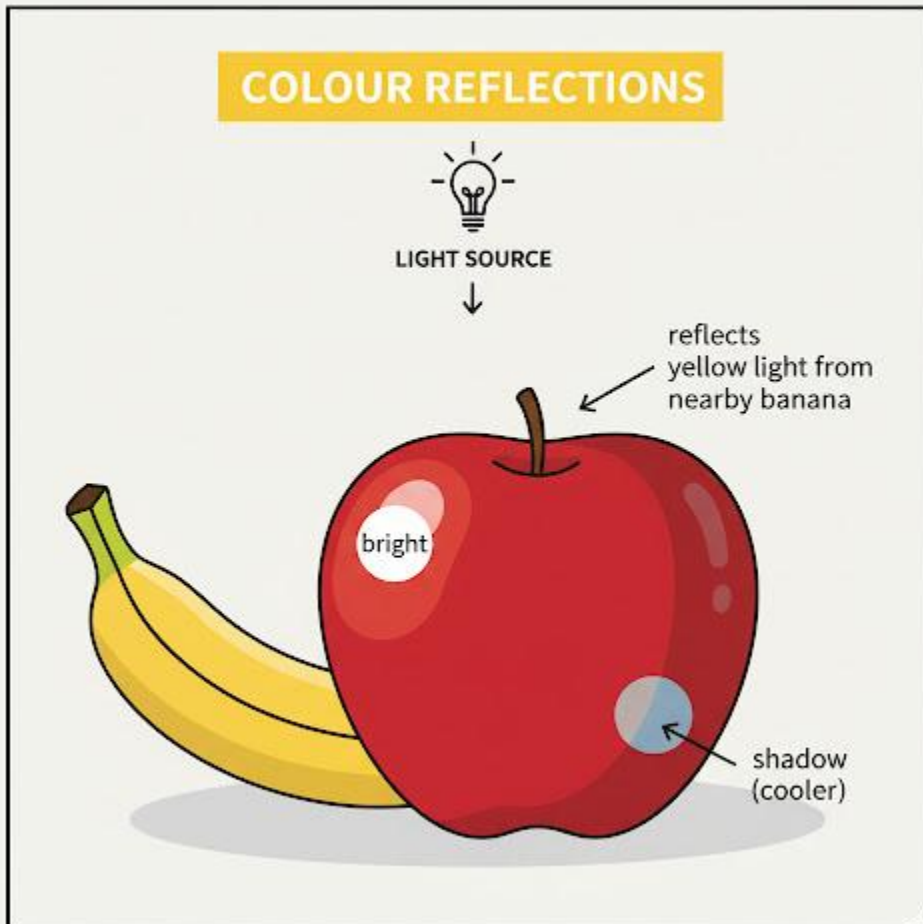
Objects reflect colours from nearby surfaces. This is why no object is ever truly one colour.

Examples:

- A **white teacup** on a **blue table** will have blue reflections underneath.
- A **red apple** beside a **yellow banana** will show a yellow highlight on one side.
- A **metal spoon** reflects surrounding objects like a mirror.

Observation Exercise: Look at any object on your table. What colours can you see in its shadow or highlights? You may find surprising tones like blue, pink, or gold.

Illustration: Colour Reflections



B. Nuances of Colour Mixture

In painting, an artist rarely uses colour straight from the tube. Realistic art requires **subtle mixtures** of colour to show light, midtones, and shadow.

Example: *A green leaf*

- **Highlight:** Yellow-green (where sunlight strikes)
- **Midtone:** True leaf green
- **Shadow:** Blue-green or brown-green (in shadowed areas)

Thus, a “green leaf” may contain **five or more shades of green**, depending on light direction and surrounding reflections.

4. UNIQUENESS OF SURFACE LIKENESS (TEXTURE)

Concept

Texture is the *surface quality* of an object — how it feels (or looks like it would feel). Developing visual sense involves being able to **see** texture and **suggest it** in a drawing.

TYPES OF TEXTURE

Type	Meaning	Examples	Artistic Technique
Tactile (Actual) Texture	The real texture you can touch.	Thick paint (impasto), rough bark, carved wood	Created physically by layering or sculpting
Visual (Implied) Texture	The illusion of texture in a 2D artwork.	Drawing fur, smooth glass, wrinkled fabric	Created with pencil strokes, shading, or patterns

Examples of Visual Texture Techniques:

Texture Type	Drawing Technique
Rough Wood	Use sharp, short, uneven pencil strokes
Smooth Glass	Use smooth, even shading and highlights
Soft Cotton	Use gentle, light hatching or blending
Gravel	Use scattered dots and small angular marks

Illustration:

TEXTURE ILLUSIONS

Rough Wood	////////- -////////
Smooth Glass	Gradual tone shading
Soft Fur	Light, wavy lines
Rough Stone	Dots, scratches, cracks

Artist's Insight: Realism depends on how well you can *see and suggest* textures. Try comparing the feel of a feather, a rock, and a glass cup — then attempt to *draw their differences*, not just their shapes.

5. VISUAL SENSE IN PRACTICE

To develop your visual sense:

1. Observe everything around you carefully.
2. Simplify what you see into **basic forms**.
3. Identify **light source** and **shadows**.

4. Notice **reflected colours**.
5. Reproduce **textures** using pencil or paint.

Over time, you will begin to “see like an artist” — breaking complex scenes into simple, manageable visual information.

6. ASSESSMENT (WEEK 3)

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What are the four basic 3D shapes that make up most objects?
2. A tree trunk or human arm can be simplified into which basic shape?
3. What is “local colour”?
4. Why is a white teacup never just white in a realistic painting?
5. What is the difference between tactile texture and visual texture?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Find three objects in your house (e.g., a tin of milk, a football, a box). Draw only their **basic 3D shapes** (cylinder, sphere, cube).
2. Set up a white egg or teacup under daylight. Observe it carefully — what colours can you see in its shadows and highlights? Describe them.
3. Create a “Texture Page” in your sketchbook:
 - (a) Rough wood
 - (b) Smooth glass
 - (c) Soft cotton wool
 - (d) Sharp gravel *Use pencil techniques to create the illusion of each.*

7. EXTENSION NOTES (FOR TEACHERS AND STUDENTS)

- Encourage observation exercises: students can bring classroom objects and identify their **underlying forms**.
- Use **3D models, geometric solids, or still life setups** for practice.
- Teach **light direction** by shining a torch on simple objects and observing shadows.
- Introduce **texture studies** using real materials — fabric, metal, leaves, stone.
- Reinforce **colour awareness** through paint mixing exercises.

“To draw is to see clearly.” — *Henri Matisse*

WEEK 4: PROFESSIONS AND JOB OPPORTUNITIES IN VISUAL ARTS

INTRODUCTION

Art is not just an act of drawing or painting—it is a **global language of creativity, communication, and innovation**. The visual arts play a vital role in modern economies, media, education, and culture. Every logo, fashion design, advertisement, building interior, and movie poster you see began in the mind of an artist.

Many people wrongly think that art is “just a hobby” or “for fun.” In truth, the **visual arts industry** contributes billions of dollars to global GDP. It is one of the **fastest-growing sectors** in the creative economy, providing diverse, well-paying, and fulfilling careers.

In this lesson, you will discover the **wide range of professions and job opportunities** available to anyone with artistic skill and imagination—from designers and illustrators to animators, curators, and educators.

PROFESSIONS AND JOB OPPORTUNITIES IN VISUAL ARTS

Visual Arts careers can be grouped into four major professional fields:

A. THE COMMUNICATION & MEDIA FIELD (APPLIED ARTS)

This field focuses on using art to **communicate messages visually**. Artists here work with digital tools, print, photography, and moving images to influence what people see, buy, and believe.

1. GRAPHIC DESIGNER

- **Role:** A creative communicator who uses visual elements—text, images, colours, and layout—to communicate messages clearly and attractively.
- **Tools:** Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, CorelDRAW, Canva, or InDesign.
- **Outputs:** Logos, brand identity materials, brochures, billboards, product packaging, magazines, digital ads, and website designs.
- **Illustration Example:** When you see the MTN or Coca-Cola logo, you are seeing a graphic designer’s work.

2. VIDEO EDITOR / MOTION GRAPHICS ARTIST

- **Role:** Edits and assembles video footage, adds sound effects, transitions, and animations for storytelling.
- **Tools:** Adobe Premiere Pro, After Effects, DaVinci Resolve.

- **Examples:** Editing wedding videos, music videos, TV ads, and documentaries; creating animated title sequences.

3. **CARTOONIST / ANIMATOR**

- **Cartoonist:** Creates humorous or storytelling drawings for newspapers, magazines, or comics (e.g., *Garfield*, *Supers Strikas*).
- **Animator:** Brings drawings or 3D models to life using movement (e.g., *Tom and Jerry*, *Lion King*, *Incredibles*).
- **Specializations:** 2D animation, 3D animation, stop-motion animation.
- **Skills Needed:** Drawing, storytelling, digital animation, patience, and timing.

4. **PHOTOGRAPHER**

- **Role:** Captures images to record, document, or beautify moments and objects.
- **Types:**
 - Fashion Photographer (models and clothing)
 - Photojournalist (news events)
 - Product Photographer (advertising)
 - Wedding/Portrait Photographer (personal and ceremonial)
- **Example:** A photographer covering a cultural festival helps document national identity and heritage.

B. THE PRODUCT & MANUFACTURING FIELD (APPLIED ARTS)

This category involves artists who **design and create tangible, functional objects** for daily use—combining utility and beauty.

1. **TEXTILE DESIGNER**

- **Role:** Designs patterns, colours, and textures for fabrics used in clothing and interior décor.
- **Outputs:** Aso-Oke, Adire, Ankara, curtains, upholstery, and embroidery designs.
- **Techniques:** Dyeing, weaving, screen printing, batik, tie and dye.
- **Example:** A textile designer creates the colourful Adire patterns used in traditional Yoruba attire.

2. **CERAMICIST / POTTER**

- **Role:** Works with clay to produce both functional and decorative objects.
- **Products:** Pots, vases, plates, mugs, tiles, and sculptures.
- **Types:**
 - *Studio potter* – creates unique, artistic pieces.
 - *Industrial ceramist* – works in factories producing tiles, cups, and sanitary ware.
- **Illustration:** The water pot (udu) and Benin terracotta heads are classic examples of ceramic artistry.

3. *INDUSTRIAL DESIGNER*

- **Role:** Designs the form and function of manufactured products like furniture, electronics, cars, and packaging.
- **Focus:** Combines engineering with artistic design to make everyday products both useful and beautiful.
- **Example:** The sleek shape of a smartphone or a modern chair was developed by an industrial designer.

4. *FASHION DESIGNER*

- **Role:** Designs clothing, shoes, and accessories to reflect identity, culture, and trend.
- **Example:** Nigerian designers like Deola Sagoe and Mai Atafo blend traditional patterns with modern styles.

C. THE FINE ART & CULTURE FIELD

This field focuses on creating **art for appreciation, exhibition, and cultural preservation** rather than mass production.

1. *PAINTER (FINE ARTIST)*

- **Role:** Creates expressive and aesthetic artworks using paint, charcoal, ink, or mixed media.
- **Venues:** Galleries, art fairs, or private commissions.
- **Styles:** Realism, abstraction, impressionism, or expressionism.
- **Example:** Bruce Onobrakpeya's prints and Ben Enwonwu's sculptures celebrate Nigerian identity and folklore.

2. *SCULPTOR (FINE ARTIST)*

- **Role:** Creates three-dimensional forms using materials like clay, wood, stone, metal, or recycled materials.
- **Example:** Public monuments like the "Unknown Soldier" in Lagos.
- **Note:** Sculptors may also work with architects to decorate buildings and public spaces.

3. *CURATOR / CULTURAL OFFICER*

- **Curator:** Works in museums or galleries, organizes exhibitions, studies collections, and writes about artworks.
- **Cultural Officer:** Works to preserve and promote local and national art and traditions.
- **Example:** An officer at the National Gallery of Art helps promote Nigerian artistic heritage through exhibitions.

D. THE SPECIALIZED & SCIENTIFIC FIELD

Here, artists combine creativity with science and education.

1. MEDICAL ILLUSTRATOR

- **Role:** Creates accurate, detailed drawings of the human body, diseases, and surgical processes.
- **Skills:** Knowledge of biology, anatomy, and digital illustration.
- **Uses:** Medical textbooks, hospital manuals, surgical training.
- **Example:** A medical illustrator might draw an image of the human heart for a biology textbook.

2. INVESTIGATIVE / FORENSIC ILLUSTRATOR

- **Role:** Works with police to produce sketches of suspects based on eyewitness descriptions or reconstruct crime scenes.
- **Skills:** Portrait drawing, observation, and attention to detail.
- **Example:** A forensic artist helps solve crimes by producing sketches that identify missing persons or suspects.

3. ART TEACHER / LECTURER

- **Role:** Educates, trains, and inspires students in schools, colleges, and universities.
- **Importance:** They ensure that artistic skills are passed on and that art continues to grow as a discipline.
- **Example:** An art teacher helps students discover talents that could later become international careers.

ILLUSTRATIVE NOTE:

Every object you use daily — your clothes, books, phone, furniture, and even the currency in your pocket — was designed by someone in the visual arts. Without artists, the world would be colourless, confusing, and unimaginative.

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What does a **Graphic Designer** do?
 2. What is the main difference between a **Cartoonist** and an **Animator**?
 3. A person who works in a museum and organizes exhibitions is called a _____.
 4. Which two fields must a **Medical Illustrator** be an expert in?
 5. Name **three professions** in Visual Arts that are examples of **Applied Arts**.
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ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Choose **one profession** from this lesson that interests you the most. Write a short paragraph describing what a typical day in that career might be like.
2. Look around your home and identify **five items** designed by visual artists (e.g., book cover, fabric pattern, logo, chair, or wall paint). List each and name the kind of artist responsible.

3. Explain the difference between a **Fine Artist** and a **Graphic Designer** in terms of their goals and how they earn income.
 4. Define **Forensic Illustrator** and state who they work for.
 5. Why is an **Art Teacher** or **Lecturer** an essential profession in the visual arts industry?
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WEEK 6: DRAWING LINES

INTRODUCTION

This week, we begin our **first practical exploration** in drawing — the **Line**, the most fundamental building block of all visual art.

A **line** is the simplest yet most powerful element of design. It is to art what letters are to writing — **the alphabet of drawing**. Every great masterpiece, from a child's sketch to the works of Michelangelo or Ben Enwonwu, begins with a single line.

Paul Klee, a famous artist, once said:

“A line is a dot that went for a walk.”

When a pencil moves across paper, it leaves a visible trail — **that path is a line**. It can whisper softly, shout loudly, dance playfully, or stand firmly — depending on how it is drawn.

CONCEPT OF LINES

In art, a **line** is an identifiable path created by a point moving in space. It can vary in width, direction, and length.

A line can:

- **Define a shape or form** (outline of a bottle or face).
- **Create texture** (wood grain, hair, or fabric folds).
- **Express emotion** (calm, anger, speed, or grace).
- **Suggest movement or depth**.

In simple terms:

A line is both a boundary and a bridge — it defines what something is and how it feels.

TYPES OF LINES

Every line has a **direction** and a **character**. The way a line moves affects how we perceive the emotion or energy of the drawing.

Below are the **main types of lines** and their meanings:

1. VERTICAL LINES

Visual Example	Description
	Lines that move straight up and down . They create a sense of height and strength.
Effect: Suggest dignity, stability, and power — like tall trees or buildings.	
Examples: Telephone poles, standing figures, tree trunks.	

2. HORIZONTAL LINES

Visual Example	Description
	Lines that move side to side . They suggest calmness and rest.
Effect: Peace, relaxation, distance.	
Examples: The sea horizon, a person lying down, a table top.	

3. DIAGONAL LINES

Visual Example	Description
	Lines that slant at an angle.
Effect: Action, movement, or tension — they make a drawing dynamic.	
Examples: A falling tree, a staircase, a person running.	

4. WAVY (CURVY) LINES

Visual Example	Description
	Flowing, curved lines that move like waves.
Effect: Grace, beauty, softness, natural movement.	
Examples: Rivers, hills, hair, fabric folds.	

5. ZIG-ZAG LINES

Visual Example	Description
	Sharp, angular lines formed by joining

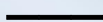
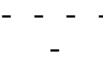
Visual Example	Description
	diagonals.
Effect: Excitement, energy, nervousness, danger.	
Examples: Lightning bolts, cracks, energy patterns.	

6. SPIRAL LINES

Visual Example	Description
	Lines that curve around a central point and wind outward.
Effect: Growth, motion, continuity, or infinity.	
Examples: Snail shells, whirlpools, galaxies, climbing vines.	

QUALITIES OF LINES (LINE WEIGHT)

Not all lines are created equal. The **thickness**, **pressure**, and **texture** of a line affect how the drawing “feels.” Artists call this the “**line weight**” or **line quality**.

Line Type	Illustration	Meaning/Effect
Thick / Heavy Lines		Appear strong, bold, and dominant. Used for outlines or nearby objects.
Thin / Light Lines		Appear delicate or distant. Used for fine details or far objects.
Broken / Sketchy Lines		Suggest texture, shadow, or motion. Common in quick sketches.
Flexible / Tapered Lines		Vary from thick to thin — the most expressive and professional line type.

Illustrative Note: When drawing, think of your pencil as a dancer — sometimes strong, sometimes light, always moving with rhythm and purpose.

LINES AS PATTERNS IN NATURE

Nature is a living gallery of lines. Every form in the natural world — leaves, rivers, clouds, shells — is made of lines that reveal motion, energy, and structure.

Line Type	Found in Nature	Illustration
Vertical	Tree trunks, waterfalls, tall rocks	

Line Type	Found in Nature	Illustration
Horizontal	Calm sea, horizon, grass plains	
Wavy	River flow, sand dunes, hills	
Spiral	Snail shells, galaxies, flower buds	
Zig-Zag	Lightning, mountain peaks, cracks	⚡
Branching	Leaf veins, coral patterns, roots	

Art Note: When drawing from nature, look for the **hidden lines** that structure every object — even a leaf is a network of lines!

VISUAL EXERCISES (CLASS PRACTICE)

Activity 1: Line Observation

- Go outdoors and identify at least 3 types of lines in your environment (tree trunks, electric wires, road markings). Sketch them in your sketchbook.

Activity 2: Line Emotion Chart

- Draw different lines and write the emotion they express beneath them:
 - Zig-zag = Angry ⚡
 - Wavy = Calm
 - Spiral = Curious
 - Horizontal = Peaceful
 - Vertical = Proud

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

- Define “line” in the context of art.
- A line that suggests rest or calm is a _____ line.
- A line that suggests action or instability is a _____ line.
- What is meant by the “**quality**” of a line?
- How can you use **line weight** to show that one object is closer than another?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

- In your sketchbook, create a “**Line Library**.” Draw two-inch boxes and fill each with different types of lines (Vertical, Horizontal, Zig-zag, Spiral, etc.).
- Practice **flexible lines** — draw wavy lines that go from thin to thick and back to thin in one stroke (20 times).

3. Find a **leaf** and draw only its lines (edges and veins). Observe how the line directions form patterns.
4. Write: What kind of emotion or mood does a **zig-zag line** express? What about a **wavy line**?
5. Fold a paper in half. On one side, draw a box using **rigid, uniform lines**; on the other, use **expressive, flexible lines**. Which looks more alive? Why?

SUMMARY NOTE

“Line is the artist’s handwriting.” — Each artist’s line carries emotion, rhythm, and individuality. To master art, you must first master the line — for **all great drawings begin and end with it.**



WEEK 8: DRAWING NATURE AND MAN-MADE OBJECTS

1. INTRODUCTION

Last week, we studied **lines** — the foundation of all art and design. This week, we take a step forward by learning how to **apply lines to observe and draw the real world** — both **natural objects** (trees, leaves, animals) and **man-made objects** (buildings, fences, roads).

Drawing from nature helps you observe **organic patterns, textures, and movement**, while drawing man-made objects helps you understand **structure, geometry, and perspective**.

Think of it like this:

Nature teaches us curves, flow, and softness. Man-made objects teach us angles, order, and construction.

Together, they form the complete language of visual expression.

2. DRAWING WOODLAND (TREES WITHOUT LEAVES)

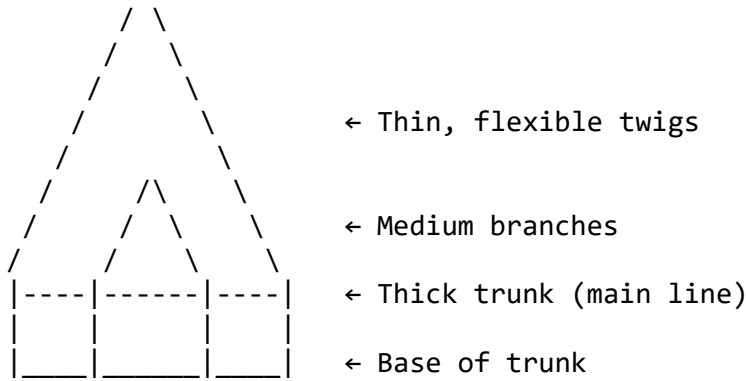
Concept

A **leafless tree** is one of the best exercises in understanding line, structure, and growth patterns. It is like the “skeleton” of nature — made entirely of lines.

How to Observe a Tree

1. **Trunk (Main Axis):** Start from the base — a strong vertical line that anchors the tree to the ground. → *Use thick, firm lines to show strength.*
 2. **Branches:** Notice how each branch **divides** — this is called **branching structure** or **dendritic pattern**. → Branches always get **thinner** as they move away from the trunk.
 3. **Twigs:** The ends of branches are fine, delicate, and slightly curved. → *Use light, thin lines.*
 4. **Texture of Bark:** Bark is not smooth. Represent it with **short, broken, and irregular lines**.
-

Illustration: Structure of a Tree (Without Leaves)



TIP: Notice how every line grows *outward and upward* like a family tree — this pattern is also seen in blood vessels, rivers, and lightning.

3. DRAWING ANIMAL PATTERNS

Animals are perfect for studying **line, shape, and pattern** — especially their **fur, scales, or stripes**. When you draw an animal, don't just copy its outline; **observe how patterns wrap around its form**.

Examples

Zebra Stripes

- The stripes follow the animal's curves, helping to show its **three-dimensional shape**.
- **Vertical on the sides, curved across the back, and circular around the legs.**

Snake Scales

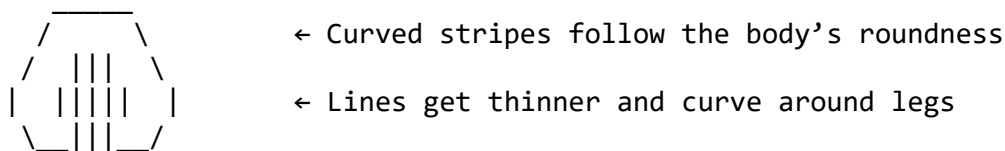
- Repeated **diamond or oval shapes**.
- Lines curve to follow the body, making the snake look round and coiled.

Skeletons

- The skeleton reveals **structure** — bones as lines of strength, joints as points of movement.

Illustration: Zebra Pattern

Zebra Body Outline:



NOTE: The direction and curvature of the stripes help the drawing look 3D — not flat.

4. LINES AND PATTERNS IN MAN-MADE OBJECTS

Man-made objects differ from natural ones because they are **structured, geometric, and symmetrical**. Here, **rulers, compasses, and perspective drawing** come into play.

Concept: Linear Perspective

Linear Perspective is the technique artists use to make drawings appear **three-dimensional (3D)** on a flat surface. It is based on the observation that **parallel lines appear to meet** at a distant point called the **Vanishing Point**.

Key Principles

1. **Horizon Line:** The eye-level of the viewer. → All vanishing points sit on this line.
2. **Vanishing Point (VP):** The point on the horizon where parallel lines meet. → Used in **one-point** or **two-point** perspective drawings.
3. **Converging Lines:** Lines that move toward the vanishing point to create depth.

Examples of Man-Made Objects Using Perspective

Railway Tracks



Observation: The planks (sleepers) appear smaller and closer together the farther they go — this creates the illusion of distance.

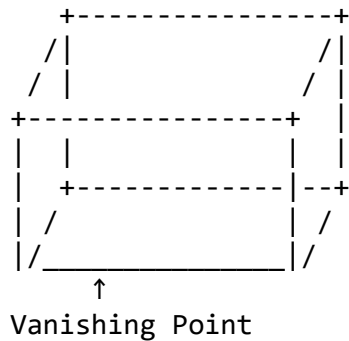
Bridges and Fences

- Use **parallel lines converging** toward the horizon.
- The top and bottom edges of the bridge or fence **taper** toward the vanishing point.

Buildings / Cubes

- In **one-point perspective**, only one face of the building is visible.
 - In **two-point perspective**, both front and side faces are seen, giving a realistic corner view.
-

Illustration: One-Point Perspective (Building or Cube)



Comparison: Natural vs Man-Made Lines

Aspect	Natural Objects	Man-Made Objects
Type of Line	Curved, irregular, flowing	Straight, angular, precise
Tools	Freehand	Ruler, compass, set square
Form	Organic (leaves, trees, rivers)	Geometric (buildings, machines)
Observation Focus	Texture and rhythm	Structure and proportion

5. CLASSROOM PRACTICE & OBSERVATION SKILLS

During class:

- Observe **real-life references** (plants, trees, fences, or building edges).
- Practice **varying your line quality** — thick, thin, curved, and straight.
- Try to draw using both **freehand (for nature)** and **measured lines (for man-made)**.

6. ASSESSMENT (WEEK 8)

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. When drawing a leafless tree, what kind of line quality should be used for the trunk versus the twigs?
2. Why is drawing a zebra's stripes a good exercise? What do the stripes show?
3. What is **Linear Perspective**?
4. What is a **Vanishing Point**?
5. Give two examples of **man-made objects** where linear perspective applies.

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. **Tree Study:** Find a leafless tree or a complex branch. Do a **detailed 30-minute line drawing**, focusing on how lines split, thin, and texture.
2. **Perspective Exercise:** Draw a **railway line** or **straight road** disappearing into the distance. Include horizon and vanishing point.
3. **Cube in Perspective:** Draw a **cube using one-point or two-point perspective** (as demonstrated in class).
4. **Zebra Pattern Study:** Draw a zebra, focusing on **how the stripes curve** around the body and legs.

7. TEACHER'S NOTE / EXTENSION ACTIVITY

Encourage students to:

- Create a **Line Journal**: collect 5–10 sketches of natural and man-made subjects over time.
- Visit nearby structures (school building, fence, gate) to observe perspective in real life.
- Compare a **leaf vein pattern** with a **bridge framework** — they follow the same visual logic: **structure through lines**.

Visual Summary

- ♣ TREE → Organic lines, flowing and varied
 - ZEBRA → Pattern lines, curved on 3D form
 - 🏠 BUILDING → Geometric lines, converging in perspective
 - 🚂 RAILWAY → Parallel lines meeting at vanishing point
-

WEEK 9: DRAWING AND SHADING

1. INTRODUCTION

So far, we have focused on **line drawing** — creating shapes, outlines, and textures using only lines. However, **line drawing** alone appears **flat** and lacks a sense of depth or realism. To make a drawing **three-dimensional (3D)** — that is, to make it look as if it occupies real space — we must use **shading**, also called **tone** or **value**.

Definition:

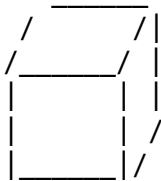
Shading is the use of light and dark tones to show how light falls on an object, making it look solid, rounded, and realistic.

Purpose of Shading:

- To show **form** (3D appearance)
- To show **light direction**
- To create **mood or atmosphere**
- To add **realism and beauty** to a drawing

Illustration 1: Line Drawing vs Shaded Drawing

Without Shading (Flat)



With Shading (3D)



The cube on the right appears solid because the sides have different tones — light, mid-tone, and shadow.

2. EYE AND HAND COORDINATION

Concept

Drawing is not only about talent — it's a **physical and mental coordination skill**. Your **eye** observes details, your **brain** interprets them, and your **hand** executes the motion. The better your coordination, the more accurate and expressive your drawings become.

How to Develop Eye–Hand Coordination

1. Contour Drawing

- **What:** Drawing the outline of an object **without looking at the paper**.
- **Purpose:** It trains your eyes and hands to move together.
- **Activity:** Look at your hand and slowly draw its outline without glancing at your paper.

2. Imitative Drawing

- **What:** Carefully copying what you see in front of you (a still life setup).
- **Purpose:** Trains observation and accuracy.
- **Examples:** Draw a cup, apple, or bottle exactly as seen.

Illustration 2: Eye–Hand Coordination Flow

EYE 👁 → Observes object → BRAIN → Processes image → HAND → Creates marks

The continuous communication between these three components builds artistic control and precision.

3. THE FIVE ELEMENTS OF SHADING (LIGHT AND SHADOW)

Every realistic drawing involves **light** hitting an object from a particular direction. The **way light interacts** with the object produces **five basic tonal regions**.

1. Highlight

- The **brightest area** on the object where light hits directly.
- Usually small and sharp on shiny objects (e.g., glass, metal) or soft on rough ones (e.g., cloth, skin).

2. Mid-tone

- The **natural tone** of the object — not too dark or light.
- Found between the highlight and the shadow.

3. Core Shadow

- The **darkest area on the object itself** (the part farthest from the light).
- Shows depth and weight.

4. Reflected Light

- A **soft, faint light** that bounces off surrounding surfaces back onto the shadow side of the object.
- Adds realism — prevents the object from looking “cut out” from its environment.

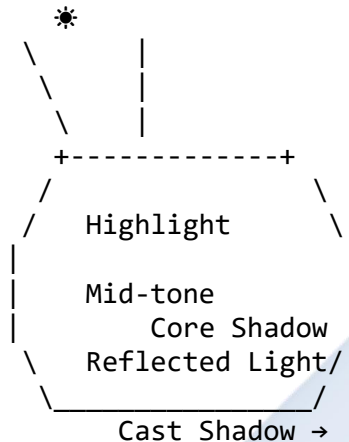
5. Cast Shadow

- The **dark area** created on the surface by the object blocking the light.

- It helps to **anchor** the object to the ground.

Illustration 3: Light and Shadow on a Sphere

(Light Source →)



Notice how the tones shift gradually from light to dark, giving the sphere its 3D roundness.

4. SHADING TECHNIQUES

Shading techniques are the **methods artists use** to represent light and shadow using pencils, pens, or other media.

1. HATCHING

What: Drawing a series of fine, parallel lines. **How:** The closer the lines, the darker the tone.

Use: For simple shadows, sketch illustrations, and to build form.

Illustration 4: Hatching

Light Tone: || || ||
 Medium Tone: ||| ||| |||
 Dark Tone: ||||| ||||| |||||

2. CROSS-HATCHING

What: Overlapping sets of hatched lines in different directions. **How:** Each additional layer adds depth and darkness.

Use: Ideal for achieving strong, rich shadows and texture.

Illustration 5: Cross-Hatching

Light: /////

Medium: /////\\\\\\

Dark: /////\\\\\\|||||

3. POINTILLISM / STIPPLING

What: Creating tone using dots. **How:** Densely packed dots = dark areas; spaced-out dots = light areas. **Use:** For pen drawings or delicate tonal control.

Illustration 6: Stippling

Light:

Medium:

Dark:

4. BLENDING / SMUDGING

What: Creating smooth, soft transitions between tones. **How:** Use a tissue, cloth, finger, or *tortillon* to gently rub pencil marks. **Use:** Best for skin, glass, or any smooth surface.

Illustration 7: Blending

White →  → Black

Note: Do not over-blend. Leave slight texture to preserve realism.

ADDITIONAL TECHNIQUE: SCUMBLING

What: Layering circular, scribbled lines to build tone. **Use:** Excellent for rough textures like stone, hair, or foliage.

5. APPLYING SHADING TO SIMPLE FORMS

Every object can be broken down into **basic geometric solids** — cube, sphere, cylinder, cone. Learning how to shade these forms correctly helps in shading any complex subject.

Shape	Light & Shadow Description	Diagram
Sphere	Smooth gradient from light to dark.	(See Illustration 3 above)
Cube	Distinct light, mid, and dark faces.	
Cylinder	Gradual tone across curved surface.	
Cone	Highlight near the tip; core shadow on opposite side.	

Practice shading each form with a **single light source** (top-left or top-right).

6. ASSESSMENT (WEEK 9)

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is the main purpose of shading in a drawing?
 2. What is the “Core Shadow”?
 3. What is the “Cast Shadow”?
 4. Define “Hatching.”
 5. What is the difference between “Hatching” and “Cross-Hatching”?
-

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. **Value Scale:** Draw a long rectangle divided into **five squares**.
 - 1st square: White (Highlight)
 - 2nd: Light grey
 - 3rd: Mid-tone grey
 - 4th: Dark grey
 - 5th: Black (Core Shadow using Cross-Hatching)

Illustration 8: Value Scale

[□][░][▒][▓][■]

2. **Shading Spheres:** Draw four spheres and shade them as follows:
 - 1st → Hatching
 - 2nd → Cross-Hatching
 - 3rd → Stippling
 - 4th → Blending
 3. **Reflected Light Study:** Explain in your notes: *What is reflected light, and why is it important for realism?*
 4. **Shaded Cube Exercise:** Draw a cube showing:
 - Highlight
 - Mid-tone
 - Core Shadow
 - Reflected Light
 - Cast Shadow
-

7. TEACHER'S NOTES / EXTENSION ACTIVITIES

- Encourage students to **observe real-life objects under light** — e.g., a cup under sunlight — and notice all five tonal regions.
- Use a **lamp** to create controlled shadows for classroom shading practice.
- Have students compare **different techniques** (e.g., Hatching vs. Blending) to understand artistic style.
- Discuss famous shading masters like **Leonardo da Vinci** (*chiaroscuro*) and **Michelangelo**.

Visual Summary

Concept	Visual Cue	Description
Highlight		Brightest spot where light hits
Mid-tone		Normal colour of object
Core Shadow		Darkest part on object
Reflected Light		Faint light bouncing back
Cast Shadow		Shadow cast on surface

Inspiration Quote

“Light reveals form. Shadow gives it life.” — *Leonardo da Vinci*

WEEK 10: DRAWING STILL LIFE OBJECTS

1. INTRODUCTION

A **Still Life Drawing** is the study of inanimate (non-living, non-moving) objects such as fruits, bottles, vases, books, shoes, cups, or boxes arranged in an interesting way. It is a foundational art exercise that trains the artist to **observe, compose, and shade** realistically.

In still life, artists explore:

- **Form (Shape and Volume)** – How objects occupy space.
- **Light and Shadow** – How light affects surfaces and textures.
- **Composition** – How objects are arranged in harmony.

Analogy: Think of still life as a *portrait of objects*. Instead of drawing people, you are drawing “quiet” objects that tell a story through their arrangement, light, and tone.

2. COMPOSITION OF INANIMATE OBJECTS

Meaning of Composition

Composition is the **artistic arrangement** of objects within the drawing space. It is how the artist organizes forms to create balance, focus, and visual interest. A strong composition captures the viewer’s eye and leads it smoothly around the artwork.

RULES OF GOOD COMPOSITION

1. Overlap

Objects should not merely touch at the edges (“kissing”). Instead, let one object sit slightly in front of another. This **creates depth** and helps the viewer understand which object is closer.

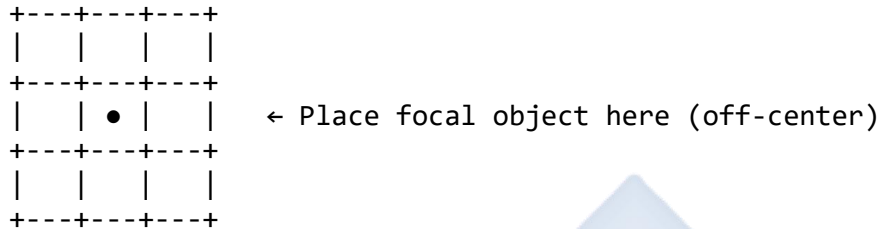
Visual Suggestion: Show three objects:

- One cup slightly in front of an apple.
 - The apple partly covering a bottle. This overlapping gives the illusion of **space**.
-

2. Rule of Thirds

Divide your paper into a 3x3 grid (like a tic-tac-toe or Ludo board). Place your **main object (focal point)** where the lines cross — not directly in the center. This creates a **dynamic composition** that feels natural and balanced.

Visual Diagram:



3. Balance

Avoid clustering all large or dark objects on one side of the page. Balance **large and small, dark and light, tall and short** objects across your setup.

Tip:

- Place a tall bottle on one side.
- Balance it with two smaller, lighter objects on the other side. This is called **asymmetrical balance** — different shapes, equal visual weight.

COMPOSITIONAL NOTES

- Use **triangular composition** — objects arranged to form an invisible triangle often look more stable and elegant.
- Leave **breathing space** around the objects (avoid crowding the edges of the page).
- Decide your **light direction** before starting to shade.

3. PERSPECTIVE IN OBJECT DRAWING

Drawing What You See — Not What You Know

In art, you must learn to **see like an artist**. You don't draw the "idea" of a bottle or box; you draw the *angles, shapes, and tones* as they appear from your viewpoint.

Understanding Ellipses

When a **circle** (like the top of a bottle or cup) is viewed from an angle, it appears **flattened**. This is called an **ellipse**.

Illustration: Show a top view (perfect circle) and a side view (flattened oval).

Practice Tip: Always ensure both sides of an ellipse are symmetrical — not too flat or too round.

Placement and Depth

- Objects **closer** appear **larger and lower** on the page.
- Objects **farther away** appear **smaller and higher** on the page. This helps create **depth and perspective**.

Visual Guide: Show three boxes:

- Large box at the bottom (closest),
- Medium box in the middle,
- Small box near the top (farthest).

Perspective Lines

In still life with man-made objects (cups, boxes, bottles), use **one-point perspective** for accuracy.

Definition: **One-point perspective** – all parallel lines recede toward a single **vanishing point** on the horizon.

Diagram Suggestion: A cube drawn with its edges meeting at one vanishing point.

4. TEXTURE AND TONE IN STILL LIFE DRAWING

Understanding Texture

Texture refers to the **surface quality** of an object — how it feels or looks like it would feel.

When shading, vary your technique to suggest texture:

Type of Object	Surface Quality	Best Shading Technique	Visual Note
Apple, Orange, Tomato	Smooth / Shiny	Blending + Highlights	Smooth transitions of light
Wood, Rock, Bark	Rough / Matte	Hatching or Cross-Hatching	Keep visible pencil strokes
Bottle, Glass	Transparent / Reflective	Blending + Strong Contrast	Bright highlights, deep shadows
Metal Cup	Shiny	High Contrast Blending	White reflection areas

Type of Object	Surface Quality	Best Shading Technique	Visual Note
Cloth, Fabric	Soft / Folded	Gentle Cross-Hatching	Soft transitions, curved strokes

Tonal Values in Still Life

Remember the **Five Elements of Shading** (from Week 9):

1. **Highlight** – Brightest area.
2. **Mid-tone** – Average tone.
3. **Core Shadow** – Darkest area on the object.
4. **Reflected Light** – Light bouncing from nearby surfaces.
5. **Cast Shadow** – Shadow on the surface below.

Suggested Diagram: Show a shaded **sphere** with all five tones labeled.

Lighting in Still Life

- Use **one main light source** (lamp or window).
- Observe where the **light hits** and where the **shadow falls**.
- The **cast shadow** should always follow the direction of the light source.

Tip: Strong directional light gives the best shadows and makes your drawing more realistic.

5. STEP-BY-STEP STILL LIFE PRACTICE

Stage 1: Setup

Arrange 3–4 objects (a bottle, a fruit, a box, and a cup) under a light source.

Stage 2: Sketch

- Lightly block in basic shapes (cylinder, cube, sphere).
- Use the rule of thirds to plan composition.
- Check proportions carefully.

Stage 3: Contour Drawing

- Draw outlines smoothly with varied line weights (thick near, thin far).
- Add ellipses correctly.

Stage 4: Shading

- Identify your light source.

- Build tone gradually using **Hatching, Cross-Hatching, or Blending**.
 - Deepen the darkest shadows last.
-

6. ASSESSMENT (WEEK 10)

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is a “Still Life” drawing?
 2. What is “Composition” in art?
 3. Explain the “Rule of Thirds.”
 4. What is an “Ellipse,” and when do we draw one?
 5. What shading technique is best for smooth surfaces like an apple?
-

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. **Create a Mini Still Life Setup**
 - Arrange one **bottle (cylinder)**, one **box (cube)**, and one **fruit (sphere)** on a table under a single light source.
 - Ensure objects **overlap** slightly.
2. **Draw the Arrangement**
 - Start with light construction lines.
 - Show correct **ellipses** and **perspective**.
 - Add **shading** to reveal form and texture.
 - Indicate all five tonal values clearly.
3. **Label Your Drawing**
 - Identify: Light Source, Highlight, Core Shadow, Cast Shadow, and Reflected Light.

Optional Classroom Visual: Show side-by-side examples:

- (A) Flat Line Drawing
 - (B) Shaded Still Life with Volume and Light
-

TEACHER’S NOTE / CLASSROOM ACTIVITY

- Conduct a “**Still Life Corner**” **setup** in class: a lamp, bottle, fruit, and cup on a draped cloth.
 - Let students sit at different angles to understand how **viewpoint** changes perspective.
 - Discuss and compare results after the exercise.
-

WEEK 11: DRAWING THE HUMAN FIGURE

1. INTRODUCTION

Drawing the **human figure** — also called **life drawing** — is the most essential and challenging form of artistic study. Every artist, from beginner to professional, studies the human body because it contains **rhythm, proportion, and emotion**.

The figure is the foundation of painting, sculpture, animation, and even fashion illustration. It helps the artist understand:

- **Form:** The three-dimensional structure of the body.
- **Proportion:** The size relationship between parts.
- **Movement:** How the body bends, twists, and balances.
- **Tone and Volume:** How light defines form.

Analogy: Just as a musician practices scales before a concert, artists practice drawing the human form to build skill, speed, and observation.

NOTE TO STUDENTS

When drawing people, don't aim to make a “perfect” person. Instead, focus on **seeing correctly** — how the head, torso, and limbs connect and move together.

2. LIFE DRAWING COMPOSITION

A. Gesture Drawing (Capturing Movement)

Gesture drawing is a **quick sketch** (usually 30 seconds to 2 minutes) that captures the **action, posture, and rhythm** of the pose. It is the *skeleton* or *heartbeat* of a figure drawing.

How to Do It:

1. Use long, sweeping lines — not short, scratchy ones.
2. Ignore details like fingers or facial features.
3. Focus on the overall **flow of movement** — where the weight is, and how the body leans or twists.
4. Think of the **spine** as your main rhythm line.

Suggested Visual: Show 3 small gesture drawings (a person standing, sitting, and bending). Use curved, flowing lines.

Tip: Imagine you are drawing the *energy* of the body, not the body itself.

B. Placement and Framing

When you draw the human figure:

- Keep the **whole body** within the paper space — avoid cutting off the head or feet.
- Leave margins for balance.
- Position the figure slightly **off-center** for dynamic composition (Rule of Thirds).

Helpful Practice: Before shading, lightly draw a rectangle (the “frame”) and plan where the head and feet will fall inside it.

3. PROPORTION — THE KEY TO REALISM

Concept of Proportion

Proportion is the size relationship between one part of the body and another. If one part is too long or short, the figure will look unnatural.

Artists use “**head units**” as a measuring system — the head becomes the basic unit of measurement for the body.

A. The Ideal Human Proportion (“Canon of 8 Heads”)

This classical proportion system, used since the Renaissance, divides the human figure into **eight equal parts** (each part equal to one head length).

Head Count	Landmark	Description / Reference Point
0	Top of Head	Start point
1	Chin	End of the head
2	Nipples / Shoulders	Upper chest line
3	Navel / Elbows	Mid-torso
4	Crotch	Halfway point of the body
5	Mid-Thigh / Fingertips	Hand reaches to mid-thigh
6	Knees	Lower legs begin
7	Mid-Calf	Calf muscle area
8	Feet	Bottom of the body

Illustration Suggestion: A front-view line diagram showing an 8-head-tall standing figure with horizontal lines dividing each “head unit” and labels on each level.

B. Additional Proportional Guides

- **Arm Span (Wingspan)** = same as total height.
- **Elbows** = level with the navel.
- **Hands** = reach mid-thigh.
- **Shoulder width** = about 3 head-widths for men, 2½ for women.
- **Legs** = about half the total height.

Note for Artists: Children's proportions differ — younger children are about **5 heads tall**, teenagers about **6–7 heads**.

C. Simplifying the Human Form

Before adding muscles and detail, block the body into **basic geometric shapes**:

Body Part	Simple Form
Head	Sphere or Oval
Neck	Cylinder
Torso	Box or Barrel
Arms & Legs	Cylinders
Hands & Feet	Simplified shapes (wedges, blocks)

Illustration: A “Mannequin Figure” made of simple shapes — spheres and cylinders joined by lines.

4. TONALITY — SHADING THE HUMAN FORM

Concept

The human body is made up of soft, rounded forms. Shading helps these forms look **solid, natural, and 3D**. Without tone, the figure looks flat — with tone, it comes to life.

A. Thinking in Forms

Break the body into simple 3D forms:

- **Head** → Sphere
- **Neck** → Cylinder
- **Torso** → Box or Barrel
- **Arms and Legs** → Cylinders
- **Hands and Feet** → Blocks or Cones

Shade each form as you did in Week 9:

1. Highlight
2. Mid-tone
3. Core Shadow
4. Reflected Light
5. Cast Shadow

Illustration: Show a cylinder shaded from light to dark, labeled with light source and shadow.

B. Shading Techniques for Skin

- **Blending (Smudging):** Use for smooth, soft skin tones. Use tissue or a blending stump.
- **Hatching / Cross-Hatching:** Use to follow the **direction of the muscles** — curves around arms, legs, and torso.
- **High Contrast:** Leave white highlights on the skin where the light hits directly.

Pro Tip: Shade **with the form**, not across it. If you're shading an arm, curve your pencil strokes around it — never in straight lines.

C. Common Mistakes to Avoid

✗ Outlines too dark — use soft edges where light meets shadow. ✗ Uniform shading — remember transitions! ✗ Forgetting reflected light — this makes the drawing look flat.

5. STUDYING HANDS AND GESTURES

Hands express **emotion and movement**. They are mini-figures themselves — complex but beautiful.

Observation Practice:

- Draw your own hand from life.
- Look for large shapes first: palm (rectangle), thumb (cone), fingers (cylinders).
- Add joints and curves later.

Illustration Suggestion: Three sketches of a hand: open, fist, pointing.

Tip: Simplify. Don't draw every wrinkle — capture structure and direction first.

6. ASSESSMENT (WEEK 11)

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is *gesture drawing*?
 2. Define *proportion* in figure drawing.
 3. According to the “ideal” canon, how many heads tall is an adult?
 4. What body landmark is halfway down the figure?
 5. Which shading technique is best for showing soft skin?
-

PRACTICAL ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. **Proportion Study**
 - Draw a standing figure **8 heads tall**.
 - Label all major proportional lines: Chin, Nipples, Navel, Crotch, Knees, Feet.
 2. **Gesture Drawing**
 - Ask a family member to hold a pose for **1 minute**.
 - Make **3–5 fast sketches** showing action, not details.
 3. **Hand Drawing Practice**
 - Draw your hand in three poses (relaxed, fist, pointing). Focus on form and proportion.
 4. **Mannequin Study**
 - Create a “stick-and-shape” figure using ovals, boxes, and cylinders to show posture.
 5. **Shading Comparison**
 - Shade a **wooden box** and a **human arm** side by side.
 - Explain (in writing) how their forms and shading differ.
-

7. TEACHER’S NOTES / CLASS ACTIVITY

- Set up a **simple life drawing session** using a volunteer model (a seated or standing pose).
 - Demonstrate the **8-head proportion guide** on the board.
 - Have students practice gesture drawings before full-body sketches.
 - Encourage peer review: let students discuss what looks “balanced” or “off” in proportions.
-

SUMMARY CHART

Concept	Focus	Practice Exercise
Gesture Drawing	Movement and Flow	5 quick poses

Concept	Focus	Practice Exercise
Proportion	Measurement and Balance	8-Head Figure
Tonality	Light and Volume	Shaded Torso
Simplified Forms	Structure	Mannequin Figure
Observation	Accuracy	Drawing Hands

SUGGESTED CLASSROOM VISUALS

1. **The 8-Head Proportion Chart** (Labeled front-view diagram).
 2. **Mannequin Figure Drawing** (Cylinders and boxes for body parts).
 3. **Gesture Drawing Examples** (Loose, quick sketches).
 4. **Shading Diagram** (Light source on sphere/cylinder).
 5. **Hand Study** (Different poses showing proportion and tone).
-



WEEK 12: INTRODUCTION TO ART APPRECIATION

1. INTRODUCTION

So far, we have focused on **how to create art** — by drawing, shading, and composing. This week, we shift our attention to **understanding and evaluating** art. This process is called **Art Appreciation**.

Art Appreciation means **seeing beyond the surface** of an artwork — not just saying “*It is beautiful*” — but being able to explain **why** it is beautiful, **how** it was made, and **what it means**.

It involves three key skills:

- **Observation:** Looking carefully and noticing details.
- **Interpretation:** Understanding what the artist is trying to say.
- **Judgment:** Evaluating how successful the artist was in achieving their aim.

In art appreciation, you learn to “see with the mind, not just the eyes.”

2. ANALYSIS AND EVALUATION OF WORKS OF ART

When appreciating art, we use a **systematic method**. We analyze using two sets of tools:

Ingredients	Principles (Recipe)
Elements of Design	Principles of Design
What the artist uses	What the artist does with those elements

This process helps us understand both the **visual language** and the **emotional message** of a work of art.

For example, an artist may use the Element of Line (bold zigzags) and apply the Principle of Contrast (thick vs thin) to express energy or conflict.

3. ELEMENTS OF DESIGN (THE INGREDIENTS)

The **Elements of Design** are the *building blocks* of any visual artwork.

Element	Meaning	Illustration / Example
1. LINE	The path of a moving point; it can show direction, movement, or emotion.	Straight, curved, broken, thick, thin lines.

Element	Meaning	Illustration / Example
2. SHAPE	A flat, enclosed area — 2D.	Circle, square, triangle.
3. FORM	A 3D object with depth, width, and height.	Cube, cylinder, cone, sphere.
4. COLOUR	Produced by light; it has Hue (name), Value (lightness/darkness), and Intensity (brightness).	Red, blue, yellow. Warm and cool colours.
5. TEXTURE	The surface feel — rough, smooth, soft, hard (real or implied).	Tree bark (rough), glass (smooth).
6. VALUE (TONE)	The degree of light or darkness in a colour.	Gradient from white to black.
7. SPACE	The area around or within objects.	Positive and negative space.

The Elements are like words — each carries a meaning that, when combined, creates visual sentences.

4. PRINCIPLES OF DESIGN (THE RECIPE)

The **Principles** are the *rules* artists follow to organize the Elements effectively. They create order, unity, and interest in an artwork.

Principle	Explanation	Visual Idea / Example
1. BALANCE	The visual weight of elements. - <i>Symmetrical</i> : same on both sides. - <i>Asymmetrical</i> : different, but visually balanced.	
2. CONTRAST	Using opposites (light/dark, rough/smooth) to create emphasis.	A black shape on a white background.
3. EMPHASIS (FOCAL POINT)	The area that draws attention first.	A red flower among green leaves.
4. MOVEMENT	The path your eyes follow around the composition.	Curving lines that lead the viewer's gaze.
5. PATTERN / REPETITION	Regular recurrence of shapes, lines, or colours.	Textile motifs or wallpapers.
6. RHYTHM	Repetition that creates a visual beat or flow.	Wavy or alternating lines.
7. UNITY / HARMONY	When all parts feel connected and consistent.	Balanced colours, proportionate forms.

Good art feels “complete” — this is the effect of Unity.

5. COMPOSITION AND HARMONY

a. Composition

Composition means **the arrangement of all visual elements** in a work of art. A good composition:

- Guides the viewer's eye.
- Balances objects and spaces.
- Emphasizes the focal point.
- Creates visual harmony.

Example: In a painting of a woman sitting by a window:

- The figure (Form) is central.
- The light from the window creates Contrast.
- The soft curves of the chair and figure create Rhythm.

b. Harmony (Unity)

Harmony happens when all parts — colour, form, texture, space — *fit together naturally*. There should be no element that looks out of place or distracting.

c. Significance of Pictorial Elements

Artworks often use **symbolic imagery**:

- A **skull** = death or mortality
- A **dove** = peace
- A **broken chain** = freedom
- A **rising sun** = new hope

Artists often “speak” using visual metaphors, not words.

6. ART TERMINOLOGIES (ESSENTIAL VOCABULARY)

Term	Meaning / Description	Illustration or Example
Appliqué	Sewing or attaching small fabric pieces onto a larger cloth to form designs.	African textile art.
Balance	Even distribution of visual weight.	Symmetry in a mask.
Bas-Relief (Low Relief)	Sculpture slightly raised from a flat background (e.g., coins, Benin plaques).	
Calligraphy	The art of beautiful writing.	Arabic or Chinese scripts.
Cartoon	(1) A humorous drawing. (2) A full-size sketch for murals or tapestries.	Leonardo da Vinci's “ <i>Cartoon for St. Anne.</i> ”

Term	Meaning / Description	Illustration or Example
Motif	A single design unit repeated to form a pattern.	
Silhouette	A dark outline or shadow of a subject against light.	Profile of a person at sunset.
Cire Perdue (Lost Wax)	An ancient method of bronze casting. Used in Ife and Benin bronzes.	

THE “CIRE PERDUE” (LOST WAX) METHOD – STAGES

1. **Make a Clay Core** – shaped like the final sculpture.
2. **Cover with Wax** – details are carved in the wax.
3. **Coat with Outer Clay Shell** – reinforced with pins.
4. **Heat** – the wax melts and drains away (hence “lost”).
5. **Pour in Molten Bronze** – fills the empty cavity.
6. **Cool and Break the Shell** – revealing the solid bronze figure.

This process produced the famous Ife and Benin Bronze Heads, admired worldwide for their craftsmanship.

7. ASSESSMENT (WEEK 12)

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is the difference between an **Element of Design** and a **Principle of Design**?
2. List **three Elements of Design**.
3. List **three Principles of Design**.
4. What is **Asymmetrical Balance**?
5. What is a **Motif**?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Define **Cire Perdue (Lost Wax)** and name **one African culture** that used it.
2. What is a **Bas-Relief** sculpture? Give an example.
3. Find a painting (online or in a textbook). Write 3–4 sentences describing:
 - (a) The **main focal point (Emphasis)**.
 - (b) One **Element of Design** used.
 - (c) One **Principle of Design** applied.
4. Explain the difference between a **cartoon** (historical meaning) and a **caricature**.
5. Why is **Unity/Harmony** considered the ultimate goal of a composition?

TEACHER'S NOTE / ILLUSTRATION GUIDES

- Bring reproductions or prints of artworks (e.g., Ife Bronze Head, Van Gogh's *Starry Night*, or Nok terracotta).
 - Use charts showing the **Elements and Principles**.
 - Encourage students to describe what they *see*, not what they *think* it "should be."
 - Display the **Lost Wax Casting** diagram during class discussion.
-



SS1 VISUAL ARTS LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: INTRODUCTION TO GRAPHICS I

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to the exciting world of **Graphic Design**, a creative discipline within **Visual Art** focused on **visual communication** — that is, communicating ideas and emotions through images, text, and design elements.

The word "**graphics**" originates from the Greek *graphikos*, meaning *to write or draw*. In Technical Drawing and Visual Communication, graphics involve using lines, shapes, symbols, and text to **convey messages accurately and attractively**.

This week, we begin with one of the most fundamental skills in graphic art: **Lettering**.

Lettering is not ordinary handwriting; it is **the art of constructing letters with precision, proportion, and artistic balance**. Every line, curve, and angle must be intentional. It is the foundation of all visual presentation in design, signage, engineering drawings, and advertising.

TYPES OF LETTERING

Lettering styles are classified into two major categories:

1. BLOCK LETTERING (SANS-SERIF)

Meaning

Block lettering is a style of lettering where all strokes are **uniform in thickness** and the letters have **no decorative endings (serifs)**. They are *geometric, strong, and clear* — perfect for **visibility** and **legibility** at a distance.

Characteristics

- Constructed from **straight lines and geometric shapes** (rectangles, circles, squares).
- All strokes have **equal thickness**.
- Letters are **upright** or sometimes **slightly inclined**.
- Clear and easy to read from far away.
- Commonly used in **technical drawings, road signs, labels, and logos**.

Construction Steps

1. Draw **guidelines**: top line, base line, and middle line (for lowercase or proportions).

2. Mark **equal spacing** for each letter.
3. **Sketch outlines** of letters using light lines.
4. **Thicken strokes** evenly.
5. **Clean up** with an eraser, leaving bold, balanced forms.

Illustration: Structure of Block Lettering

Top Line	_____
	A B C D E F
Middle	_____
Base Line	_____

Tip: Use pencils like HB or H for outlines and 2B for shading or thick strokes.
Maintain equal letter height.

Examples of Block Lettering Styles

- **Gothic / Sans-serif (Plain block letters)**
- **Roman (with slight serif hints)**
- **Italic block (slightly slanted right)**

2. CALLIGRAPHIC LETTERING (CALLIGRAPHY)

Meaning

Calligraphy derives from Greek *kallos* (beauty) and *graphein* (to write). It literally means “**beautiful writing**.” It is an *expressive, rhythmic art form* that emphasizes flow, elegance, and variation in stroke width.

Characteristics

- Strokes vary in thickness:
 - **Downstrokes** → thick
 - **Upstrokes** → thin
- Curved and flowing with decorative elements (often includes **serifs**).
- Letters connect gracefully, resembling handwritten scripts.
- Common in **invitations, certificates, decorative headings, and artistic titles**.

Tools

- **Broad-nibbed pens**
- **Flat brushes**
- **Calligraphy markers**
- **Quill pens or digital stylus pens**

The pen is held at a fixed **angle (usually 45°)** to achieve thick and thin strokes.

Illustration: Calligraphy Stroke Direction

↓ = Thick downstroke

↑ = Thin upstroke

Example: letter "a"

↓ curve thin ↑

↓ close loop

Style Variations

- **Italic Calligraphy**
- **Gothic (Blackletter)**
- **Roman Script**
- **Copperplate**

LETTERING ANATOMY AND SPACING

Understanding letter structure helps in consistent design and proportion.

Key Parts of Letters

Term	Definition	Examples
Ascender	The part of a lowercase letter that rises above the x-height.	b, d, f, h, k, l, t
Descender	The part of a lowercase letter that drops below the baseline.	g, j, p, q, y
Loop (Counter)	The enclosed or partially enclosed space inside a letter.	O, P, B, g
Curve	The smooth, rounded parts of a letter.	S, C, O, J
Serif	The short decorative stroke at the end of a main stroke (absent in block letters).	e.g., T, E, L in Roman fonts
Stem	The main vertical stroke.	l, T, D
Crossbar	The horizontal stroke across a letter.	A, H, e

Illustration: Letter Anatomy

Ascender Line _____
h
X-height Line _____
a
Baseline _____
p
Descender Line _____

SPACING AND ALIGNMENT

Good lettering is not only about the shape of letters but also **how they are spaced and aligned**.

- **Kerning:** Adjusting space between *individual* letters for balance.
- **Tracking:** Adjusting the *overall* spacing between groups of letters.
- **Leading:** Vertical spacing between lines of text.

Proper spacing ensures *visual harmony* and *legibility*.

Illustration: Kerning Example

Bad spacing: V A

Good spacing: V A

SKILL AND CRAFTSMANSHIP

Lettering is both **an art and a discipline** requiring patience, observation, and precision.

Essential Qualities

- **Patience:** Every stroke must be deliberate and controlled.
- **Precision:** Maintain uniform height, width, and line weight.
- **Consistency:** Keep angles, proportions, and alignments uniform.
- **Cleanliness:** Avoid smudges or uneven edges.
- **Practice:** Repetition sharpens your control and muscle memory.

Always start with **light pencil outlines** before darkening your final strokes.

USES OF LETTERING IN GRAPHIC DESIGN

Lettering is essential in:

- **Technical drawings** (labels, titles, dimensions)
- **Signage and posters**
- **Logos and brand design**
- **Book covers and advertisements**
- **Architectural drawings**
- **Maps and diagrams**

CLASS ACTIVITY (DEMONSTRATION)

1. Draw **guidelines** for letters 20mm high.
2. Sketch “BLOCK LETTERS” in sans-serif style.

3. Using a calligraphy pen or broad marker, write the word “**Artistic**” maintaining the 45° nib angle.
4. Compare and discuss differences in stroke width and aesthetic appeal.

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS QUESTIONS)

1. Differentiate between *lettering* and *handwriting*.
2. Define *calligraphy* and explain its main characteristic.
3. What is an *ascender*? Give two examples of letters with ascenders.
4. What is a *descender*? Mention two examples.
5. Why is *spacing* as important as the letters themselves?
6. List three tools used in calligraphic lettering.
7. Explain two uses of block lettering in graphic design.

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. In your sketchbook, draw the word “**VISUAL ARTS**” in all-caps **Block Lettering** (height: 2 inches). Maintain uniform stroke thickness and balanced spacing.
2. Draw the word “**Creativity**” using a **Calligraphic style** — use thick and thin strokes appropriately.
3. Write the word “**background**” and use arrows to label one *ascender*, one *descender*, and one *loop*.
4. Explain **why block letters are more suitable** for highway signs than calligraphic letters.
5. Identify and draw the four **guidelines** used in lettering construction.

VISUAL SUMMARY

Lettering Type	Characteristics	Common Use	Example Illustration
Block (Sans-serif)	Uniform stroke, no serifs, geometric	Posters, labels, technical drawings	A B C D E
Calligraphic	Thick/thin strokes, decorative, elegant	Certificates, invitations	A

WEEK 2: INTRODUCTION TO GRAPHICS II

INTRODUCTION

Welcome back! Last week, we studied **Lettering** — the art of drawing letters with precision. This week, we advance into the **heart of all visual composition** — understanding how every design communicates through its *visual language*.

In Graphic Design, this language is built from two key parts:

- **The Elements of Design** — these are the **basic ingredients** used to make any artwork.
- **The Principles of Design** — these are the **rules or guidelines** that help arrange those ingredients to create an effective and pleasing composition.

Just as a chef combines ingredients according to a recipe, an artist combines **elements** according to the **principles** to produce harmony, beauty, and clear communication.

ELEMENTS OF DESIGN (THE “INGREDIENTS”)

These are the **visual tools or components** that form the foundation of every design. Each element plays a unique role in creating a complete visual message.

1. LINE

Definition: A **line** is the path of a moving point through space. It is the most fundamental design element and can express direction, emotion, and structure.

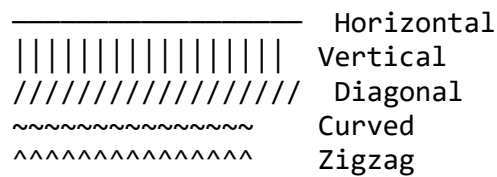
Types of Lines:

- **Horizontal:** calm, peaceful, and stable.
- **Vertical:** strong, formal, and balanced.
- **Diagonal:** dynamic and energetic.
- **Curved:** graceful, natural, and rhythmic.
- **Zigzag / Jagged:** tense, exciting, or alarming.

Uses:

- To define shapes and boundaries.
- To suggest movement and direction.
- To create patterns and textures.
- To emphasize important areas in a design.

Illustration: Types of Lines



Note: In technical graphics, construction lines (light) and visible lines (dark) are both examples of line usage.

2. TEXTURE

Definition: Texture refers to the **surface quality** of an object — how something **feels** or **appears to feel**.

Types of Texture:

- **Tactile Texture:** Real, touchable surface (e.g., rough bark, smooth glass).
- **Visual Texture:** An illusion of texture created through drawing (e.g., cross-hatching to show fabric or stone).

Illustration:

Rough Surface → ///////////////
Smooth Surface → _____

Use in Design: Texture adds realism, depth, and interest to a surface, making it more engaging to the viewer.

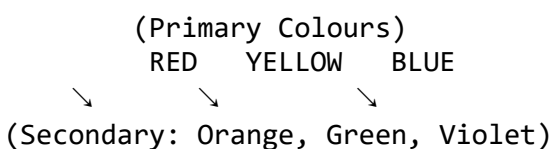
3. COLOUR

Definition: Colour is the visual response of the eye to light reflected from a surface. It is the most expressive and emotionally powerful design element.

Three Properties of Colour:

1. **Hue:** The name of the colour (e.g., red, blue, green).
2. **Value:** How light or dark a colour appears.
3. **Intensity (Saturation):** The brightness or dullness of a colour.

Colour Wheel Illustration:



Symbolic Meaning (Example):

- Red → passion, danger, love
- Blue → calm, trust, peace
- Green → nature, freshness, growth
- Black → power, mystery, elegance
- White → purity, simplicity

Note: Designers use colour harmony (analogous, complementary, triadic) to create mood and balance.

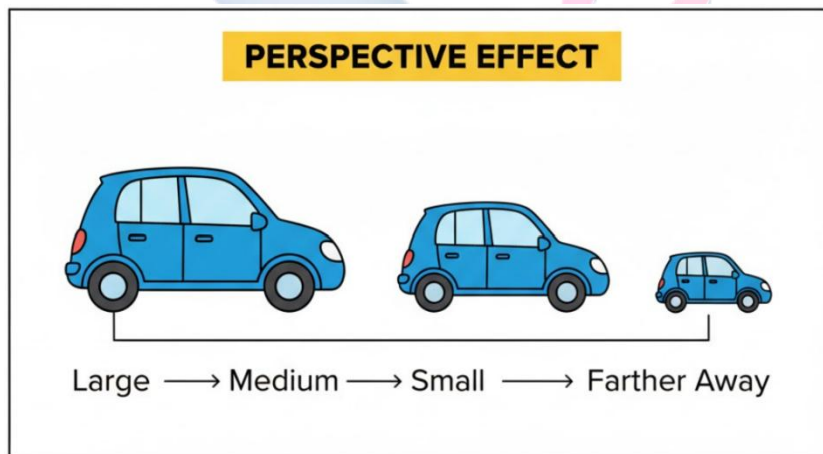
4. SIZE (SCALE)

Definition: Size, also called *scale*, describes how large or small an element appears compared to others.

Uses:

- To show **importance** (a larger object stands out).
- To create **depth** (objects appear smaller as they recede).
- To organize information visually.

Illustration:

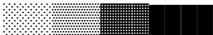


5. VALUE

Definition: Value refers to the **lightness or darkness** of a colour or tone. It is what makes shading, highlights, and shadows visible — giving the illusion of **three-dimensionality**.

Example: A black-and-white drawing relies entirely on value to define form.

Illustration: Value Gradient

White  Black

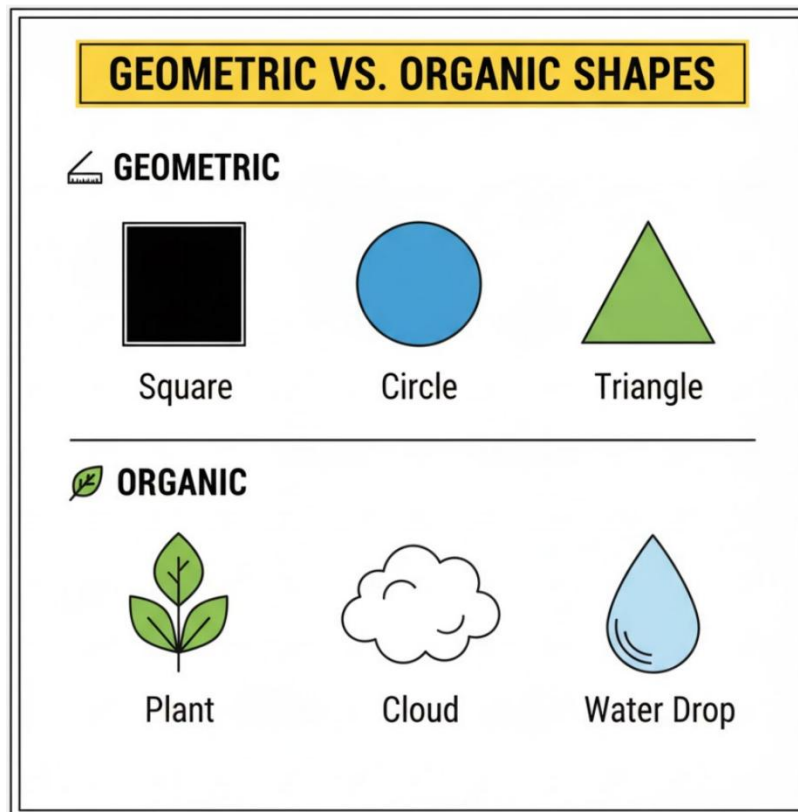
Tip: Value contrast is essential for readability, especially in text and background combinations.

6. SHAPE

Definition: A **shape** is a flat, 2D enclosed area created by lines, colour, or texture.

Types of Shapes:

- **Geometric Shapes:** Precise and mathematical (e.g., square, triangle, circle).
- **Organic Shapes:** Free, natural, irregular (e.g., leaves, clouds).



Note: When shapes overlap, they can create **form** — a 3D illusion with depth.

PRINCIPLES OF DESIGN (THE “RECIPE”)

These are the **guiding rules** or “recipes” that help the artist organize the elements of design into a cohesive and expressive composition. They ensure that the artwork communicates effectively and feels visually pleasing.

1. BALANCE

Definition: Balance refers to the distribution of **visual weight** so that the design feels stable and complete.

Types of Balance:

- **Symmetrical (Formal Balance):** The two sides are identical or mirror each other. → Example: a building's front elevation, a butterfly's wings.

| A | B |
| --- | --- | ← Both sides equal in shape and size

- **Asymmetrical (Informal Balance):** The two sides differ but still appear visually equal. → Example: a large shape on one side balanced by smaller shapes on the other.

| A (large) | B B (two small) |

Visual Effect:

- Symmetry → stability, calmness, tradition.
- Asymmetry → movement, energy, modernity.

2. CONTRAST

Definition: Contrast means placing **opposite elements** side by side to create visual interest, focus, or emphasis.

Examples of Contrast:

- Light vs. Dark
- Big vs. Small
- Rough vs. Smooth
- Curved vs. Straight
- Warm vs. Cool Colours

Illustration:

■ □ Black vs. White
LARGE vs. small
Rough × Smooth

3. PROPORTION

Definition: Proportion refers to the **relationship of sizes** among different parts of a design or object.

Example: In the human body, the head is smaller than the torso; in architecture, the doors relate proportionally to the walls.

Illustration:

Human Figure → Head : Body = 1 : 7

Good proportion ensures realism and comfort to the eye.

4. VARIETY

Definition: Variety involves using **different elements** — colours, shapes, textures, and sizes — to make the design interesting.

Purpose: It prevents monotony and engages the viewer's attention.

Illustration:

▲ ● ■ ◆ ◇ (variety of shapes)

5. GRADATION

Definition: Gradation is a gradual change in an element from one extreme to another.

Examples:

- Light → Dark (value)
- Big → Small (size)
- Bright → Dull (colour)

Illustration: Value Gradation:

White  Black

6. HARMONY (OR UNITY)

Definition: Harmony is when **all parts of the design work together** — nothing feels out of place. It is the sense of oneness or completeness.

Ways to Achieve Harmony:

- Repetition of colour or shape
- Consistent style or theme
- Balanced use of space and texture

Illustration:

●●● consistent colour = unity

Harmony makes the design feel finished, natural, and pleasing to the eye.

SUMMARY TABLE

ELEMENTS	DEFINITION	PRINCIPLES	PURPOSE
Line	Path of a moving point	Balance	Creates stability
Texture	Surface quality	Contrast	Adds emphasis
Colour	Hue, value, intensity	Proportion	Maintains realism
Size	Dimension or scale	Variety	Adds interest
Value	Lightness/darkness	Gradation	Creates depth
Shape	2D enclosed area	Harmony	Achieves unity

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS QUESTIONS)

1. What is the main difference between an *Element of Design* and a *Principle of Design*?
2. List and explain four **Elements of Design**.
3. List four **Principles of Design** and state their importance.
4. Differentiate between **Symmetrical** and **Asymmetrical Balance** with examples.
5. What is *Harmony* in a design, and why is it important?
6. Mention any three types of **Lines** and their expressive meanings.
7. What are the three **properties of colour**?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. In your sketchbook, create a **simple phone wallpaper design** using at least:
 - 3 Elements of Design
 - 2 Principles of Design
 2. Write a short paragraph (5–8 lines) explaining your design. Example:

“I used curved lines to create a flowing movement and bright colours to evoke energy. I applied contrast between warm and cool tones and maintained balance by repeating the circular shape.”
 3. Find a magazine or poster advertisement. Identify and label where you observe: a. **Balance** b. **Contrast** c. **Harmony**
-

WEEK 3: FORMS OF GRAPHIC ADVERTISEMENT I

TOPIC:

Forms of Graphic Advertisement (I)

INTRODUCTION

In previous lessons, we learned about the **elements** (ingredients) and **principles** (recipe) of design. These are the foundation upon which all graphic works are built. Now, we move to how those principles are applied in **advertising design**—a powerful tool used to communicate visually, persuade audiences, and promote products, services, or events.

Graphic Advertisement refers to the use of **visual communication**—text, images, symbols, color, and layout—to convey a message that motivates or influences the audience. It is the **visual voice of marketing**.

In essence:

Graphic Advertisement = Design + Communication + Persuasion

It is a blend of **artistic creativity** and **commercial purpose** — aimed at **attracting attention, informing, and convincing** people to act.

TYPES OF GRAPHIC ADVERTISEMENT

1. NEWSPAPER ADVERTISEMENTS

Description

Advertisements printed in daily, weekly, or monthly newspapers. They are among the **oldest and most widespread** forms of graphic advertisement.

Features

- **Medium:** Printed on low-cost, absorbent “newsprint” paper.
- **Colour:** Usually black and white due to printing costs, though full-color ads are now possible in modern papers.
- **Typography:** Headlines must be **bold, simple, and readable** from a distance.
- **Composition:** Layouts must be **clean**, with clear separation from surrounding news text.
- **Illustrations:** Small images or product photos may be used sparingly.

Challenges

- The reader's attention is divided among multiple articles and advertisements.
- The design must “fight for attention” using clever **visual hierarchy** and **strong contrast**.

Example Illustration



2. POSTERS

Description

A **large, single-sheet print** designed to be displayed in public places such as walls, billboards, schools, and bus stops.

Function

To **grab attention instantly** and communicate a **single, powerful message** at a glance.

Features

- **Dominant Image:** A strong central visual or graphic symbol.
- **Short, Bold Headline:** One idea only. (E.g., “*STOP MALARIA NOW!*”)
- **Minimal Text:** Just enough to support the message.
- **Colour & Contrast:** Bright and engaging to stand out.
- **Typography:** Readable from several meters away.

Example Types

- Movie posters
- Political campaign posters
- Public awareness posters
- Concert/event posters

Illustrative Layout Example

ART EXHIBITION 2025

"Creativity in Motion"

Venue: School Hall, June 20, 10am



DON'T MISS IT!

3. HANDBILLS (FLYERS)

Description

A **small, single-page advertisement** designed for hand distribution, often folded or printed on both sides.

Function

To **inform** and **persuade** the reader up close. It can include **more details** than a poster.

Features

- **Medium:** A5 or A6 paper (half or quarter of A4).
- **Design:** Colourful, portable, and eye-catching.
- **Content:** Includes specific information — address, contact, dates, and sometimes maps.
- **Tone:** Friendly and direct.

Example Use Cases

- Product promotions (e.g., “Buy one, get one free”)
- School events and exhibitions
- Local businesses and services

Illustrative Layout



4. INVITATION CARDS

Description

A **formal or informal card** used to invite guests to an occasion. It combines **aesthetic presentation** with **clear communication**.

Function

To **communicate event details** (what, when, where, who) while **reflecting the mood and tone** of the event.

Features

- **Tone and Style:** Must match the nature of the event.
 - Wedding → Elegant, soft colors, cursive fonts.
 - Birthday → Bright, playful, fun imagery.
 - Corporate event → Formal, minimal, structured design.
- **Information Hierarchy:**
 - **What:** Event name (e.g., “Wedding Ceremony”)
 - **Who:** Host or celebrant
 - **When:** Date and time
 - **Where:** Venue
 - **Optional:** RSVP, dress code, map, theme color.

Example Illustration



5. BOOK COVERS

Description

The “**face**” or **packaging** of a book, designed to **attract buyers** and communicate the essence of the book’s content.

Function

A book cover must **stand out visually** and **give hints about the book’s genre** (romance, horror, adventure, educational, etc.)

Features

- **Front Cover:** Includes title, author, and imagery that reflect the story or subject.
- **Spine:** Displays title and author for shelf visibility.
- **Back Cover:** May include summary, author bio, and publisher details.
- **Design Principle:** Balance, contrast, and unity between image and text.

Example

- A **romantic novel** may use soft pink tones and floral imagery.
- A **thriller** may use dark shades, bold fonts, and shadowy figures.

Illustration



KEY VISUALS & SUMMARY CHART

Type	Size/Medium	Main Purpose	Text Density	Viewing Distance
Newspaper	Newsprint	Inform or promote quickly	Moderate	Close
Poster	Large paper	Attract attention	Minimal	Far
Handbill	Small paper	Inform in detail	Medium–High	Close

Type	Size/Medium	Main Purpose	Text Density	Viewing Distance
Invitation	Card	Invite formally	Moderate	Close
Book Cover	Book material	Sell and represent content	Moderate	Close

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. Define *graphic advertisement* and state its purpose.
2. Differentiate between a **poster** and a **handbill**.
3. Mention three features of a **newspaper advertisement**.
4. Explain what is meant by the “tone” of an **invitation card**.
5. State two ways a **book cover** attracts attention.

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Design a **poster** for your school’s Art Exhibition. Use a dominant image, a short headline, and bright colors.
2. Create a **handbill** for the same event, including time, venue, list of activities, and contact info.
3. Select a **book** you own. Analyze its **cover design** and explain what type of message or genre it communicates through its visual elements (color, typography, imagery).

WEEK 4: FORMS OF GRAPHIC ADVERTISEMENT II

TOPIC:

Forms of Graphic Advertisement (Continued)

INTRODUCTION

In the previous week, we studied **traditional print advertisements**—newspapers, posters, handbills, invitation cards, and book covers. This week, we step into the **modern and large-scale media forms** of graphic advertising—those you see on **music albums, digital platforms, and massive outdoor banners**.

Just as fashion evolves, **advertising design evolves** with technology and audience behavior. Today's designer must be able to create visuals that look appealing both on **paper** and on **screens**—from a huge banner on the street to a small thumbnail on a smartphone.

To excel, you must understand how **purpose, scale, and medium** affect design choices such as **color, font, image size, and layout**.

TYPES OF GRAPHIC ADVERTISEMENT (CONTINUED)

1. CD JACKETS (ALBUM ART)

Description

A **CD jacket** or **album art** is the **cover design** of a music album—traditionally printed on paper or cardboard, but now mostly digital. It's what you see when browsing through music apps like Spotify, Audiomack, or Apple Music.

The **album cover** is the **visual face of the music**. It captures the **mood, genre, and identity** of the artist or album.

Functions

- To create a **visual identity** for the artist or music group.
- To **attract attention** and make the music **instantly recognizable**.
- To **communicate the mood** or **genre** of the album (e.g., love, energy, rebellion, peace).

- To serve as part of the **artist's brand identity** (just as logos do for companies).

Design Features

- **Imagery:** Often features the artist's photograph, or a symbolic graphic.
- **Typography:** Artist name and album title must be bold and clear.
- **Colour Scheme:** Reflects the music style (e.g., bright for pop, dark for rock).
- **Composition:** Balanced and visually appealing, even when viewed as a small icon.
- **Modern Challenge:** Must remain **readable and recognizable** as a **small digital thumbnail** (e.g., on phones).

Examples and Symbolism

Genre	Design Style	Visual Example
Gospel	Calm, light colors, radiant imagery	Hands lifted in worship
Hip-Hop	Bold fonts, urban textures, dark background	Graffiti art or city streets
Classical	Elegant typography, soft tones	Abstract lines or old instruments
Pop	Bright, trendy, colorful	Portrait of artist with vivid background

Illustrative Layout Example

DAVID SOUL - "HEARTBEAT"
[Artist Image or Symbolic Illustration]
Gentle blues and soft pink tones
Typography: Elegant serif font

Visual Note: Encourage students to view popular album covers (e.g., Burna Boy, Adele, Wizkid, Taylor Swift) and analyze how color and imagery express the artist's **style** and **genre**.

2. BANNERS

Description

A **banner** is a **large, elongated visual advertisement** printed on **vinyl (PVC)**, **fabric**, or displayed **digitally** (e.g., on websites or LED billboards). It is one of the most visible and impactful tools of mass communication.

Functions

- To **announce, promote, or advertise** on a **large scale**.

- To **draw attention from afar**, especially in outdoor environments.
- To **mark special occasions** like crusades, trade fairs, political campaigns, and graduations.

Features

- **Size:** Usually very large—measured in feet or meters.
- **Material:** Printed on **vinyl or canvas** to resist wind, sun, and rain.
- **Typography:** Very large and bold text readable from 10–30 meters away.
- **Layout:** Simple and uncluttered—few words, clear message.
- **Color:** High contrast for visibility (e.g., white text on blue background).
- **Imagery:** Large, high-resolution photos or icons.

Example Uses

- Church or event banners (“Annual Harvest Thanksgiving”)
- Political campaign banners (“Vote for Progress 2027”)
- School or business advertisements (“Admission in Progress!”)
- Trade fairs, concerts, product launches

Illustrative Banner Layout

GREAT FUTURE COLLEGE, UYO

2025 GRADUATION CEREMONY

Theme: “Lighting the Path of Knowledge”

Date: June 14, 2025 | Time: 10am | Venue: School Hall

GUEST SPEAKER: Prof. Mary Essien

#SuccessStartsHere

Visual Tip: Use **contrast**, **hierarchy**, and **negative space**—too many words or cluttered graphics make banners hard to read.

FEATURES OF A GOOD GRAPHIC ADVERTISEMENT

What makes a graphic design *effective* and *professional*? Below are **7 golden rules** that guide all forms of visual communication—from posters and album covers to banners and digital ads.

1. SUITABLE DESIGN (APPROPRIATENESS)

The **design must fit its purpose and audience**.

- Match the **mood** of the message:
 - Children's event → bright colors, fun fonts
 - Law firm → serious colors, formal fonts
 - Funeral → dark tones, simple layout
- The **style, color, and typeface** must reflect the subject.

Example: A poster for a **toy store** should look playful; one for a **bank** should look trustworthy and stable.

2. LEGIBILITY (READABILITY)

If the text cannot be read clearly, the design fails.

- Use **clear fonts** (avoid over-decorated letters).
- Ensure **contrast** between text and background.
- Avoid crowding text; leave breathing space.
- Maintain good alignment and spacing.

Example: White letters on a dark background are often more legible outdoors.

3. COMMUNICATION

The **message must be instantly clear**—within **1–3 seconds**.

- Avoid too many details.
- Use strong imagery that tells a story.
- Let the design *speak before the viewer reads* the text.

Analogy: A good poster “shouts its message” even from across the room.

4. TECHNICAL PROFICIENCY (CRAFTSMANSHIP)

A professional finish shows **skill, care, and precision**.

- Lines are clean and sharp.
- Images are clear and not pixelated.
- Layouts are balanced and aligned.
- No spelling or grammatical errors.
- Printing or rendering quality is high.

Bad craftsmanship looks like: Jagged images, inconsistent colors, blurry photos, and untidy edges.

5. COLOUR DISTRIBUTION

Color is not just decoration—it **communicates emotion** and **creates focus**.

Colour	Common Meaning	Usage Example
Red	Energy, urgency, danger	Sales posters, warnings
Blue	Trust, calm, professionalism	Corporate ads, banks
Yellow	Cheerfulness, youth	Kids' brands, entertainment
Green	Nature, peace, freshness	Eco campaigns, health
Black	Power, elegance	Luxury goods
White	Purity, simplicity	Invitations, hospitals

Tip: Too many bright colors = chaos. Good designers balance **contrast** with **harmony**.

6. HARMONY (UNITY)

All elements—text, image, color, and background—should **work together** like a team.

- Nothing should appear random or misplaced.
- Repetition of color or shape can unify the design.
- Maintain consistent margins, font types, and alignments.

Example: A school brochure using the same color scheme and font across all pages looks more professional.

7. SYMBOLISM

Symbolism is the **use of images to represent ideas or concepts**.

Symbol	Meaning
Dove	Peace
Scale	Justice
Heart	Love
Light bulb	Idea / innovation
Tree	Growth or nature
Star	Excellence or success

Example: The **MTN logo** uses yellow to symbolize energy and connectivity, while **Apple's logo** represents creativity and simplicity.

VISUAL SUMMARY CHART

Feature	Description	Visual Cue / Example
Suitability	Design fits audience	vs
Legibility	Text easily readable	A vs fancy fonts
Communication	Clear message fast	⚡
Craftsmanship	Neat, professional finish	
Colour	Balanced, mood-appropriate	
Harmony	All parts work together	
Symbolism	Uses imagery for meaning	

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is the main function of a **CD jacket** or **album art**?
2. What is the key requirement for **text on a large banner**?
3. Explain why **legibility** is the most important rule in design.
4. Define **suitability** in graphic design, and give an example.
5. What is **symbolism**? Mention one common design symbol and its meaning.

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Find a famous brand logo (e.g., Nike, Apple, Coca-Cola, MTN).
 - (a) Draw it in your sketchbook.
 - (b) Write a short paragraph explaining its **symbolism**—what ideas or emotions it conveys.
2. Design a **simple logo** for your school.
 - Use clear symbolism that reflects your school's mission or spirit.

3. Explain why **technical proficiency** is important in design.

- What does a poorly crafted design look like? Give one example.
-



WEEK 6: INTRODUCTION TO COMPUTER GRAPHICS

INTRODUCTION

For centuries, artists and designers created visual art manually—using pencils, brushes, ink, and paper. This form of work required time, space, and physical tools. However, with the invention of **computers**, art and design have become faster, more precise, and easily editable.

Computer Graphics refers to the **art, science, and technology of creating, editing, and displaying visual content** (such as drawings, paintings, images, animations, and videos) using a **computer system**.

It forms the foundation of **digital art, architectural drafting, animation, advertising, game design, and multimedia communication**.

IMPORTANCE OF COMPUTER GRAPHICS

- Used in **advertising** for posters, billboards, and branding materials.
 - Used in **engineering and architecture** to produce technical and 3D drawings.
 - Used in **entertainment** (movies, animation, games).
 - Used in **education** for creating diagrams, charts, and visual aids.
 - Used in **web design** and **UI/UX** development.
-

COMPUTER HARDWARE (THE “BODY”)

Hardware refers to all **physical parts** of a computer system that can be touched. For a **graphic artist**, these hardware components are essential tools of the trade.

KEY HARDWARE COMPONENTS FOR GRAPHICS WORK

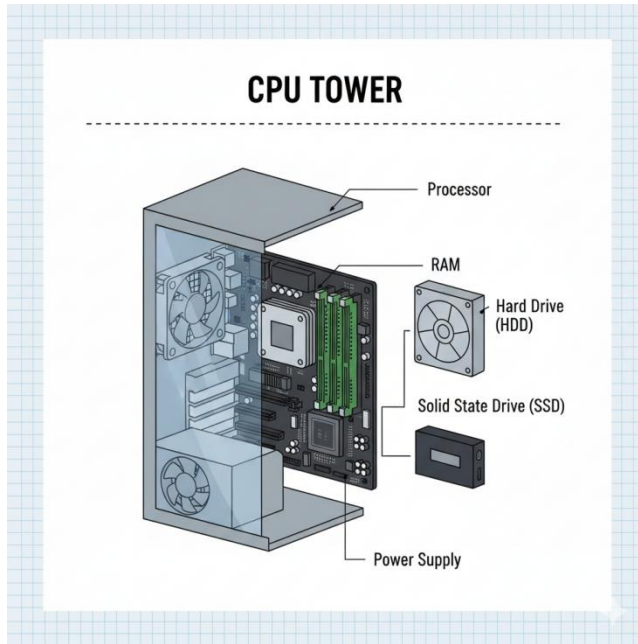
1. Monitor (Display Screen)

- **Function:** Displays visual output and shows your artwork as you work on it.
 - **Importance:** A large, high-resolution monitor allows accurate color display and detail visibility.
 - **Types:** LCD, LED, or Retina displays.
-

2. System Unit (CPU)

- **Function:** The “brain” of the computer — processes all commands and instructions.
- **Contains:** Processor, RAM, motherboard, hard drive, cooling fans.
- **Importance:** A powerful CPU ensures smooth performance for heavy graphic software like CorelDraw or Photoshop.

Illustration (internal structure):



3. Printer

- **Function:** Converts digital designs into **hard copies** on paper.
- **Types:**
 - *Inkjet printer* – for photo-quality images.
 - *Laser printer* – for text and line work.
 - *Plotter* – for large-format drawings and architectural prints.

4. Keyboard

- **Function:** Used to type text, shortcuts, and commands.
- **Examples:**
 - CTRL + Z → Undo
 - CTRL + S → Save
 - CTRL + P → Print

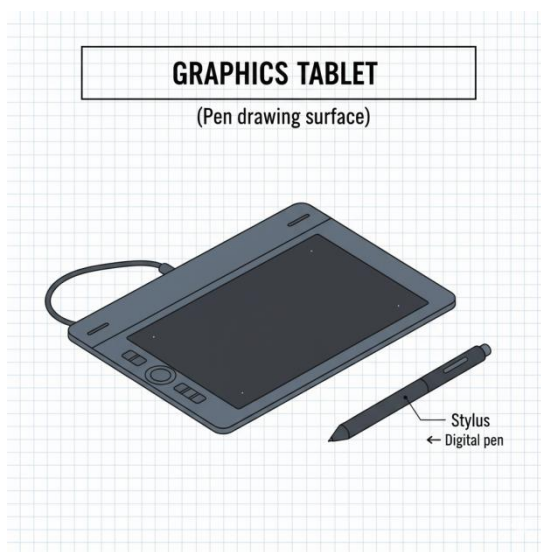
5. Mouse

- **Function:** Used to move the pointer, click, drag, and draw.
 - **Importance:** Essential for object manipulation in graphic software.
 - **Alternatives:** Stylus, pen, or touchpad for more precision.
-

6. Graphics Tablet (Digital Pen Tablet)

- **Function:** Allows natural hand-drawing directly into the computer.
- **Importance:** Mimics paper drawing—used by illustrators and digital painters.
- **Popular Brands:** Wacom, Huion, XP-Pen.

Illustration:



COMPUTER SOFTWARE (THE “MIND”)

Software is the collection of **programs and instructions** that tell the computer what to do. For a designer, software is like the **toolbox** for creativity.

TYPES OF GRAPHIC SOFTWARE

1. CorelDRAW (Vector-Based Software)

- **Definition:** A *vector* program that uses mathematical points, lines, and curves to form images.
- **Output:** Crisp and clear, no matter the size.
- **Uses:** Logos, letterings, illustrations, cartoons, signboards.
- **Advantages:**

- Can be resized infinitely without losing quality.
- Produces small file sizes.
- Excellent for printing.

2. Adobe Photoshop (Raster-Based Software)

- **Definition:** A *raster* or *bitmap* program that creates images from tiny colored squares called **pixels**.
- **Uses:** Editing photos, painting digitally, creating realistic textures.
- **Disadvantages:**
 - Cannot be enlarged too much without losing quality (becomes pixelated).
- **File Format:** .PSD (Photoshop Document), .JPEG, .PNG.

Example: A digital portrait, photograph, or movie poster.

3. Harvard Graphics (Presentation Software)

- **Definition:** An early presentation program for creating charts, slides, and graphs.
- **Modern Equivalents:**
 - Microsoft PowerPoint
 - Google Slides
- **Uses:** Presentations, reports, and visual storytelling.

OTHER MODERN GRAPHIC SOFTWARE

- **Adobe Illustrator:** Another vector-based tool used by professionals.
- **SketchUp:** Used for architectural 3D modeling.
- **AutoCAD:** Used by engineers and architects for precise technical drawings.
- **Canva:** Web-based design tool for quick posters and social media graphics.

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN VECTOR AND RASTER GRAPHICS

Feature	Vector Graphics	Raster Graphics
Composition	Made of lines, points, and curves (mathematical)	Made of pixels (tiny colored dots)
Example Software	CorelDraw, Illustrator	Photoshop, Paint
Scalability	Infinite – never loses quality	Limited – becomes pixelated when

Feature	Vector Graphics	Raster Graphics
		enlarged
Best Use	Logos, drawings, illustrations	Photographs, paintings
File Size	Usually smaller	Usually larger

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. Define **computer graphics**.
2. Mention **two uses** of computer graphics in everyday life.
3. Differentiate between **hardware** and **software**.
4. What is the main difference between **vector** and **raster** programs?
5. Why is **CorelDraw** more suitable for logos than **Photoshop**?

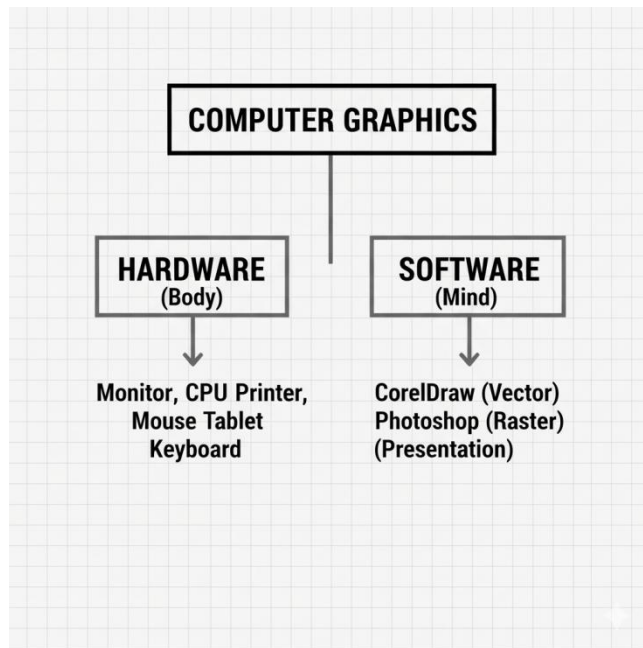
ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. In your own words, explain why a **graphics tablet** is preferred by digital artists over a **mouse**.
2. What does it mean when an image becomes **pixelated**? Which type of graphic causes it?
3. List **three input devices** and **two output devices** used in computer graphics.
4. Identify and describe **two modern programs** that can replace Harvard Graphics.
5. Design (sketch) a simple **logo** on paper that could be drawn using CorelDraw.

SUMMARY NOTES

- Computer Graphics = Art + Computer.
- Hardware = Physical components (Monitor, CPU, Mouse).
- Software = Programs (CorelDraw, Photoshop).
- Vector graphics = Scalable and precise.
- Raster graphics = Realistic but pixel-based.

VISUAL SUMMARY



WEEK 8: COMPUTER GRAPHICS II (BASIC MOUSE TECHNIQUES)

INTRODUCTION

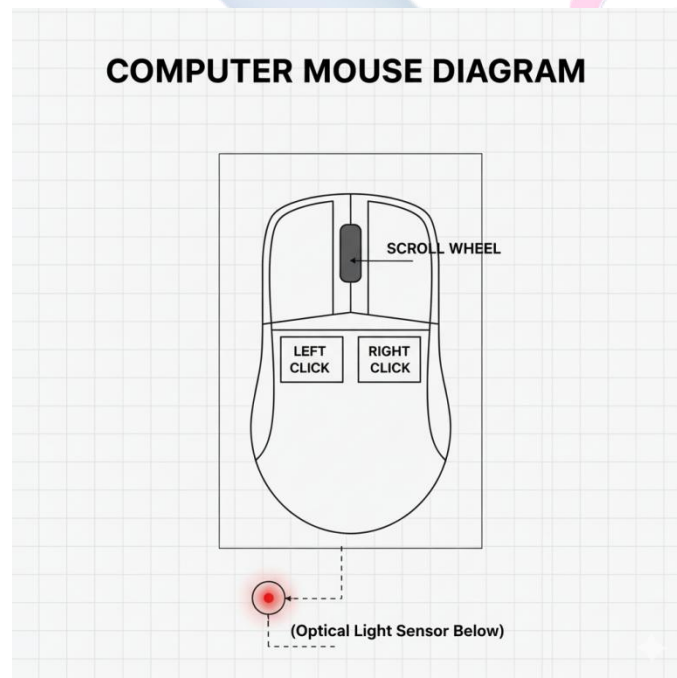
The **computer mouse** is one of the most essential input devices for any computer user, especially for **graphic designers, digital artists, architects, and engineers**.

Before mastering professional design software such as **CorelDraw, Adobe Photoshop, or AutoCAD**, a student must first understand how to properly **control and manipulate objects** on the screen using **basic mouse techniques**.

The mouse acts as an **extension of your hand** in the digital world — every line you draw, shape you resize, or menu you open starts with a simple mouse movement.

PARTS OF A STANDARD MOUSE

A computer mouse typically has the following components:



Parts Description:

- **Left Button:** Used for clicking, selecting, and dragging.
- **Right Button:** Used for context menus or special options.

- **Scroll Wheel:** Used to move up and down documents or zoom in/out in design programs.
- **Optical Sensor:** Detects movement on the surface and translates it to pointer movement on the screen.

BASIC MOUSE TECHNIQUES

These are the **five fundamental mouse actions** that every computer graphics student must master. They form the foundation of nearly all operations performed in design software.

1. POINTING

What It Is: Moving the mouse across a surface to move the **pointer (cursor)** on the computer screen.

Purpose: Used to “aim” or **indicate** an object, icon, button, or area you intend to work on.

Illustration:

Mouse Movement → Cursor Movement

[Mouse] → [Pointer on Screen]

Example: In CorelDraw, you **point** at the "Rectangle Tool" icon before selecting it to draw a rectangle.

Tip:

- Move the mouse gently and maintain control.
- Avoid lifting the mouse too often—move it smoothly across the mouse pad.

2. CLICKING (LEFT-CLICK / SINGLE-CLICK)

What It Is: Pressing and releasing the **left mouse button** one time.

Purpose: Used to **select** or **activate** items such as icons, menus, buttons, or tools.

Example:

- Clicking on the “**Start**” button.
- Selecting a **tool** (e.g., Brush tool in Paint).
- Choosing a **color** from a palette.

Note: A **single click** is not the same as **double-click**—it only selects, it does not open.

3. DOUBLE-CLICKING

What It Is: Quickly pressing and releasing the **left mouse button twice** in succession.

Purpose: Used to **open files, launch programs, or select whole words** in text editors.

Example: Double-clicking on “My Computer” opens the drive and folders. In design programs, double-clicking may **open object properties** or **edit settings**.

Tip:

- The two clicks must be **rapid**, or the system will treat them as two separate single clicks.
- Adjust “double-click speed” in the mouse settings if it feels too fast or slow.

4. DRAGGING (OR DRAG-AND-DROP)

What It Is:

1. Point at the item.
2. Press and **hold down** the left mouse button.
3. Move (drag) the mouse to a new location.
4. **Release** the button to drop the item.

Purpose: Used for **moving, rearranging, resizing, drawing, or selecting multiple objects**.

Examples in Graphics:

- Moving a shape across the canvas.
- Drawing a line or rectangle.
- Selecting multiple layers or objects by dragging across them.
- Resizing an image by dragging its corner handles.

Tip: Hold **Shift** or **Ctrl** while dragging to constrain proportions or duplicate objects (in design programs).

5. RIGHT-CLICKING

What It Is: Pressing and releasing the **right mouse button** once.

Purpose: Opens a **context menu** — a short menu that provides **quick access to commands** related to the selected object.

Illustration:

[Right-Click on Picture]

↓

Pop-up Menu Appears:

└─ Open

- └ Edit
- └ Copy
- └ Delete
- └ Properties

Example: Right-clicking on an image in Photoshop brings up options like:

- Copy Layer
- Convert to Smart Object
- Blending Options

Tip: Right-click menus are **context-sensitive**, meaning they change depending on what you click.

EXTRA TECHNIQUE: SCROLLING

What It Is: Rolling the **scroll wheel** forward or backward to move up and down through pages or canvases.

Purpose: Allows **navigation** in long documents or zooming in/out of images (in some design software).

Illustration:

Scroll Wheel ↑ → Move up the page
 Scroll Wheel ↓ → Move down the page

Example: Zooming in to refine a logo in CorelDraw or scrolling down a long webpage.

SUMMARY TABLE

Action	Description	Purpose	Example
Pointing	Move the cursor	Aim or indicate an object	Point at "Rectangle Tool"
Clicking	Press & release left button once	Select or activate	Select a tool or file
Double-Clicking	Press left button twice quickly	Open or launch	Open folder
Dragging	Hold, move, and release	Move, resize, draw	Move shape on canvas
Right-Clicking	Press right button once	Open context menu	Show "Copy" options
Scrolling	Roll wheel	Navigate or zoom	Zoom in on artwork

PRACTICAL VISUAL ILLUSTRATION

COMPUTER SCREEN

← Pointer moving across screen
(Controlled by Mouse)

↓ Physical Movement of Hand ↓

[Mouse]
Left | Scroll | Right Buttons

REAL-WORLD APPLICATIONS OF MOUSE TECHNIQUES

Field	Application Example
Graphic Design	Drawing shapes, selecting tools, painting strokes.
Architecture	Moving and scaling building plans in AutoCAD.
Engineering Drawing	Dragging and aligning components precisely.
Education	Navigating slides, annotating diagrams, selecting lessons.
Video Editing	Trimming clips, dragging timelines, selecting effects.

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is the action of **pointing**?
2. What is the difference between **clicking** and **double-clicking**?
3. Describe the **four steps** of a **drag-and-drop** action.
4. What is the main purpose of **dragging** in a graphics program?
5. What happens when you **right-click** on an item?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME / PRACTICAL TASK)

Objective: Practise using mouse actions in a real application.

1. Open **Microsoft Paint** or **Tux Paint** on your computer.
2. Use the mouse to:
 - **Click** on the **Brush Tool**.
 - **Click** on the **Color Palette** to select a green color.
 - **Drag** the mouse to draw a simple tree.

- **Right-click** anywhere on the canvas to explore the context menu.
- Click the **Text Tool** and type your **name** below your drawing.

Extension Task: Try using the scroll wheel to zoom in and refine details of your drawing.

TEACHER'S NOTE / INSTRUCTIONAL GUIDE

- Demonstrate each action live using a **projector or smart board**.
 - Encourage learners to hold the mouse **lightly and naturally**, not tightly.
 - Give students **individual practice time** to build coordination.
 - Pair weaker students with stronger ones for **peer learning**.
-



WEEK 9: TEXTILE DESIGNS I (MOTIF & REPEAT PATTERNS)

INTRODUCTION

This week, we move into another fascinating branch of **Applied Arts** — **Textile Design**.

Textile design is the **art and science of creating patterns, colours, and textures on fabrics**. It combines creativity, drawing, colour theory, and geometry to produce beautiful fabrics used for **clothing, upholstery, curtains, and traditional attire**.

Every fabric design — whether it's a rich **Ankara print**, **Adire cloth**, or a **school uniform pattern** — starts from one simple idea: a **motif**.

SECTION 1: MOTIF

Meaning of Motif

A **motif** is the **basic unit of design** — a small, single element or symbol that can be repeated or arranged in many ways to form a pattern. It is the “**seed**” or “**building block**” from which the whole textile design grows.

In short: A *motif* is to textile design what a *word* is to a sentence.

CHARACTERISTICS OF A GOOD MOTIF

A well-designed motif should:

- Be **simple and recognizable**.
 - Work well when **repeated or rotated**.
 - Have **clear lines** and **balanced shapes**.
 - Be adaptable for **printing, weaving, or embroidery**.
 - Create **visual harmony** when used in pattern layouts.
-

TYPES OF MOTIFS

Textile artists usually work with three main categories of motifs:

1. NATURAL MOTIFS

These are inspired by **nature** — plants, animals, insects, shells, clouds, leaves, or flowers.

Examples:

- A sunflower
- A fish
- A palm leaf
- A butterfly
- A lizard

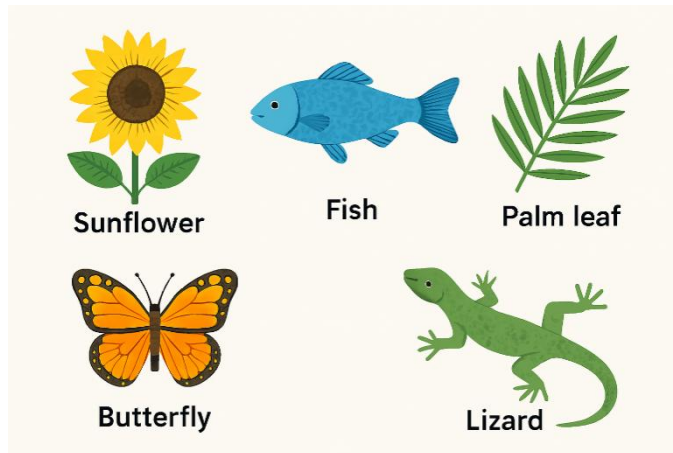


Illustration:



Used in: Traditional fabrics like *Ankara*, *Adire*, *Kente*, and *Batik*.

2. GEOMETRIC MOTIFS

These are based on **mathematical shapes** and symmetry — perfect for modern, clean designs.

Examples:

- Circles ○
- Squares □
- Triangles ▲
- Zigzags / Chevrons ⌘
- Spirals or Crosses ✚

Illustration:



Used in: School uniforms, architectural patterns, woven fabrics.

3. ABSTRACT MOTIFS

These are **stylized** or **non-representational shapes**, often inspired by imagination rather than real objects. They focus on **movement, rhythm, and flow**.

Examples:

- Swirls
- Random brush strokes
- Waves
- Stylized symbols

Illustration:

≈ ≈ ≈ ~~~ ∞

Used in: Artistic fabrics, scarves, and modern digital prints.

SECTION 2: REPEAT PATTERNS

Meaning of Repeat Pattern

A **repeat pattern** is the **system of arrangement** used to repeat a motif so that it fills a fabric evenly and beautifully. It ensures that the design continues seamlessly across the entire surface of the textile.

Think of it like wallpaper: One small section is repeated until it covers the wall.

TYPES OF REPEAT PATTERNS

Below are the main repeat systems used in textile design, with illustrations:

1. BLOCK (SQUARE) REPEAT

The **simplest** and most common repeat. The motif is arranged in straight rows and columns — like tiles on a floor.

Pattern Diagram:

□ □ □
□ □ □
□ □ □

Characteristics:

- Easy to design.
- Good for geometric motifs.

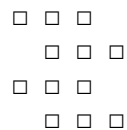
- May appear too rigid if overused.

Example: Checkered shirts, tablecloths, tiled fabrics.

2. HALF-DROP REPEAT

The motif is repeated in rows, but every second row is **shifted halfway down**. This makes the pattern appear more **flowing and dynamic**.

Pattern Diagram:



Characteristics:

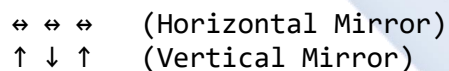
- Adds rhythm and visual interest.
- Common in floral designs.

Example: Flowered curtain fabrics, Ankara patterns.

3. MIRROR (REFLECTED) REPEAT

The motif is **flipped** or **mirrored** — either horizontally or vertically — to form a reflection.

Pattern Diagram:



Characteristics:

- Creates symmetry and balance.
- Excellent for motifs with clear outlines.

Example: Traditional embroidery, woven kente designs.

4. BRICK REPEAT

Similar to a **half-drop repeat**, but instead of shifting vertically, the motifs are staggered **horizontally**, like bricks in a wall.

Pattern Diagram:



Characteristics:

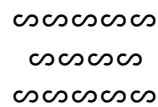
- Stable and structured.
- Works well for geometric motifs.

Example: Checkerboard, striped or blocky prints.

5. OGEE REPEAT

An **S-shaped, curved, or interlocking pattern** that flows gracefully. It's elegant and often used in high-quality fabrics.

Pattern Diagram (Stylized):



Characteristics:

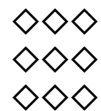
- Graceful, curving rhythm.
- Evokes movement and flow.
- Difficult to construct but visually rich.

Example: Brocade, damask, or lace designs.

6. DIAMOND REPEAT

The motifs are arranged along **diagonal lines** forming a **diamond grid**.

Pattern Diagram:



Characteristics:

- Creates elegance and symmetry.
- Adds direction and flow to the fabric.

Example: African wax prints, royal regalia cloths.

HOW TO CREATE A REPEAT PATTERN

1. **Draw a Motif** — e.g., a simple leaf or bird.
2. **Decide the Type of Repeat** — block, half-drop, mirror, etc.
3. **Use Tracing Paper or Software** — to copy and arrange motifs.

4. **Align Edges** — ensure motifs connect smoothly.
5. **Test Your Design** — fill the page to see the repeating effect.

DIAGRAM: HOW A MOTIF FORMS A PATTERN

Single Motif: ✻

Block Repeat: ✻ ✻ ✻
 ✻ ✻ ✻
 ✻ ✻ ✻

Half-Drop: ✻ ✻ ✻
 ✻ ✻ ✻
 ✻ ✻ ✻

TOOLS AND MATERIALS USED IN TEXTILE DESIGN

Tool	Use
Pencil & Eraser	Sketching motif ideas
Tracing Paper	Duplicating motifs accurately
Ruler & Set Square	Measuring and aligning repeats
Paints & Brushes	Adding colour to motifs
Fabric / Paper	Final printing or testing
Printing Blocks / Stencils	Reproducing designs on cloth

IMPORTANCE OF MOTIFS AND REPEAT PATTERNS IN TEXTILE DESIGN

1. They form the **foundation of all printed and woven fabrics**.
2. They allow **mass production** of consistent and attractive designs.
3. They help express **culture, tradition, and identity** (e.g., Adire, Kente).
4. They add **aesthetic appeal** and **commercial value** to textiles.
5. They teach **balance, rhythm, and repetition** in visual composition.

CLASSROOM ACTIVITY / PRACTICAL

Objective: Create your own textile repeat pattern.

Materials Needed: A4 paper, pencil, eraser, ruler, colours (watercolour or markers).

Procedure:

1. Draw a simple motif — e.g., leaf or butterfly.
 2. Trace it in a **block repeat** pattern on one sheet.
 3. On another sheet, trace it in a **half-drop** repeat.
 4. Colour both sheets neatly.
 5. Label each clearly.
-

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is a **motif** in textile design?
 2. List and describe the **three main types of motifs**.
 3. What is a **repeat pattern**?
 4. What is the **simplest and most common** type of repeat pattern?
 5. How is a **half-drop repeat** different from a **block repeat**?
-

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Design a simple **natural motif** (like a stylized leaf or butterfly) in your sketchbook.
 2. On one A4 page, use your motif to create a **block repeat pattern**.
 3. On another A4 page, use the same motif to create a **half-drop repeat pattern**.
 4. Find a fabric at home and identify:
 - The **motif** used.
 - The **repeat pattern** type.
-

EXTENSION / DIGITAL PRACTICE

For students with computer access:

- Use **CorelDraw** or **Photoshop** to create a digital motif.
 - Use the “Duplicate” and “Align” tools to create a **repeat pattern**.
 - Print your design for display in class.
-

WEEK 10: TEXTILE DESIGNS II (PRINTING TECHNIQUES)

INTRODUCTION

Last week, we designed motifs and repeat patterns — the *blueprints* of textile design. This week, we move into the **practical side** — the process of **transferring designs onto fabric surfaces** using **printing techniques**.

Meaning of Textile Printing

Textile printing is the **art of applying colour, dye, or ink to fabric** in a **planned and controlled pattern**. Unlike dyeing (which colours the *whole* fabric), **printing applies colour only to selected areas**.

Definition: Textile printing is the process of applying colour in a pre-determined pattern to the surface of fabric using various tools and methods.

It allows us to create **beautiful designs** such as:

- Ankara patterns
- Adire (resist-printed cloth)
- Custom T-shirts and tote bags
- Interior fabrics like curtains, pillow covers, and bedsheets

TYPES / FAMILIES OF PRINTING TECHNIQUES

Textile printing methods are grouped into two main **families**:

Family	Principle	Example Techniques
Relief Printing (Stamping)	Ink is applied to the <i>raised surface</i> of a block and stamped onto the fabric.	Block Printing (Woodcut, Linocut, Yam Cut)
Stencil Printing (Through a Screen or Opening)	Ink is <i>pushed through open areas</i> of a stencil onto the fabric.	Screen Printing (Silk Screen)

1. RELIEF PRINTING (BLOCK / LINO / WOODCUT PRINTING)

Meaning

This is one of the **oldest textile printing methods**, used for centuries in Africa, India, and China. It is called *relief* printing because the **raised parts** of a block carry the ink, while the **cut-away parts remain blank**.

Tools and Materials

Tool	Function
Block (Wood, Linoleum, or Yam)	The surface on which the motif is carved
Gouge / Knife	Used to carve out unwanted parts
Printing Ink / Fabric Dye	Provides colour
Roller (Brayer)	Used to spread ink evenly on the block
Printing Table / Surface	For pressing fabric
Fabric / Paper	The surface to receive the print

PROCESS (Step-by-Step)

1. **Design a Motif:** Draw your motif on paper (e.g., a leaf or symbol).
2. **Transfer the Design:** Trace or draw it onto the block (wood, lino, or yam).
3. **Carve Away:** Cut out all parts of the design you *don't* want to print — the motif should remain raised.
4. **Apply Ink:** Roll ink onto the raised surface using a roller or sponge.
5. **Stamp:** Carefully press the block onto the fabric.
6. **Lift the Block:** Gently lift it to reveal the print.
7. **Repeat:** Continue printing to create a repeat pattern.
8. **Dry the Fabric:** Allow the print to dry completely before use.

ILLUSTRATION: BLOCK PRINTING PROCESS

Step 1: Draw motif on block

 →  motif sketch

Step 2: Carve away background

 → Raised design area

Step 3: Apply ink on raised part

 → Ink spread evenly

Step 4: Stamp on fabric

 →  repeated prints

TYPES OF BLOCK PRINTING

1. Woodcut Printing

- Uses a block of wood.
- Traditional method, durable, detailed designs.
- Used in Adire Eleko and traditional African textiles.

2. Lino Cut Printing

- Uses **linoleum sheet**, softer and easier to carve than wood.
- Suitable for beginners and school art projects.

3. Yam / Potato Cut Printing

- Uses cut vegetables (yam, potato, or foam).
 - Simple, safe, and perfect for classroom demonstration.
-

ADVANTAGES OF BLOCK PRINTING

- Simple and inexpensive.
- Good for small-scale production.
- Creates bold, textured prints.
- Allows individual creativity.

DISADVANTAGES

- Time-consuming for large quantities.
 - Difficult to align for perfect repeats.
 - Limited to one colour per block.
-

2. STENCIL PRINTING (SCREEN / SILK SCREEN PRINTING)

Meaning

This is a **stencil-based** printing technique. It uses a **fine mesh screen** (once made of silk, now nylon or polyester) stretched over a **wooden or metal frame**.

Ink is forced through **open parts** of the mesh onto the fabric, while **blocked areas** stop ink from passing through.

In simple terms: Ink goes *through holes* instead of being *stamped on top*.

TOOLS AND MATERIALS

Tool	Function
------	----------

Tool	Function
Screen Frame (Wood or Metal)	Holds the mesh tightly
Silk or Nylon Mesh	Allows ink to pass through open areas
Squeegee (Rubber Blade)	Used to spread and push ink across the screen
Emulsion or Paper Stencil	Blocks areas that should not print
Printing Ink / Dye	Gives colour to the design
Fabric / Substrate	Receives the design

PROCESS (Step-by-Step)

1. **Prepare the Screen:** Stretch a fine nylon or silk mesh tightly across a frame.
2. **Create the Stencil:**
 - Cover non-printing areas using **paper, wax, or light-sensitive emulsion.**
 - Leave open spaces for the motif.
3. **Position the Screen:** Place the screen carefully on top of the fabric.
4. **Apply Ink:** Pour a small amount of printing ink at the top of the screen.
5. **Spread the Ink:** Use a **squeegee** to pull ink across the screen evenly.
6. **Lift the Screen:** Carefully lift it — the ink passes through the open parts, forming the design.
7. **Dry the Fabric:** Allow the print to dry before removing or washing.

ILLUSTRATION: SCREEN PRINTING PROCESS

- 1 Stretch nylon mesh on frame →
- 2 Create stencil (block-out areas) → 
- 3 Pour ink on top → 
- 4 Use squeegee to spread → 
- 5 Lift screen to reveal print → 

ADVANTAGES OF SCREEN PRINTING

- Produces **sharp, bold, and repeatable prints.**
- Can print **multiple colours** (using one screen per colour).
- Suitable for **large-scale commercial production.**
- Works on various materials (fabric, paper, plastic, metal, etc.).

DISADVANTAGES

- Requires more setup time.

- Needs careful alignment for multi-colour designs.
- Each colour requires a separate screen.

APPLICATIONS OF SCREEN PRINTING

- T-shirts and hoodies
 - Posters and banners
 - Curtains and tablecloths
 - Shopping bags and logos
-

COMPARISON BETWEEN BLOCK PRINTING AND SCREEN PRINTING

Feature	Block Printing	Screen Printing
Type	Relief (stamping)	Stencil (through holes)
Tools Used	Block, roller	Screen, squeegee
Speed	Slow	Fast
Cost	Cheap	Slightly expensive
Best for	Handcrafted work	Mass production
Example Product	Adire, school craft	Branded T-shirts

CLASSROOM PRACTICAL ACTIVITY

Activity 1: Yam Cut Printing

Objective: To produce a simple repeat pattern using a yam cut.

Materials: Yam or potato, knife (teacher-assisted), ink or poster paint, paper/fabric, brush.

Procedure:

1. Cut the yam or potato in half.
 2. Draw a simple motif on the flat surface.
 3. Carefully carve away the background.
 4. Apply paint or ink on the raised part.
 5. Press the block onto paper or fabric.
 6. Repeat to form a pattern.
 7. Allow to dry.
-

Activity 2: Screen Printing Demonstration

Objective: To understand the flow of ink through a stencil.

Procedure:

1. Prepare a small nylon screen on a wooden frame.
2. Cover non-printing areas with paper or tape.
3. Pour ink on top and spread with a squeegee.
4. Lift the screen to reveal the print.

ILLUSTRATIVE SUMMARY

TEXTILE PRINTING



Relief (Stamp)
e.g., Block, Lino



Stencil (Through Mesh)
e.g., Screen Printing

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is **textile printing**?
2. State the **main difference** between *relief printing* and *stencil printing*.
3. What is a **lino cut**?
4. What is a **squeegee**, and in which technique is it used?
5. Mention **two advantages** of screen printing.

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. (Practical) Create a simple **yam cut** or **potato cut** print at home.
 2. Carve a small motif on the flat surface of a cut yam or potato.
 3. Apply paint or ink and **stamp** the design on paper or cloth to create a **repeat pattern**.
 4. Explain why **only one colour can be printed at a time** with a single screen in screen printing.
 5. Bring your printed work to class for display and critique.
-

EXTENSION / DIGITAL PROJECT

For digital art students:

- Use **CorelDRAW** or **Canva** to simulate **screen printing** layers.
 - Create a 2-colour T-shirt design showing *screen separation* for each colour.
-



WEEK 11: TERMINOLOGIES IN 2-DIMENSIONAL ART

INTRODUCTION

Every profession has its own language. Doctors, architects, engineers — and artists — all use **specialized words** to describe their work. To talk about **2-dimensional art (2D art)** confidently and professionally, you must understand and use the **correct art terminologies**.

2D Art refers to all forms of artwork that exist on a **flat surface** — such as **drawing, painting, collage, and computer graphics**.

Definition: *2-Dimensional (2D) Art* is any artwork that has **length and width** but no depth, and is created on a **flat surface** such as paper, canvas, or a digital screen.

KEY TERMINOLOGIES IN 2-DIMENSIONAL ART

Below are important technical terms used by artists, illustrators, and designers. Each term includes its **definition, explanation, visual example, and real-life application**.

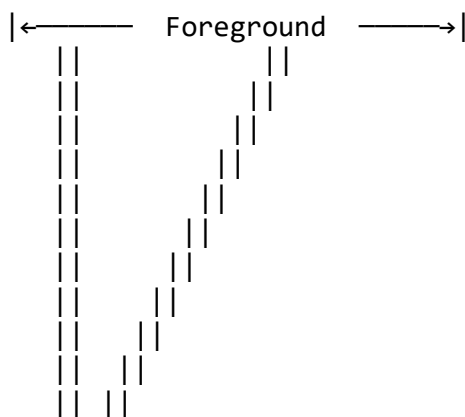
1. VANISHING POINT

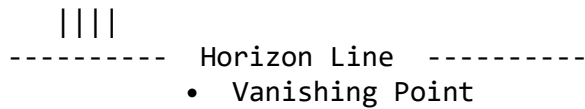
Definition: A *vanishing point* is an imaginary point on the **horizon line** where **parallel lines** appear to converge (meet) and vanish in the distance.

Explanation: This is a principle of **perspective drawing** that creates the illusion of **depth and distance** on a flat surface.

Illustration:

Road or Railway Lines Perspective





Example: When drawing a long road, railway track, or rows of buildings, they seem to meet at a single point far away — that's the vanishing point.

Application in Art: Used in **linear perspective drawing**, **architectural sketches**, and **landscape paintings**.

2. MEDIUM (Plural: Media)

Definition: A *medium* is the **material or substance** that an artist uses to create a work of art.

Examples of Media:

- Graphite (pencil)
- Charcoal
- Watercolour
- Oil paint
- Acrylic
- Ink
- Pastel
- Digital pen (stylus) for computer art

Illustration:

Medium	Common Tool	Artwork Type
Graphite	Pencil	Sketches, drawings
Watercolour	Brush + Water	Painting
Oil Paint	Palette knife + Brush	Canvas painting
Ink	Pen	Illustration
Digital	Tablet stylus	Computer graphics

Artist Note : An artwork's *medium* is often stated beside its title, e.g., "**Landscape in Blue, 2024 — Watercolour on Paper.**"

3. CHIAROSCURO

Definition: An Italian term meaning "*light-dark*." It refers to the **dramatic contrast between light and shadow** used to create a **3D illusion and mood** in an artwork.

Explanation: Artists use strong highlights (light) and deep shadows (dark) to model form, depth, and emotion.

Illustration:

Light Source → ☀

🎯 Object: Sphere

Bright Side: High light

Middle tone: Mid shadow

Dark Side: Core shadow

Cast Shadow: On surface

Example: Renaissance artist **Caravaggio** painted figures illuminated by a single light source emerging from darkness — creating drama and realism.

Application: Used in **painting, photography, and digital art** to emphasize mood and realism.

4. FORESHORTENING

Definition: A drawing technique that makes an object or figure **appear to project towards the viewer** by **shortening its length** in perspective.

Explanation: It's used to make an image look **realistic and three-dimensional** even on a flat paper.

Illustration:

Person pointing finger towards viewer 🖐

(closer finger appears larger)



Arm looks shorter

Example: In a painting, an artist might draw a hand reaching forward or a leg extending towards the viewer — appearing large in front and small behind.

Application: Used in **figure drawing, animation, and comic art** to create dramatic perspective.

5. AERIAL VIEW (BIRD'S-EYE VIEW)

Definition: A way of drawing or painting a scene as if viewed **from high above**, looking down.

Explanation: It shows the arrangement of buildings, roads, or landscapes from an elevated point — like a bird flying overhead.

Illustration:

View from Above:

🏠 → Houses look small and rooftops visible

[] [] []
[] [] []
[] [] []

Example: Architects and city planners use aerial or top-down views in **site plans** and **map illustrations**.

Application: Used in **landscape painting, urban design, cartography, and game design**.

6. REPEAT MOTIF

Definition: A *repeat motif* is the repetition of a single design unit (the motif) in a systematic arrangement to form a **pattern**.

Explanation: It's the foundation of **textile design, wallpaper decoration, and surface pattern design**.

Illustration:

Motif: ❁

Repeat Pattern (Block Repeat):

❁ ❁ ❁
❁ ❁ ❁
❁ ❁ ❁

Example: African Ankara fabrics often feature motifs of leaves, shells, or symbols repeated in various directions.

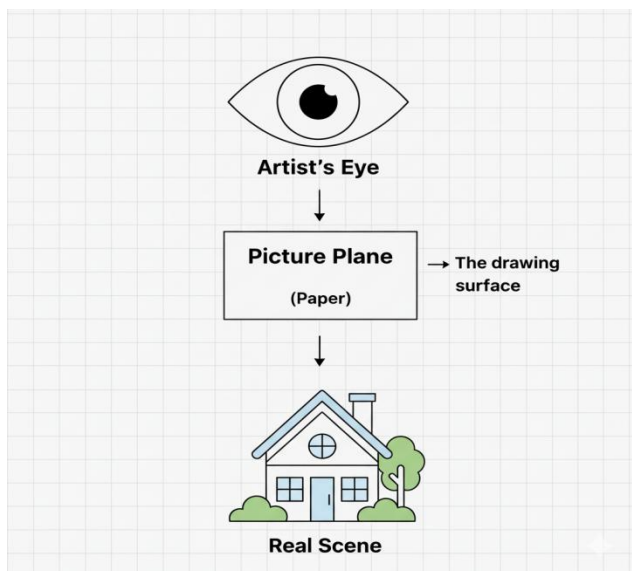
Application: Used in **textile printing, ceramic design, graphics, and digital wallpapers**.

7. PICTURE PLANE

Definition: The *picture plane* is the **imaginary flat surface** through which the artist views the subject. It is also the **actual 2D surface** (paper, canvas, or screen) on which the artwork is created.

Explanation: Think of it as a **window** between the artist's eye and the scene being drawn.

Illustration:



Application: Used in **perspective drawing**, **composition planning**, and **proportion studies**.

ILLUSTRATIVE SUMMARY TABLE

TERM	DEFINITION	APPLICATION / USE
Vanishing Point	Imaginary point where parallel lines meet	Perspective drawing
Medium	Material used to create art	All forms of 2D art
Chiaroscuro	Contrast between light and shadow	Painting, photography
Foreshortening	Illusion of an object projecting toward viewer	Figure drawing
Aerial View	Top-down or bird's-eye view	Maps, architecture
Repeat Motif	Repetition of a single design	Textile and graphic design
Picture Plane	Flat surface where the artwork is made	Drawing and composition

TEACHER NOTES

- **Class Demo 1:** Draw a road or railway line converging at a vanishing point.
- **Class Demo 2:** Shine a lamp on an object to show *chiaroscuro* in real life.
- **Class Demo 3:** Ask students to photograph their own hand in a foreshortened pose (like pointing toward the camera).

Encourage students to keep an **Art Terminology Glossary** in their sketchbooks to build professional vocabulary.

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is a *vanishing point*, and where is it located in a drawing?
 2. Explain the term *medium* in art. Give three examples.
 3. Define *chiaroscuro* and state its importance in painting.
 4. What is *foreshortening*? Give one example.
 5. What do we mean by the *picture plane*?
-

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. In your sketchbook, **draw a road or railway track** disappearing to a single **vanishing point**.
 2. Find a painting, photograph, or film scene that shows **chiaroscuro**.
 - Write one sentence explaining how light and dark are used dramatically.
 3. Draw your own **hand in a foreshortened pose** (e.g., pointing toward your face).
 4. Identify **three artworks or fabrics** in your home and describe their **motif and pattern type**.
-

VISUAL SUMMARY (DIAGRAM OVERVIEW)

2D ART TERMINOLOGIES



Perspective Concepts → Vanishing Point → Foreshortening
Light & Shadow Concepts → Chiaroscuro
Design Concepts → Repeat Motif → Picture Plane
Viewing Angle Concepts → Aerial (Bird's-Eye)

WEEK 12: TERMINOLOGIES IN 3-DIMENSIONAL ART

Sculpture and Ceramics Vocabulary

INTRODUCTION

Three-dimensional (3D) art refers to artworks that have **height, width, and depth** — they occupy physical space and can often be touched, walked around, or viewed from multiple angles. The most common branches of 3D art are **sculpture** and **ceramics**.

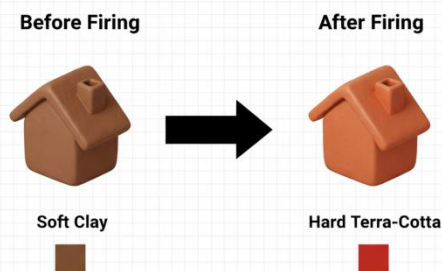
To understand and discuss 3D artworks correctly, artists must know the proper **terminologies** — these are the words that describe the **materials**, **techniques**, and **forms** used in 3D art.

3D ART TERMINOLOGIES

1. TERRA-COTTA

- **Meaning:** The term *Terra-Cotta* comes from Italian, meaning “baked earth.”
- **Definition:** It refers to a **reddish-brown earthenware clay** that is shaped and then fired (baked) at a low temperature.
- **Uses:** Terra-cotta is used for making **pots, roof tiles, decorative sculptures**, and **traditional figures**.
- **Example:** The **Nok sculptures of Nigeria** (dating back over 2,000 years) were made from terra-cotta.

VISUAL ILLUSTRATION: CLAY FIRING

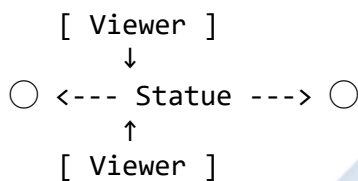


Note: Terra-cotta objects remain **porous** unless glazed — they can absorb water, which is why unglazed flower pots “breathe.”

2. SCULPTURE IN THE ROUND

- **Definition:** A type of sculpture that is **freestanding** — not attached to any background or wall.
- **Characteristic:** You can **walk around** it and view it from **all sides**.
- **Examples:** Statues, busts, and full-body figures.
- **Famous Example:** Michelangelo’s *David* and traditional African wooden figures.

Illustration:

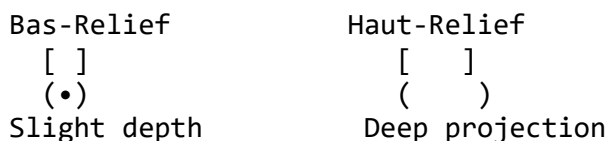


(The sculpture is visible and viewable from every direction.)

3. RELIEF SCULPTURE

- **Definition:** Relief sculpture is carved or modeled on a **flat background**, and the figures **project outward** from it.
- **Types of Relief:**
 - **Bas-Relief (Low Relief):** The projection is shallow — the design slightly rises from the surface. *Example:* The face on a coin.
 - **Haut-Relief (High Relief):** The projection is deeper — parts of the sculpture stand out boldly, almost completely detached from the background. *Example:* Ancient Egyptian or Greek temple carvings.

Illustration:



4. GREENWARE

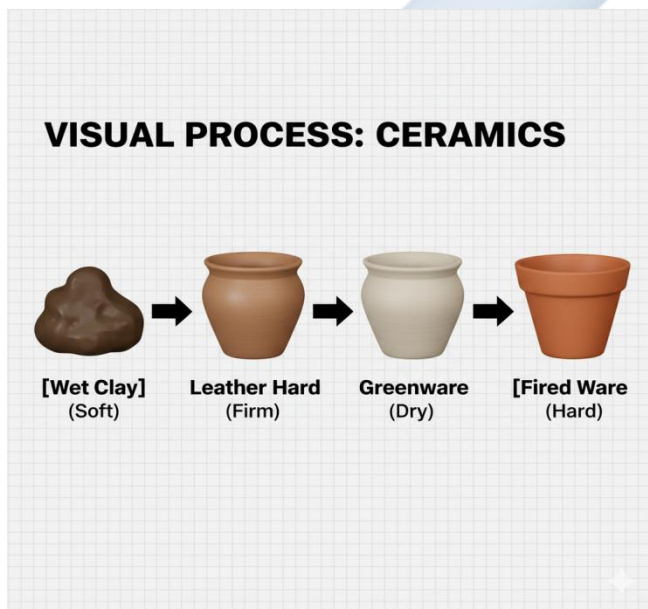
- **Definition:** Greenware is **unfired clay** that has been shaped and dried until **bone dry** but not yet fired in a kiln.
- **Characteristics:**

- Very **brittle** and **fragile**.
- Can easily **break or dissolve** when exposed to water.
- **Importance:** It is the **final stage** before firing in ceramics production.

Caution: If water touches greenware, it will turn back to mud!

5. LEATHER HARD

- **Definition:** This is the stage of clay that is **partially dry**. It still contains some moisture, making it firm but not completely hardened.
- **Uses:**
 - Ideal for **carving, joining, and refining details**.
 - Handles or decorations can be added easily at this stage.
- **Transition:** When left longer to dry, it becomes **greenware**.



6. MAQUETTE

- **Definition:** A *maquette* is a **small-scale model or prototype** of a sculpture.
- **Purpose:** Artists use maquettes to **test ideas, study composition, and experiment** before producing a large final piece.
- **Advantages:**
 - Saves time and materials.
 - Helps visualize proportions, balance, and posture.

- **Materials Used:** Clay, wax, wire, or plasticine.



Example: Before creating a monument, sculptors often build a small clay or wax maquette to show clients and plan construction.

KEY NOTES

- Every sculptor and potter must understand these stages of **material transformation**: Wet → **Leather Hard** → **Greenware** → **Bisque** → **Glazed** → **Finished**.
- Knowing when to carve, fire, or glaze clay determines the **quality and durability** of the final artwork.
- In relief and sculpture-in-the-round, understanding space, form, and texture is essential for achieving realism.

VISUAL SUMMARY

Term	Meaning / Description	Example / Illustration
Terra-Cotta	Baked reddish clay	Nok heads, flower pots
Sculpture in the Round	Freestanding, viewable all around	Michelangelo's <i>David</i>
Relief	Raised from flat background	Coins, temple carvings
Greenware	Dried but unfired clay	Fragile clay pot
Leather Hard	Partially dry, carvable	Clay mug ready for handle
Maquette	Small model of sculpture	Mini clay figure for monument

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is the main difference between *Sculpture in the Round* and *Relief Sculpture*?
 2. What does the term *Terra-Cotta* mean?
 3. Explain the difference between *Greenware* and *Leather Hard* clay.
 4. Why would a sculptor make a *Maquette* before a full sculpture?
 5. Give one common example of *Bas-Relief* in everyday objects.
-

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Using local clay or playdough, create a **small maquette** of any simple object (animal, vase, or human figure).
 2. Go outdoors and find some **ant-hill clay**. Test its texture. Is it the same as *Terra-Cotta*? Explain your answer in a short paragraph.
 3. Research and write briefly about one famous Nigerian *Terra-Cotta* artwork — mention its **origin**, **period**, and **features** (e.g., *Nok Head from Jemaa* or *Ife Bronze Heads*).
-

Teacher's Note / Class Activity Suggestion

- Bring samples or photos of **terracotta pots** and **Nok sculptures**.
- Demonstrate clay stages with real samples (wet → leather hard → dry).
- Show short video clips or images of **Bas-relief vs. Sculpture in the round** for visual clarity.
- Encourage students to touch, observe, and describe texture and form using the new terminologies.

SS1 VISUAL ARTS LESSON NOTES

THIRD TERM

WEEK 1: INTRODUCTION TO MODELLING I

INTRODUCTION

Welcome to **Third Term**! This term, we begin an exciting exploration of **3-Dimensional Art**, which deals with objects that have **height, width, and depth** — forms that occupy physical space.

In contrast to drawing (which is **2D**, on flat paper), **modelling** allows artists to **create, touch, and shape** real, tangible forms. Through this lesson, you will learn:

- The **meaning of modelling**
- The **basic forms** used to build 3D objects
- The **importance of clay** as a modelling material

By the end of this lesson, you should be able to identify the **additive process** of modelling, recognize **basic shapes** in real objects, and understand why **clay** is called the sculptor's best friend.

MEANING OF MODELLING

Definition: Modelling is a **sculptural process** in which an artist **creates a 3-dimensional form** by **adding and shaping** a soft, pliable material such as **clay, wax, or plasticine**.

It is one of the oldest and most direct methods of sculpture — the artist uses their **hands, tools, and imagination** to bring a form to life.

Characteristics of Modelling

- It is an **Additive Process** — you build up a form by adding small pieces of material together.
 - The artist **moulds** the material instead of cutting or chiselling it.
 - The work can be **altered, repaired, or reshaped** easily before drying.
 - It allows for **smooth surfaces, expressive textures, and fine detail**.
-

Additive vs. Subtractive Process

Process Type	Description	Material Example	Artist Action	Result
Additive (Modelling)	Adding material to build form	Clay, wax, plasticine	Build up, shape, mould	Flexible, detailed sculpture
Subtractive (Carving)	Removing material to reveal form	Wood, stone, ivory	Cut away, chip, scrape	Permanent, hard sculpture

Think of it this way:

- A **modeller** is a *builder* — they **add** clay to form shapes.
- A **carver** is a *digger* — they **remove** stone to reveal shapes.

BASIC CONCEPTS OF FORM BUILDING

Before you can model a realistic object, you must first learn to **see and think in 3D**. Every object — whether a car, a fruit, or a human body — can be broken down into **four basic forms**.

These are the **building blocks** of all 3D art.

The Four Basic Forms

Form	Description	Common Uses / Examples	Illustration
1. Sphere	Round, ball-like form. No edges or corners.	Head, eyeball, orange, globe	○
2. Cylinder	Has circular ends and straight sides.	Arms, legs, tree trunks, pipes	
3. Cube	Square box form with equal sides.	House, chest, boxes, tables	
4. Cone	Has a circular base tapering to a point.	Roof, hat, beak, nose	

Tip for Modellers: Always begin with **large, simple forms** (sphere, cube, etc.) before adding small details like fingers or facial features.

Form Building in Practice

To model a figure, **combine basic forms**:

- Head → Sphere
- Neck → Short Cylinder
- Chest → Cube or Oval

- Arms/Legs → Cylinders
- Nose → Cone

Illustrative Example:

O ← (Sphere for Head)
 | ← (Cylinder for Neck)
 [] ← (Cube for Chest)
 / \ ← (Cylinders for Legs)

Over time, these forms are **smoothed, refined, and detailed** to look realistic.

CLAY AS A MODELLING MATERIAL

Clay is the **most widely used material** for modelling because it is **soft, flexible, and expressive**.

What is Clay?

Clay is a **natural earthy material** composed mainly of **fine mineral particles** that become **plastic (mouldable)** when wet and **hard** when fired.

It is found in riverbeds, termite mounds, and beneath topsoil.

Why Clay Is the Sculptor's Best Friend

1. **Pliable (Soft and Mouldable):** You can easily shape it with your hands and simple tools.
2. **Expressive:** Clay records every movement — from your fingerprints to tool marks — giving life and texture to your work.
3. **Forgiving:** Made a mistake? Just add more clay or reshape it. It's easy to correct before drying.
4. **Versatile:** Can be used to make both **functional objects** (pots, plates) and **aesthetic sculptures** (figures, reliefs).
5. **Durable (When Fired):** Soft clay becomes **hard and permanent** after being baked in a **kiln** — this process creates **terracotta (baked earth)**.

Stages of Clay Transformation

Stage	Condition	Use / Property
Wet Clay	Soft, workable	Used for shaping and modelling
Leather Hard	Partially dry, firm	Can still be carved or joined
Greenware	Fully dry, unfired	Fragile and easily breakable
Bisque / Fired Clay	Baked and hardened	Permanent terracotta sculpture

VISUAL PROGRESSION: CERAMICS



PRACTICAL DEMONSTRATION IDEA

Materials: Clay, water bowl, modelling tools, small mat or board. **Activity:**

1. Roll clay into balls (spheres).
2. Shape some into cylinders, cones, and cubes.
3. Combine them to build a simple object — e.g., a bird, car, or human figure.
4. Observe how joining forms creates realistic shapes.

Encourage students to explore by touch — feeling form, weight, and balance helps them think in 3D.

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. Define **Modelling** in your own words.
2. Is modelling an **additive** or **subtractive** process?
3. Explain the **difference between modelling and carving**.
4. List the **four basic 3D forms** that artists use to build sculptures.
5. State **three reasons why clay** is an excellent modelling material.

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Choose an object around you (e.g., a bottle, car, or person).
 - In your sketchbook, draw it **using only the four basic forms** (sphere, cube, cylinder, cone).
2. What is a **subtractive process** in sculpture?
 - Give one **example of a material** used for carving.

3. If you were to model a simple **bird**, what forms would you use for:

- (a) Head
- (b) Body
- (c) Beak

VISUAL SUMMARY (DIAGRAM CHART)

Concept	Illustration	Explanation
Additive Modelling	✚ Clay added piece by piece	Building form by adding material
Subtractive Carving	— Stone chipped away	Creating form by removing material
Basic Forms	○	Sphere, Cube, Cylinder, Cone
Clay Stages	→ →	Wet → Dry → Fired (Terracotta)

TEACHER'S NOTE / CLASS DEMO SUGGESTION

- Bring samples of **clay**, **terracotta pots**, or **plasticine** for handling.
 - Display printed or digital images of **famous clay sculptures** (e.g., *Nok Heads*, *Benin Bronze Forms*, *Ife Terracotta*).
 - Let students **model simple objects** in small groups to build confidence in 3D visualization.
-

WEEK 2: INTRODUCTION TO MODELLING II

INTRODUCTION

Last week, we learned that **modelling** is a sculptural process that involves building forms by **adding and shaping** a soft material like clay. This week, we go deeper to understand the **material itself — CLAY**.

To model effectively, an artist must know:

- Where clay comes from,
- The **different types** of clay, and
- The **special properties** that make clay behave the way it does.

Understanding clay scientifically helps the artist to control it creatively — this is where **art meets geology**.

TYPES OF CLAY

Clay is **decomposed rock** formed through the **weathering** of **feldspar-rich rocks** (like granite). Over millions of years, rain, wind, and temperature changes break these rocks into microscopic particles. Depending on how far these particles travel, we have **two main types of clay**:

1. PRIMARY CLAY (RESIDUAL CLAY)

Origin: Primary clay is found **exactly where it was formed**. It has not been transported by natural forces such as water or wind.

Characteristics:

- **Purity:** Very pure — contains few impurities.
- **Color:** Usually **white** or pale.
- **Plasticity:** Has **low plasticity** — not very easy to shape; cracks easily.
- **Texture:** Coarse-grained (feels sandy).
- **Firing Temperature:** Very high; needs a lot of heat to mature.

Example: **Kaolin (China Clay)** Used in:

- Porcelain production
- Fine ceramics
- Chalk and paper fillers

- Toothpaste and cosmetic powder

Illustration:

Granite Rock → Weathered → Kaolin (White Clay)
Stays in Place → Primary Clay

2. SECONDARY CLAY (SEDIMENTARY CLAY)

Origin: Secondary clay is **transported** from its place of formation by water, wind, or glaciers and **deposited elsewhere** (riverbeds, valleys, or lakes).

Characteristics:

- **Impurities:** Picks up organic matter, iron oxide, and other minerals during transport.
- **Plasticity:** Very **plastic and flexible**, easy to shape and model.
- **Color:** Varies from **red, brown, grey, or black** depending on impurities.
- **Texture:** Fine-grained (smooth).
- **Firing Temperature:** Medium to low.

Examples:

- **Ball Clay** – very fine, plastic, used for blending.
- **Earthenware Clay (Terra-cotta)** – reddish-brown, porous, used for sculpture and pottery.
- **Stoneware Clay** – grey to brown, strong, used for durable wares.

Illustration:

Rock (Feldspar) → Weathered → Carried by Water → Deposited in Valley → Secondary Clay

COMPARISON TABLE: PRIMARY vs SECONDARY CLAY

Feature	Primary Clay	Secondary Clay
Place Found	At point of origin	Transported and redeposited
Purity	Very pure (few impurities)	Contains impurities
Plasticity	Low (harder to shape)	High (very flexible)
Texture	Coarse-grained	Fine-grained
Color	White or light	Red, brown, or grey
Example	Kaolin (China Clay)	Ball Clay, Earthenware, Stoneware

PROPERTIES OF CLAY

The **properties of clay** determine how artists can work with it — how it can be shaped, dried, and fired. There are **three essential properties** every modeller must understand:

1. PLASTICITY (AND PLIABILITY)

Definition: The ability of clay to be **shaped, stretched, bent, or molded** without breaking — and to hold that shape when released.

Scientific Basis: Clay particles are flat and plate-like (microscopic sheets). When mixed with water, these plates **slide over each other**, allowing flexibility.

Artistic Importance: Plasticity makes clay “alive” in the modeller’s hands. It’s what allows an artist to create smooth curves, muscles, or details like folds in clothing.

Analogy: Think of plasticity as the “softness” that allows bread dough to be kneaded and reshaped.

Illustration:

[Clay Particle Layers + Water → Slippery, Flexible Structure]

2. POROSITY

Definition: Porosity refers to the **tiny holes or pores** in clay that allow moisture and air to pass through.

Importance in Art:

- It allows clay to **dry gradually and evenly**.
- It prevents **explosions in the kiln**, because trapped water can escape as steam.
- It helps glazes adhere better after firing.

Analogy: Think of clay like a **sponge** — it holds water but lets it escape slowly.

Tip for Artists: Never put wet clay directly into the kiln — it must be bone dry first!

3. SHRINKAGE

Definition: Shrinkage is the **reduction in size** of a clay object as it **dries and is fired**.

Causes:

1. **Drying Shrinkage:**

- As water evaporates, clay particles move closer together.
- 2. **Firing Shrinkage:**
 - When fired, chemical water is removed and the clay fuses (vitrifies).

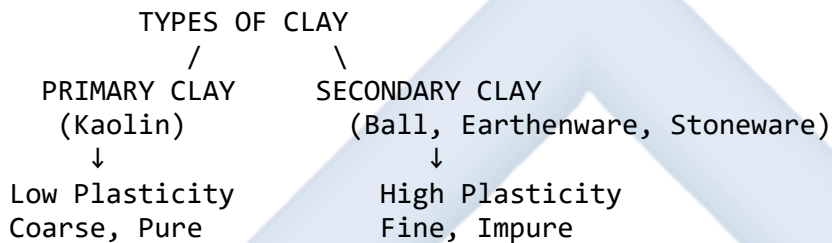
Result: The final piece can shrink **10%–15%** from its original size.

Illustration:

Wet Pot (10cm) → Dried Pot (9cm) → Fired Pot (8.5cm)

Practical Note: Artists must always **make their models slightly larger** to allow for shrinkage.

ILLUSTRATIVE SUMMARY DIAGRAM



CLASS ACTIVITY (PRACTICAL)

Demonstration: Bring samples of different clays (Kaolin and local red clay). Compare:

- Color
- Texture
- Plasticity (by hand shaping)
- Drying behavior

Observation Journal: Students record their observations under the headings — **Touch, Flexibility, Drying Time, Color after Drying.**

ASSESSMENT (WEEK 2)

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is the main difference between **Primary** and **Secondary** clay?
 2. Define **Plasticity** and explain why it is important for modellers.
 3. Why is **Porosity** essential when firing clay?
 4. What happens to clay as it **dries** and when it is **fired**?
 5. Which property of clay makes it **reduce in size** after firing?
-

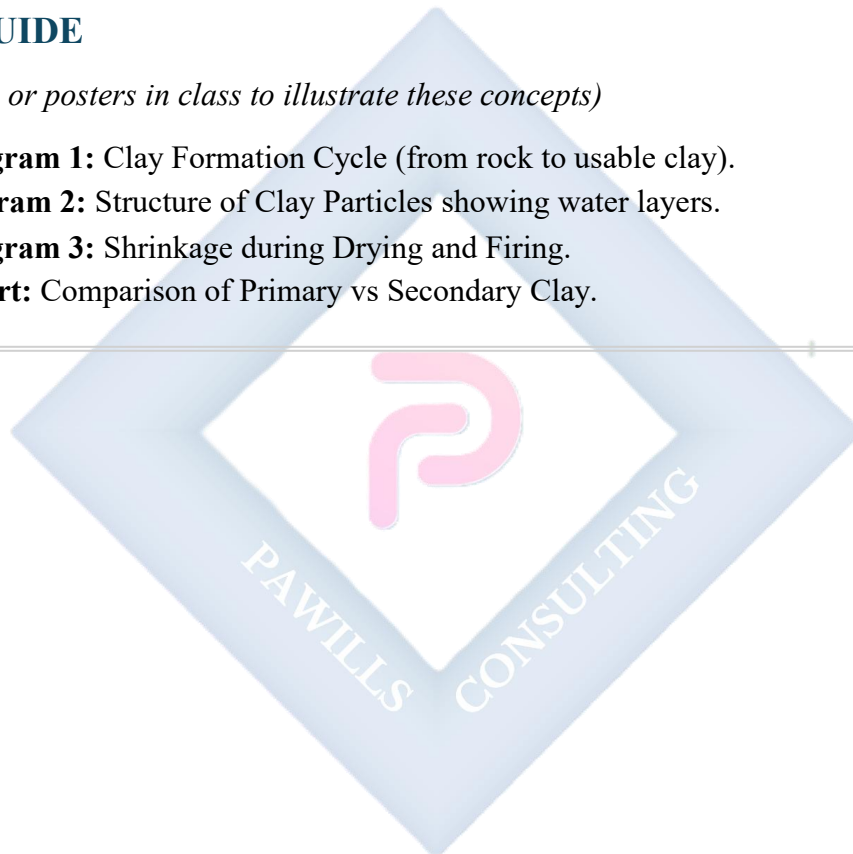
ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Why is Secondary clay **more plastic** than Primary clay?
2. What is **Kaolin**? Identify its type and two uses.
3. If you want to model a **detailed human figure**, which type of clay would you use — Primary or Secondary? Why?
4. If an artist wants a final pot to be **10 cm tall**, should they model it at exactly 10 cm? Explain.
5. Draw and label the **four basic stages of clay preparation** (Wet Clay → Leather Hard → Greenware → Fired).

VISUAL GUIDE

(Use diagrams or posters in class to illustrate these concepts)

- **Diagram 1:** Clay Formation Cycle (from rock to usable clay).
- **Diagram 2:** Structure of Clay Particles showing water layers.
- **Diagram 3:** Shrinkage during Drying and Firing.
- **Chart:** Comparison of Primary vs Secondary Clay.



WEEK 3: INTRODUCTION TO MODELLING III

INTRODUCTION

We have learned that **clay** is the foundation of all ceramic and sculptural modelling. We now understand **its types and properties** (plasticity, porosity, shrinkage). But the next big question is:

“How do we actually *shape* the clay into meaningful forms?”

This week’s lesson introduces:

- **The essential tools and equipment** used in ceramic modelling.
- **The three fundamental hand-building techniques** that every artist must master — *Pinching, Coiling, and Slabbing*.

Modelling is both **art and craft** — it combines creativity with skill, imagination with precision, and hands with tools.

CERAMIC TOOLS AND EQUIPMENT

While the artist’s **hands** are the most important tools for shaping clay, other tools help with *refinement, precision, and surface finishing*. These tools can be **man-made** (manufactured) or **natural** (sticks, shells, stones).

1. HANDS — THE PRIMARY TOOL

- The most powerful and expressive tool an artist has.
- Used for shaping, smoothing, pinching, and joining clay.
- The warmth of your hands helps soften and control the clay’s surface.

“Every fingerprint you leave behind gives the sculpture life and individuality.”

2. MODELLING TOOLS

- Small tools made of **wood, bamboo, or plastic**.
- Each end has a different shape — **pointed, curved, flat, or rounded**.
- Used for:
 - Carving details (eyes, lips, folds)

- Smoothing surfaces
- Refining contours

Illustration:

Modelling
Tool

← Used for shaping, smoothing, and detailing.

3. LOOP OR RIBBON TOOLS

- Have **metal loops** at their ends (often two-sided).
- Used for:
 - Hollowing thick clay (to prevent cracking during drying)
 - Trimming surfaces
 - Refining contours in sculptural modelling

Illustration:

Handle ——— (Loop Metal Wire)

Used to scoop out excess clay or hollow forms.

4. WIRE CUTTER (WIRE HARP)

- A thin **steel wire** with wooden handles on each end.
- Used for cutting large blocks of clay cleanly or slicing clay pieces evenly.

Tip: Always use a wire cutter instead of a knife to avoid uneven surfaces.

5. RIB OR KIDNEY TOOL

- Flat, **kidney-shaped** tool made of **wood, metal, or rubber**.
- Used for:
 - Smoothing and compressing walls of pots
 - Refining curved surfaces (especially on the potter's wheel)

Visual:

() ← Rib Tool (like a kidney shape)

6. SPATULA

- Flat wooden or metal blade used for smoothing, spreading slip, or scraping surfaces.

7. ROLLING PIN

- Used to roll clay into **flat, even slabs** (like rolling pastry dough).
- Essential for the **slabbing method**.

8. KILN (Firing Equipment)

- A **special high-temperature oven** where clay is “baked” (fired) to make it hard, durable, and permanent.
- Can be electric, gas, or wood-fired.
- Temperature: ranges from **800°C to 1300°C** depending on clay type.

Summary Table: Tools and Their Uses

Tool	Description	Main Use
Hands	Natural tool	Shaping and forming clay
Modelling Tools	Wooden/plastic tools	Detailing, carving, refining
Loop Tools	Metal loop ends	Hollowing and trimming
Wire Cutter	Wire with handles	Cutting large clay blocks
Rib (Kidney)	Flat curved tool	Smoothing surfaces
Rolling Pin	Cylindrical roller	Making flat slabs
Spatula	Flat wooden/metal blade	Spreading and smoothing
Kiln	Firing chamber	Hardening clay permanently

METHODS OF MOULDING (HAND-BUILDING TECHNIQUES)

Before machines or potter’s wheels, ancient sculptors built all clay forms **by hand**. These three **hand-building techniques** are the foundation of all ceramic and sculptural work.

1. PINCHING METHOD

Definition: The **oldest and simplest** method of shaping clay by pressing, pinching, and rotating it between the thumb and fingers.

Process:

1. Roll clay into a **smooth ball**.

2. Press your **thumb** into the center (not through the bottom).
3. **Pinch** the clay gently between thumb (inside) and fingers (outside).
4. Turn and shape the form evenly by rotating as you pinch.
5. Smooth with fingers or a rib.

Result: A small, rounded, evenly walled pot or bowl — called a **pinch pot**.

Best For: Small bowls, cups, or sculptural studies.

Illustration:

(1) Ball of Clay → (2) Thumb Press → (3) Pinching Rotation → (4) Small Pot

2. COILING METHOD

Definition: A method of building **larger or taller forms** by stacking long “snake-like” coils of clay.

Process:

1. Roll a **flat base** (pancake shape).
2. Roll long, even **coils or ropes** of clay.
3. **Score and Slip:**
 - Scratch the joining surfaces (score).
 - Apply liquid clay (slip) as glue.
4. Stack the coils one on top of another, forming a wall.
5. Blend coils together inside or outside to make a smooth surface.

Best For: Large vases, decorative pots, asymmetrical sculptures.

Illustration:

Coil Coil Coil
↑ ↑ ↑
Built up on Base
Joined by Score + Slip

3. SLABBING METHOD

Definition: A method for creating **flat-walled, geometric, and architectural** forms.

Process:

1. Roll out **flat slabs** using a rolling pin.

2. Allow them to reach **leather-hard** stage (partly stiff).
3. Cut shapes (squares, triangles, rectangles).
4. **Score and Slip** the edges.
5. Join edges at right angles to form boxes, houses, or abstract shapes.

Best For: Boxes, houses, tiles, wall reliefs, or any structure with straight edges.

Illustration:

[Slab 1] + [Slab 2] → Score + Slip → Joined Box Form

THE “SCORE AND SLIP” RULE

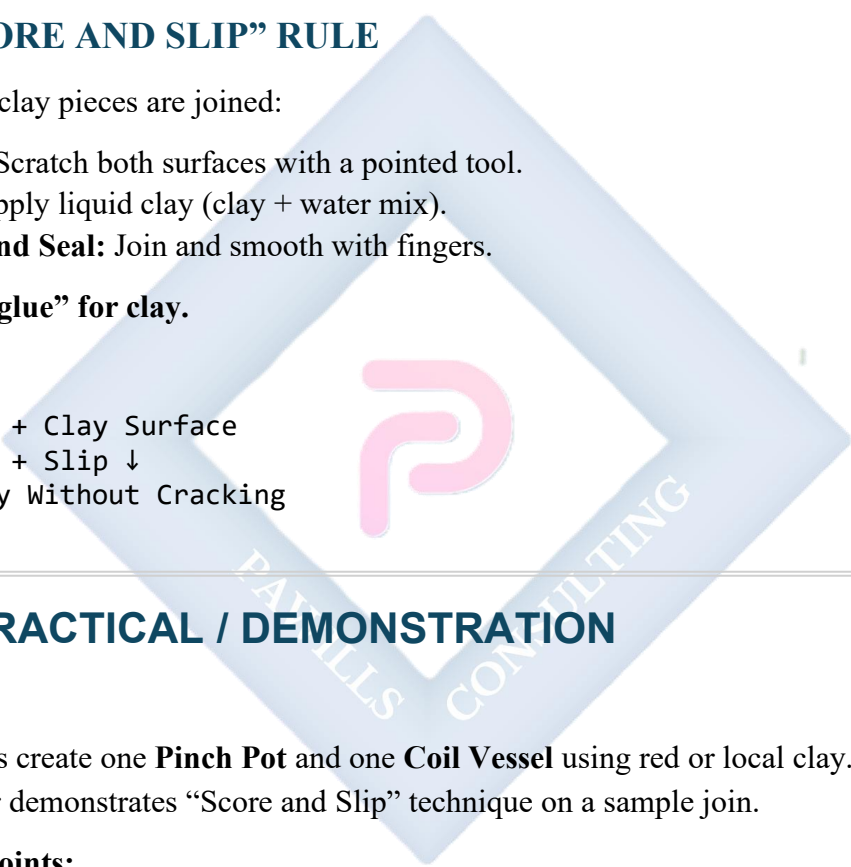
Whenever two clay pieces are joined:

1. **Score:** Scratch both surfaces with a pointed tool.
2. **Slip:** Apply liquid clay (clay + water mix).
3. **Press and Seal:** Join and smooth with fingers.

This acts like “glue” for clay.

Illustration:

Clay Surface + Clay Surface
↓ Score + Slip ↓
Joined Firmly Without Cracking



CLASS PRACTICAL / DEMONSTRATION

Activity:

- Students create one **Pinch Pot** and one **Coil Vessel** using red or local clay.
- Teacher demonstrates “Score and Slip” technique on a sample join.

Observation Points:

- Thickness of walls
- Evenness of form
- Smoothness of joints

Teacher’s Tip:

Keep your clay moist and cover unfinished work with plastic to prevent drying.

ASSESSMENT (WEEK 3)

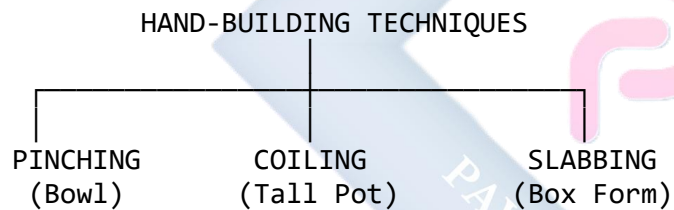
EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What are your two most important tools for modelling clay?
 2. What is a “Loop Tool” used for?
 3. What is the simplest and oldest method of hand-building?
 4. Describe the “Coiling” method briefly.
 5. What kind of shape is the “Slabbing” method best for creating?
-

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Explain what it means to **Score and Slip** and why this is necessary when joining clay.
 2. **Practical:** Using play-doh or soft clay, make a small **pinch pot** and observe how it dries.
 3. What is a **rib tool** and what is it used for?
 4. Which of the three hand-building methods would you use to make a **house-shaped model**, and why?
 5. Draw and label simple diagrams showing the **three hand-building techniques**.
-

SUMMARY DIAGRAM (Visual Recap)



WEEK 4: INTRODUCTION TO MODELLING IV

TOPIC: Drying, Firing, and Finishing of Clay Works

SUB-TOPIC: Processes and Techniques of Finalizing Clay Models

INTRODUCTION

At this stage, you have shaped your clay into a pot, a bowl, or a sculpture using **pinching**, **coiling**, or **slabbing**. However, that object is still **fragile and temporary** — just *wet mud*. To transform it into a **strong, durable, and beautiful piece of art**, it must undergo **drying**, **firing**, and **finishing**.

These three processes determine whether your clay work will **survive or crack**, **remain soft or harden**, **stay dull or shine beautifully**. Understanding and carefully applying these stages is what separates a **craft learner** from a **skilled ceramic artist**.

CONTENT

1. PROCESSES OF DRYING CLAY WORKS

Drying is **the most critical stage** in ceramics. Over **90% of ceramic failures** occur during drying due to **uneven moisture loss**.

A. Stages of Dryness

Stage	Description	Characteristics	What You Can Do
Wet Clay	Freshly worked clay.	Soft, cool, dark, pliable.	Shaping, moulding, joining pieces.
Leather Hard	Partially dried; water evaporated slightly.	Firm but still damp; carvable; slightly flexible.	Carving, trimming, adding handles or decorations.
Bone Dry (Greenware)	Fully dried clay ready for firing.	Pale, brittle, room-temperature, chalky surface.	Handle with extreme care; prepare for firing.

Tip: “Greenware” is like dry wood—it *looks dry*, but if you rush it, it will crack or explode during firing.

B. Why Dry Slowly?

- **Uneven drying** causes **cracks** or **warping**.
- **Fast drying** (especially under direct sunlight) makes the outer layer shrink before the inner layer, causing **stress fractures**.

- **Proper drying** ensures the clay particles settle evenly and retain their form.

C. How to Dry Properly

1. **Place in a cool, shaded area.**
2. **Cover loosely** with a **plastic bag** or **cloth** to slow moisture loss.
3. **Turn or rotate** the object occasionally for even drying.
4. **Avoid direct sunlight or heat.**

2. FIRING OF CLAY WORKS

Firing transforms **dry clay (greenware)** into **hard, durable ceramic**. This is done in a special oven called a **kiln**.

A. The Kiln

A **kiln** is a **high-temperature furnace** used to bake and strengthen clay.

- Temperature range: **800°C – 1300°C**
- Made of **heat-resistant bricks**
- Can be **electric, gas, or wood-fired**

B. The Process of Firing

1. **Loading the kiln:** Arrange bone-dry pots carefully so they don't touch.
2. **Slow heating:** Gradually raise temperature to allow residual moisture to escape.
3. **Vitrification:** At high heat, clay particles **melt and fuse**, forming a **hard, glass-like** material.
4. **Cooling:** The kiln must cool slowly to prevent cracking from thermal shock.

Caution: Never fire wet or damp clay! The trapped water becomes **steam**, expands rapidly, and can **explode**, damaging the pot and others in the kiln.

C. Two Stages of Firing

Stage	Name	Purpose	Result / Appearance
First Firing	Bisque Firing	Permanently hardens the clay and removes chemical water.	Porous, reddish or white ceramic (bisqueware).
Second Firing	Glaze Firing	Melts glaze onto the bisqueware for strength and waterproofing.	Smooth, shiny, colourful surface.

3. FINISHING TECHNIQUES

Once a pot is bisque-fired, it can be **decorated, polished, or glazed** to enhance its appearance and usability.

A. Glazing

Glazing is applying a **liquid glass mixture** that, when fired, melts into a glossy, waterproof coating.

Steps:

1. Clean the bisque pot of dust.
2. Apply glaze by **dipping, brushing, or spraying**.
3. Allow to dry completely.
4. Fire in the kiln again at glaze temperature.

Result: A bright, glassy surface — decorative and functional.

Example: Glazed teacups, flower vases, and ceramic plates.

B. Burnishing

A natural polishing technique done before firing.

- Rub the surface with a **smooth stone or spoon** while it's leather-hard.
- Produces a **soft sheen** without glaze.

Traditional African potters often burnish using **river pebbles** or **gourd fragments** to achieve a glossy, earthy finish.

C. Painting

After bisque firing, paint the pot using **acrylic or oil paints**.

- Used for decorative sculptures, not for food containers.
- Can be sealed with **varnish** for shine.

ILLUSTRATIVE DIAGRAMS

Diagram 1: Stages of Clay Dryness

[Wet Clay] → [Leather Hard] → [Bone Dry]
(soft) (firm) (brittle)

Diagram 2: Two Stages of Firing

Greenware → (Bisque Firing) → Bisqueware → (Glaze Firing) → Glazed Pottery

Diagram 3: Burnishing

[Leather Hard Pot]



Rub with smooth stone → Shiny surface before firing

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What are the three main stages of clay dryness?
2. Why should clay be dried slowly before firing?
3. What is “vitrification,” and why is it important?
4. Distinguish between bisque firing and glaze firing.
5. What is the purpose of glazing in pottery?
6. Why can't you paint a greenware piece with acrylics?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Explain what happens to clay during firing. Include the word “vitrification.”
2. List and describe three ways to finish a ceramic object after firing.
3. Practical: Use a small clay or dough piece and try burnishing it with a spoon. Record what happens.
4. Research and write about how **traditional Nigerian potters** (e.g., in **Ile-Ife, Bwari, or Ushafa**) dry and fire their pots without modern kilns.

VISUAL SUMMARY BOARD

PROCESS	TOOL / EQUIPMENT	RESULT / PRODUCT
Drying	Air, Plastic Cover	Bone-Dry Clay
Firing	Kiln	Hard Ceramic (Bisqueware)
Finishing	Glaze, Stone, Paint	Decorated Pottery

EXTENSION ACTIVITY (For Advanced Learners)

- Visit a **local pottery workshop** or watch an online documentary on “**African Pottery Firing Techniques**.”
 - Observe how potters control drying and firing using **smoke pits, bonfires, or gas kilns**.
 - Sketch a labelled diagram showing the layout of a **traditional pit kiln**.
-

WEEK 6: HISTORICAL FOUNDATION OF NIGERIAN ARTS I

TOPIC: The Beginnings of Nigerian Art

SUB-TOPIC: The Nok Culture — The Birth of African Sculpture

INTRODUCTION

For the next few weeks, we are stepping back in time — thousands of years — to explore the **origins and evolution of Nigerian art**. Before the arrival of Europeans, before colonialism, and before modern painting, our ancestors created **powerful and sophisticated artworks** that amazed the world.

These ancient works, discovered by archaeologists, show that **Nigeria has one of the oldest and richest art histories in Africa**. They are evidence that the people of this region were **skilled, organized, spiritual, and deeply artistic** long before written history.

This week, we begin our journey with the **Nok Culture**, the oldest known art tradition in Nigeria — the foundation upon which later civilizations like **Ife** and **Benin** built their legacies.

CONTENT

1. GENERAL OVERVIEW OF ANCIENT NIGERIAN ART (c. 200 BC – 1900 AD)

This long period — called the **Classical or Ancient Era of Nigerian Art** — includes major art-producing cultures such as:

- **Nok Culture** (900 BC – 300 AD) — The earliest known in West Africa.
- **Ife Art** (12th – 15th century) — Famous for naturalistic bronze and terra-cotta heads.
- **Benin Art** (15th – 19th century) — Renowned for bronze plaques and royal sculptures.
- **Igbo-Ukwu Art** (9th century) — Known for intricate bronze and glass works.

These cultures were **highly advanced** — showing evidence of:

- Organized societies with leadership and religion.
- Specialized craftsmanship and artistic training.
- Trade, communication, and cultural symbolism.

Did You Know? The art of these ancient Nigerian cultures is studied in major universities and museums around the world — including the **British Museum (London)** and **Louvre Museum (Paris)** — where Nok, Ife, and Benin pieces are exhibited as masterpieces of world art.

2. NOK ART (c. 900 BC – 300 AD)

A. DISCOVERY

- **Location:** Central Nigeria, mainly **Jos Plateau, Kaduna, and Nasarawa States**.
- **Village:** The first sculptures were found in **Nok village**, hence the name *Nok Culture*.
- **Year of Discovery: 1943**
- **Discovered by:** **Tin miners** who accidentally unearthed clay heads while mining.
- **Archaeologist: Bernard Fagg**, a British archaeologist, led scientific studies and excavation.

Illustration: Archaeological Discovery Scene

[Tin Miners Digging] → [Unearth Terracotta Head] → [Archaeologists Study] → [Nok Art Identified]

B. MATERIAL USED

All Nok sculptures were made from **terra-cotta**, meaning **baked or fired clay**.

- The clay was shaped by hand (modelled) and fired in an open pit or primitive kiln.
- No metal or stone tools were used; everything was shaped manually.

“Terra-cotta” comes from Italian words meaning “baked earth.”

C. STYLISTIC FEATURES (HOW TO RECOGNIZE NOK ART)

The Nok style is **unique, symbolic, and easily identifiable**. Below are its main characteristics:

Feature	Description	Illustration / Notes
Material	Terra-cotta (baked clay)	Brownish-red color after firing
Subject Matter	Mostly human heads and figures; sometimes animals	Often representing leaders, warriors, or ancestors
Head Proportion	Large heads in relation to body	May symbolize wisdom or spiritual power
Eyes	Triangular, semi-circular, or D-shaped openings	The most distinctive Nok feature
Perforations (Holes)	In eyes, nostrils, mouth, and ears	Allowed air to escape during firing — prevented explosions

Feature	Description	Illustration / Notes
Hairstyles	Elaborate, braided, coiled, or plaited	Shows ancient African beauty culture
Jewellery / Ornaments	Necklaces, beads, bangles	Represented status and adornment
Style	Semi-naturalistic — not fully realistic but recognizable	Balanced between abstraction and realism

D. SYMBOLISM AND CULTURAL SIGNIFICANCE

Nok art was **not just decoration** — it was deeply **spiritual and symbolic**.

- Likely connected to **ancestor worship** or **fertility rituals**.
- The emphasis on heads shows belief in the **head as the seat of wisdom, identity, and power**.
- The high level of craftsmanship suggests **specialized artists** and a **structured society**.
- Nok art may have influenced later Nigerian art traditions such as **Ifé** and **Benin**.

Cultural Link: Nok → Ifé → Benin — This artistic evolution shows how Nigerian art grew in sophistication over time.

E. VISUAL ANALYSIS: NOK HEAD

Typical Nok Head Sculpture:



These heads often express dignity, spirituality, and calmness, suggesting they may have represented revered individuals or deities.

F. SIGNIFICANCE OF NOK CULTURE

1. Historical Importance

- Oldest known civilization in Nigeria (over 2,000 years old).
- Provides evidence of early social organization and religion.

2. Technological Achievement

- Demonstrated early mastery of **terra-cotta firing**.
- Artists understood air control, clay composition, and firing temperature.

3. Artistic Achievement

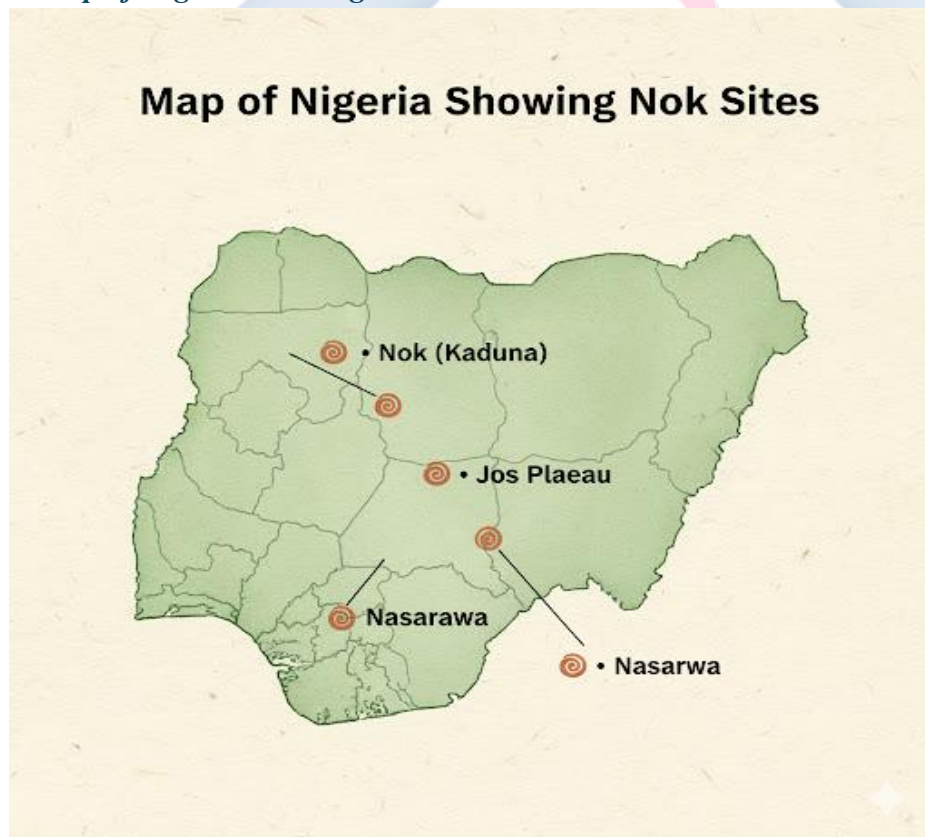
- The balance of naturalism and stylization set a foundation for African art aesthetics.
- Its expressive power continues to inspire modern Nigerian sculptors.

4. Archaeological Legacy

- Nok artifacts have been found across over **500 km** of central Nigeria.
- Many are preserved in the **National Museum, Jos**.

ILLUSTRATIVE GRAPHICS / VISUAL BOARD

1. Map of Nigeria Showing Nok Sites



2. Comparison Chart

Culture	Period	Material	Style	Location
Nok	900 BC – 300 AD	Terra-cotta	Semi-naturalistic	Central Nigeria
Ife	12th – 15th C.	Bronze, Terra-cotta	Naturalistic	Southwestern Nigeria
Benin	15th – 19th C.	Bronze, Ivory	Stylized	Southern Nigeria

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What is meant by the “Classical Era” of Nigerian Art?
2. Where was Nok art first discovered and by whom?
3. What material was used by the Nok artists?
4. Describe two physical features that make Nok heads easily recognizable.
5. Why did Nok artists make holes (perforations) in their sculptures?
6. What is the significance of the head in Nok sculpture?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Draw a simple **Nok Head** in your sketchbook. Include:
 - Triangular eyes
 - Perforated mouth and nose
 - Elaborate hairstyle or ornaments
2. Define **Terra-cotta** and explain why it was important in Nok art.
3. In 5–7 sentences, explain what the **existence of Nok art** reveals about early Nigerian societies.

TEACHER’S NOTES / DEMONSTRATION IDEAS

- **Visual Aids:** Use photographs or slides of Nok sculptures from museums.
- **Hands-On Activity:** Have students model a **miniature Nok head** using local clay or playdough.
- **Discussion Prompt:** “What do hairstyles and ornaments in Nok sculptures tell us about the people’s culture?”
- **Integration with History:** Connect with lessons on early civilizations and iron-working in Nigeria.

SUMMARY BOARD

Aspect	Details
Culture Name	Nok

Aspect	Details
Date Range	c. 900 BC – 300 AD
Location	Central Nigeria (Jos Plateau, Kaduna, Nasarawa)
Material	Terra-cotta
Style	Semi-naturalistic with triangular eyes, perforations, and elaborate hairstyles
Significance	Oldest evidence of organized artistic civilization in Sub-Saharan Africa



WEEK 8: HISTORICAL FOUNDATION OF NIGERIAN ARTS II

INTRODUCTION

Last week, we studied the **Nok culture**—the earliest known Nigerian art civilization famous for its *terra-cotta sculptures*.

This week, we journey further into two other **brilliant art traditions** that flourished centuries later:

- **Igbo-Ukwu Art** (c. 9th century AD)
- **Ife Art** (c. 12th–15th century AD)

Both cultures are **proof of Nigeria's deep artistic and technological sophistication** long before contact with Europe. They demonstrate mastery in metal casting, design, and symbolism — and represent two of the **greatest artistic civilizations in Africa**.

IGBO-UKWU ART (c. 9th Century AD)

1. DISCOVERY

- **Location:** Igbo-Ukwu town, near Awka in **Anambra State (Southeastern Nigeria)**.
- **Discovered by:** *Isaiah Anozie* in 1938, while digging a well.
- **Excavated by:** *Thurston Shaw* in the 1950s.
- **Context:** Three main archaeological sites were found —
 - **Igbo-Isaiah:** A shrine or ritual store.
 - **Igbo-Richard:** A burial chamber of a high-status figure (possibly a priest-king or Eze Nri).
 - **Igbo-Jonah:** A cache of ritual and ceremonial objects.

These discoveries revealed **Nigeria's earliest known bronze works**, centuries older than those of Benin or Europe's medieval bronzes.

2. MATERIAL

- Igbo-Ukwu art was made primarily of **bronze** — a metal alloy of **copper and tin** (sometimes mixed with lead).
- No evidence of local smelting furnaces was found, which suggests **imported metal**, but **indigenous craftsmanship**.

3. STYLISTIC FEATURES

CASTING TECHNIQUE

- Used the **Lost-Wax Casting** method (*Cire Perdue*). This technique involves:
 - a. Sculpting a detailed model in wax.
 - b. Covering it with clay and heating it.
 - c. The wax melts out, leaving a hollow mold.
 - d. Molten bronze is poured in and solidified.
 - e. The clay mold is broken off, revealing the metal sculpture.

Illustration: LOST WAX PROCESS

Wax Model → Clay Mould → Heating (wax melts) → Pour molten bronze → Break mould → Finished Bronze

DETAIL AND COMPLEXITY

- Igbo-Ukwu bronzes are **extremely intricate**, covered with fine surface details and **woven, rope-like textures**.
- Every piece is hand-crafted — not mass-produced — showing **meticulous craftsmanship**.

MOTIFS & SYMBOLISM

- Common designs include:
 - **Spirals and ropes** – symbolizing continuity and unity.
 - **Insects and snails** – symbols of patience, life, and regeneration.
 - **Geometric patterns** – representing cosmic order and spiritual harmony.

OBJECT TYPES

- **Ritual Vessels** (such as the famous “Roped Pot”)
- **Pendants and Jewelry**
- **Ceremonial Staffs**
- **Altar Stands and Bowls**

4. SIGNIFICANCE

- Proves that **ancient Igbo societies** had:
 - **Complex leadership structures**

- **Advanced metalworking knowledge**
- **Religious and ceremonial sophistication**
- It is one of the **earliest known bronze traditions in Africa**, older than Europe's.

ILLUSTRATION

Visual Representation: IGBO-UKWU BRONZE OBJECTS

- [🌀] Roped Vessel
- [🐌] Snail-pattern Bowl
- [🌀] Ritual Pendant

(Insert images of the “Roped Pot,” bronze bowls, and pendants from museum collections for classroom display.)

IFE ART (c. 12th – 15th Century AD)

1. DISCOVERY

- **Location:** Ile-Ife, **Osun State**, the spiritual home of the Yoruba people.
- **Context:** Found around **royal compounds**, shrines, and the palace of the **Ooni of Ife**.
- **Discovered by:** German explorer **Leo Frobenius (1910)**, who was so amazed that he claimed they must have come from “Atlantis” — because he could not believe Africans made such realistic art!

2. MATERIALS

- Ife artists worked with:
 - **Bronze and Brass** (for royal sculptures)
 - **Terra-cotta (Clay)** (for everyday and ritual use)
 - **Quartz and Stone** (for sacred carvings)

3. STYLISTIC FEATURES

IDEALIZED NATURALISM

- The defining hallmark of Ife art.
- Figures are portrayed as **realistic human beings**, but in their **ideal and perfect state** — calm, symmetrical, and graceful.

SERENE EXPRESSIONS

- Faces are emotionless, dignified, and still — representing **spiritual wisdom, patience, and divine calm.**

STRIATIONS (SCARIFICATIONS)

- Fine parallel lines across the face or neck — symbolic of:
 - Clan identity or beauty marks.
 - Beaded face veils of royalty.

PROPORTIONS

- Heads are slightly larger than normal (about one-third of total body height).
- In Yoruba belief, the **head (Ori)** represents destiny, consciousness, and divine guidance.

TECHNICAL SKILL

- Demonstrates deep knowledge of anatomy, proportion, and metal casting.
- Surfaces are polished smooth, showing exceptional realism.

4. SIGNIFICANCE

- Ife art represents the **apex of classical African naturalism.**
- It profoundly influenced **Benin art**, as Benin artists adopted and built upon Ife bronze-casting traditions.
- Ife art proved to the world that **precolonial African civilizations were artistically and technologically advanced.**

ILLUSTRATION

Visual Representation: IFE BRONZE HEAD

- [👑] Smooth, symmetrical facial structure
- [~] Fine vertical striations
- [] Beaded crown and neck ornaments



COMPARISON TABLE: IGBO-UKWU vs IFE ART

Feature	Igbo-Ukwu Art	Ife Art
Date	9th Century AD	12th–15th Century AD
Location	Anambra State	Osun State
Material	Bronze (Copper Alloy)	Bronze, Brass, Terra-cotta, Quartz
Technique	Lost-Wax Casting	Lost-Wax Casting
Style	Highly Ornamental, Decorative	Naturalistic, Idealized Realism

Feature	Igbo-Ukwu Art	Ife Art
Purpose	Religious and Ceremonial	Royal Portraits and Spiritual Representation
Symbolism	Insects, Spirals, Snails	Scarification, Serenity, Ori (Head)

SUMMARY NOTES

- Igbo-Ukwu and Ife arts represent **two peaks of ancient Nigerian artistic achievement**.
- Both reveal a **continuity of cultural sophistication and technical mastery**.
- Together, they demonstrate that **Nigeria has one of the longest, richest art traditions in human history**.

ASSESSMENT (IN-CLASS)

1. Where was Igbo-Ukwu art discovered, and by whom?
2. Explain the **Lost-Wax Casting** method used by Igbo-Ukwu and Ife artists.
3. What is the major stylistic difference between Igbo-Ukwu and Ife art?
4. What do the **striations** on Ife heads represent?
5. Why was the discovery of Ife art significant to world history?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Create a **two-column chart** comparing Igbo-Ukwu and Ife art (use materials, style, and meaning).
2. Make a **sketch** of either an Igbo-Ukwu bronze pot or an Ife bronze head. Label at least 3 features.
3. In 100 words, explain why Ife art is described as “*Idealized Naturalism*.”

VISUAL LEARNING RECOMMENDATIONS

For classroom enrichment:

- Display **museum images** from the **National Museum, Lagos**, or **British Museum collections** (Ife and Igbo-Ukwu bronzes).
- Use **3D clay models** or **printed templates** to show casting stages.
- Watch short clips (YouTube: “Ife Art – Nigeria’s Classical Heritage”).

WEEK 9: HISTORICAL FOUNDATION OF NIGERIAN ARTS III

INTRODUCTION

This week, we explore one of Africa's greatest and most powerful art traditions — the **Art of the Benin Kingdom** — as well as related art forms from **Owo** and **Tsoede**.

The **Benin Kingdom (Edo people)** was one of the most advanced African states in governance, trade, and art long before colonial times. Its **royal bronze and ivory artworks** are now among the most famous cultural treasures in the world.

We will also study how **Owo** and **Tsoede** developed unique hybrid art styles influenced by both **Ifè** and **Benin** — showing the **interconnectedness of ancient Nigerian civilizations**.

BENIN ART (c. 14th – 19th Century AD)

1. DISCOVERY & CONTEXT

- **Location:** Benin City, in **Edo State**, South-South Nigeria.
 - **People:** The **Edo people**, ruled by the **Oba of Benin**.
 - **Ifè Connection:**
 - According to oral tradition, the **Oba of Benin (Oguola)** sent to the **Ooni of Ifè** for a skilled bronze caster.
 - The Ooni sent a master artist named **Iguegha (or Ighe-Ighae)**.
 - From this exchange, **Benin's royal bronze-casting guild (Igun Eronmwon)** was founded.
 - **End of the Classical Era (1897):**
 - In 1897, the **British Punitive Expedition** invaded Benin, exiled the Oba (Ovonramwen Nogbaisi), and looted thousands of bronze and ivory artworks.
 - These artworks were taken to museums in **London, Berlin, Paris, and New York**, where most still remain.
-

2. MATERIALS

Benin artists worked mainly with:

- **Bronze and Brass** – used for plaques, royal heads, and commemorative figures.
- **Ivory** – carved into masks, tusks, and ornaments.
- **Wood** – for palace doors and altars.

The artists were members of a **hereditary guild**, the *Igun Eronmwon*, who lived and worked within the **royal palace compound**.

3. STYLISTIC FEATURES

EVOLUTION OF STYLE

- **Early Period:** Highly **naturalistic**, similar to Ife art.
- **Later Periods:** Became **stylized**, more symbolic, and **hierarchical** — emphasizing power and order rather than realism.

HIERARCHICAL SCALE

A major feature of Benin art is **hierarchical scale**, meaning:

The most important person (usually the Oba) is shown larger than everyone else.

Illustration:

Visual: BENIN RELIEF PLAQUE

- [👑 Oba - Large and Central]
- [🛡️ Guards - Medium-sized]
- [👤♂ Servants - Small]

This technique communicates **rank, power, and divine status**.



OBJECT TYPES

1. **Bronze Heads**

- Represented **Obas (kings)** and **Queen Mothers (Iyoba)**.
- Placed on royal altars during ancestral ceremonies.
- They are not portraits of specific people, but **idealized representations of royal dignity**.

Features:

- Large, heavy neck collars made of coral beads.
- Calm, composed facial expression.

- Elaborate headdresses symbolizing authority.

Example: *Head of an Oba, Benin (16th century)*

2. Ivory Carvings

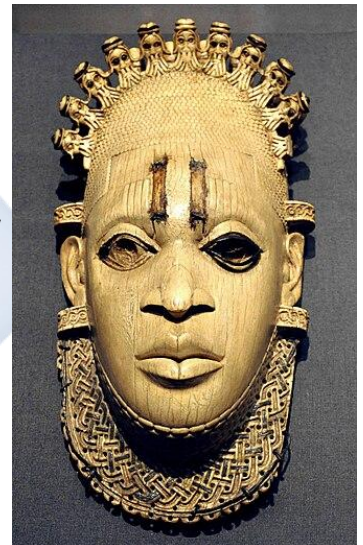
- Ivory was sacred and associated with **purity and royalty**.
- Artists carved **pendants, tusks, horns, and masks**.
- The most famous is the **Queen Idia Mask**, carved from ivory and inlaid with iron and copper.

Queen Idia (The "Benin Ivory Mask")

- Represents **Queen Mother Idia**, mother of Oba Esigie (16th century).
- Worn during ceremonies of victory and remembrance.
- Shows **delicate carving, serene expression**, and a **crown of Portuguese heads and mudfish** — symbolizing trade and divine power.

Illustration: QUEEN IDIA MASK (Simplified)

- [🏰] Crown with tiny Portuguese heads
- [] Smooth ivory face
- [🐟] Mudfish motifs symbolizing the Oba's spiritual duality



3. Bronze Plaques

- Thin, rectangular **bronze panels** cast in *bas-relief* (low relief).
- Used to **decorate the wooden pillars** of the Oba's palace.
- Subjects include:
 - Obas in full regalia
 - Warriors and attendants
 - Court scenes
 - Portuguese traders (with hats and muskets)
- Each plaque functioned as a **visual historical record**, preserving the culture, politics, and achievements of the kingdom.

Illustration:

Visual: BENIN BRONZE PLAQUE

	👑 Oba (large, center figure)	
	⚔️ Warriors and attendants	
	🌐 Portuguese visitor with gun	

4. FUNCTION AND MEANING

Benin artworks were not made for decoration alone. They served **spiritual, historical, and ceremonial purposes**:

- **Ancestral Veneration:** To honor past Obas and Queen Mothers.
- **Political Propaganda:** To record victories and legitimize royal authority.
- **Spiritual Connection:** To maintain balance between the human and divine worlds.

OWO ART (c. 15th Century AD)

1. LOCATION

- **Owo**, a Yoruba town in **Ondo State**, Southwest Nigeria.
- Strategically located **between Ife and Benin**, making it a cultural bridge between both traditions.

2. MATERIAL

- Primarily **terra-cotta (clay)** figures and fragments, as well as some **ivory carvings**.

3. STYLISTIC FEATURES

- Owo art is a **hybrid** — combining elements of **Ife's naturalism** and **Benin's royal symbolism**.

Features include:

- Naturalistic faces similar to Ife.
- Decorative regalia and headdresses like Benin.
- Complex surface ornamentation and carved details.
- Calm, idealized expressions.

Illustration: OWO TERRACOTTA FIGURE

[👤] Calm face (Ife style)

- [♂] Beaded collars and hat (Benin style)
- [] Terracotta material

Significance: Owo art shows that **artistic knowledge and styles were shared** among the kingdoms of Ife, Benin, and Owo — proving strong inter-regional cultural exchange.

TSOEDE BRONZE (NUPE AREA)

1. LOCATION & LEGEND

- Found along the **Niger River** around **Tsoede, Jebba, and Giragi** in **Nupe land (Middle Belt, Nigeria)**.
- Named after **Tsoede**, a legendary hero who fled **Idah (Igala land)** and founded the **Nupe Kingdom** in the 15th century.

2. MATERIAL & STYLE

- Made of **bronze** using the **lost-wax process**.
- The figures are large and heavy, often depicting:
 - Chiefs, warriors, or symbolic deities.
 - Stylized but showing traces of **Ife's naturalism**.
- Unique details and local patterns suggest a **fusion of Northern and Southern Nigerian artistic traditions**.

3. SIGNIFICANCE

- Represents early **intercultural contact and migration** of metalworking knowledge across Nigeria.
- Links the **Ife–Benin–Igala–Nupe cultural corridor** of artistic exchange.

COMPARATIVE SUMMARY TABLE

Feature	Benin Art	Owo Art	Tsoede Bronze
Date	14th – 19th Century	15th Century	15th Century
Location	Edo State	Ondo State	Niger Region
Material	Bronze, Brass, Ivory	Terra-cotta	Bronze
Influence	Ife	Ife & Benin	Ife & Igala
Style	Stylized, Hierarchical	Hybrid, Naturalistic	Mixed, Symbolic
Main	Plaques, Heads, Ivory	Terracotta Figures	Large Bronze Figures

Feature	Benin Art	Owo Art	Tsoede Bronze
Objects	Masks		
Purpose	Royal, Historical, Spiritual	Ceremonial, Cultural	Commemorative, Symbolic

SUMMARY NOTES

- **Benin art** represents the **pinnacle of royal art in Nigeria**, combining spirituality, power, and historical record.
- **Owo art** serves as a **cultural bridge**, blending Ife's realism with Benin's regal symbolism.
- **Tsoede bronzes** reveal the **spread of metal artistry** and mythic connections across central Nigeria.
- Together, these traditions show that **ancient Nigerian art was dynamic, interconnected, and highly advanced** — not isolated or primitive as once thought.

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. According to Benin legend, where did the people learn bronze casting?
2. What was the 1897 Punitive Expedition, and how did it affect Benin art?
3. Define *hierarchical scale* in art.
4. What was the function of the Benin bronze plaques?
5. Why is Owo art described as a hybrid of Ife and Benin styles?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Compare an **Ife head** and a **Benin head** in terms of (a) style and (b) function.
2. Who was **Tsoede**, and what artworks are named after him?
3. Find and describe the **Queen Idia Mask** (material, features, and meaning).

VISUAL AIDS & CLASSROOM ILLUSTRATIONS

Topic	Suggested Visual	Description
Benin Bronzes	![Placeholder: Benin Plaque Diagram]	Relief showing Oba with attendants
Queen Idia Mask	![Placeholder: Queen Idia Ivory Mask]	Ivory mask of Benin queen mother
Owo Terracotta	![Placeholder: Owo Figure]	Terracotta figure with Benin-style headdress
Tsoede Bronze	![Placeholder: Bronze Figure]	Nupe bronze statue with stylized features

Would you like me to **generate high-quality vector illustrations** of the following for this lesson?

1. *Benin Bronze Plaque (showing hierarchical scale)*
2. *Queen Idia Ivory Mask (simplified line art)*
3. *Owo Terracotta Figure (Ife-Benin blend)*
4. *Tsoede Bronze Figure (stylized form)*



WEEK 10: HISTORICAL FOUNDATION OF NIGERIAN ARTS IV

TOPIC:

Later Classical Nigerian Art Traditions — Esie Soapstone Figures, Ibibio Ekpo Masks, and Ikom Monoliths

CONTENT

INTRODUCTION

This week, we conclude our journey through the historical foundations of Nigerian art by exploring **three fascinating and mysterious traditions** that reflect the creativity, spirituality, and cultural identity of different Nigerian peoples.

We will study:

1. The **Esie Soapstone Figures** — mysterious stone sculptures believed to represent ancestors.
2. The **Ekpo Masks of the Ibibio** — dramatic wooden masks symbolizing good and evil.
3. The **Ikom (Alok) Monoliths** — ancient stone carvings used to honour ancestors.

These arts reveal that **Nigerian art is not only ancient but also diverse**, ranging from stone and wood to metal and clay, and serving religious, political, and social purposes.

1. ESIE SOAPSTONE FIGURES (C. 12th Century AD)

Location and Discovery

- Found in **Esie town**, near **Ilorin, Kwara State** (Yoruba area).
- Discovered by local farmers centuries ago and regarded as sacred.
- The **Esie Museum** (the first museum in Nigeria) was built in 1945 to house them.

Material

- Made of **soapstone (steatite)**, a soft stone easy to carve.
- Over **800 sculptures** have been found — the **largest collection of stone sculptures in Africa**.

The Mystery

- The identity of the artists is unknown.

- Local legend says they were a **tribe of people turned into stone** for disobeying a divine order.
- Archaeologists suggest they were used for **religious or ancestral worship**.

Stylistic Features

- Figures are **stylized human forms**, both **male and female**.
- Often shown **seated on stools**, suggesting importance or authority.
- **Detailed hairstyles, necklaces, and ornaments** indicate status and beauty.
- Some have **facial striations (lines)** similar to those seen in **Ifé art**, hinting at cultural connections.
- Calm and dignified expressions reflect a **spiritual or ancestral presence**.

Illustration – Esie Figure

(° 3 °) ← stylized human head with scarification lines
 / | \
 / _ | _ \ ← sitting posture on stool



Visual Reference: *Esie Soapstone Sculpture — Esie Museum, Kwara State.*

Cultural Importance

- Represents **ancestral veneration** in Yoruba culture.
- A reminder of **morality, obedience, and divine power** in oral tradition.
- The Esie figures are **unique in material and mystery**, showing Nigeria's early mastery of stone art.

2. WOOD CARVING – EKPO MASKS (IBIBIO/ANNANG PEOPLE)

Location and Context

- Found among the **Ibibio and Annang** people of **Akwa Ibom and Cross River States**.
- Used by the **Ekpo (Ghost) Secret Society** — a powerful traditional organization responsible for:

- Enforcing laws and discipline,
- Honouring ancestors, and
- Preserving community order.

Material

- Made from **wood**, the most common sculptural medium in Nigeria because of its abundance and versatility.
- Often decorated with **pigments, raffia, feathers, or animal hair**.

Types of Ekpo Masks

Type	Local Name	Meaning/Function	Stylistic Features
Beautiful Mask	<i>Mfon</i>	Represents good spirits, peace, ancestors	Smooth surface, light-coloured, gentle symmetrical features
Fierce/Ugly Mask	<i>Idiok</i>	Represents evil, chaos, punishment, or dangerous spirits	Rough surface, dark-painted, exaggerated features, sometimes with movable jaw

Illustration – Ekpo Mask Types

[Beautiful Mask]

(• ◡ •)

Smooth, calm look

Light tone

Symbol of good

[Fierce Mask]

(益)

Rough, angry expression

Dark tone

Symbol of evil

Visual Reference: *Ekpo Mask, Ibibio – showing detailed carving and dramatic expression.*

Cultural and Social Role

- Used in festivals, funerals, and initiation ceremonies.
- Ekpo masquerades acted as “**living laws**”, punishing offenders and protecting the community.
- Symbolically represents the **balance between good and evil**, and the **connection between the living and the dead**.

3. ALOK (IKOM) MONOLITHS

Location

- Found in **Ikom area** of **Cross River State**, among the **Ejagham (Ekoi)** people.
- Also called the **Alok Monoliths**, after one of the main discovery sites.

Description

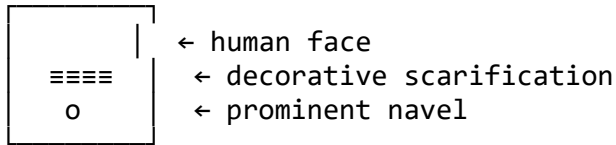
- Over **300 carved stone pillars** made from **basalt (volcanic rock)**.
- Each monolith stands **between 1 and 2 meters high**.
- Arranged in circles, marking **ancestral shrines or graves** of revered elders.

Stylistic Features

- Carved in **low relief**, showing **human faces and torsos**.

- Decorated with **geometric patterns**, representing scarification, hairstyles, or tattoos.
- Most figures have a **prominent navel**, a symbol of **life and ancestry**.
- Some monoliths include **inscriptions or markings**, possibly ancient writing or clan symbols.

Illustration – Ikom Monolith



Visual Reference: *Ikom Monoliths — Cross River State.*

Cultural Significance

- Represent **ancestors and lineage continuity**.
- Serve as **historical records** and **sacred memorials**.
- Reflect early Nigerian skill in **stone carving** and **abstract symbolism**.

COMPARATIVE SUMMARY TABLE

Art Tradition	Location	Material	Main Theme	Distinctive Features
Esie Soapstone	Esie, Kwara State	Soapstone	Mystery & Ancestry	Seated human figures, detailed ornaments, calm expressions
Ekpo Masks (Ibibio)	Akwa Ibom / Cross River	Wood	Social control, morality	Beautiful & fierce masks, moving jaws, dramatic contrasts
Ikom Monoliths	Cross River State	Basalt stone	Ancestral veneration	Stone pillars with faces, geometric designs, prominent navels

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What material are the Esie sculptures made from?
2. What is the “mystery” surrounding the Esie figures?
3. Why is wood carving the most common art form in Nigeria?
4. Explain the difference between the “beautiful” and “fierce” Ekpo masks.
5. What do the Ikom monoliths represent, and what is their cultural purpose?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Draw the two types of Ekpo masks side-by-side — one “beautiful” (*Mfon*) and one “fierce” (*Idiok*). Label each with its meaning.
2. Define the term “**monolith**.”

3. All three art forms studied this week (Esie, Ekpo, Alok) feature **elaborate hairstyles**. What does this reveal about the **cultural importance of hair and beauty** in ancient Nigerian societies?
-

TEACHER'S NOTE (For Visual Aid)

- Bring printed images or slides of:
 - Esie Soapstone Figures (Esie Museum)
 - Ekpo Masks (Ibibio Annang)
 - Ikom Monoliths (Cross River State)
 - Use a map of Nigeria to show their locations.
 - Allow students to model clay or draw replicas of one of the artworks.
-



WEEK 11: MUSEUMS AND ART I

TOPIC:

Museums and Art Galleries – Meaning, Types, Functions, and Importance

CONTENT

INTRODUCTION

After exploring Nigeria’s ancient masterpieces — **Nok terracotta, Ife bronze heads, Benin plaques, Esie soapstone figures, and Ikom monoliths** — the natural question arises:

“Where are these treasures kept today?” “How do we get to see and learn from them?”

The answer lies in **museums and art galleries**. These institutions are like **guardians of our cultural heritage**. They **protect, display, and interpret** artworks and artifacts so that the public can **learn from the past and appreciate creativity**.

Think of a museum as a treasure chest that keeps the memory of a people safe. Think of an art gallery as a living space that celebrates the creativity of today.

1. DEFINITION OF A MUSEUM

Formal Definition

A museum is a **non-profit, permanent institution** that **collects, preserves, researches, and exhibits** objects of artistic, cultural, historical, or scientific importance for **education and enjoyment**.

Simplified Meaning

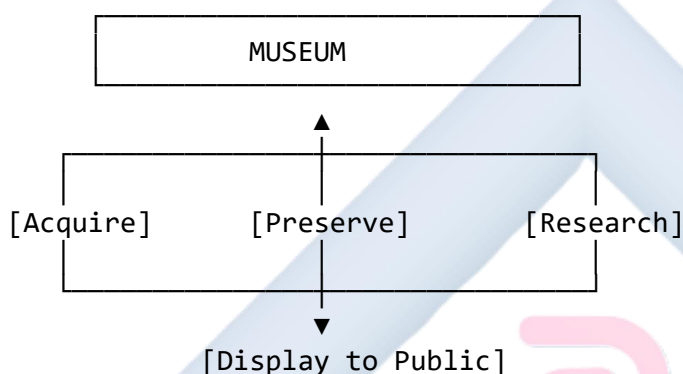
A museum is a **“library of objects.”** It is a **safe home** where a society’s **most valuable treasures** are kept, studied, and displayed for the public.

THE FOUR MAIN FUNCTIONS (“FOUR VERBS”) OF A MUSEUM

Action	Meaning / What It Does	Example
ACQUIRE	Collects or receives valuable objects from	The National Museum collects

Action	Meaning / What It Does	Example
	excavations, donations, or purchases	ancient Nok terracotta figures
PRESERVE	Protects and conserves objects from damage, decay, theft, or loss	Conservators clean and restore ancient bronzes
RESEARCH	Studies and interprets artifacts to understand history and culture	Archaeologists study Esie figures to learn who made them
DISPLAY	Exhibits the objects for public viewing and education	Visitors see Benin bronzes in glass showcases

Illustration – “How a Museum Works”



Visual Example: *National Museum, Lagos – Housing Nigeria’s artistic heritage.*

WHAT MUSEUMS DISPLAY

- Ancient artifacts (e.g., Nok, Ife, Benin sculptures)
- Traditional crafts and costumes
- Paintings, sculptures, and ceremonial objects
- Scientific and archaeological finds
- Historical documents and relics

PURPOSE OF A MUSEUM

- **Education:** Teaches people about their past and the world.
- **Preservation:** Protects fragile heritage for future generations.
- **Inspiration:** Encourages creativity and pride in cultural identity.
- **Research:** Provides a resource for scholars and artists.
- **Tourism:** Attracts visitors and boosts national image.

A museum is where history comes alive.

TYPES OF MUSEUMS

Type	Focus Area	Example (Nigeria)
Art Museum	Paintings, sculptures, visual art	National Gallery of Art, Abuja
Cultural/History Museum	Traditional life, cultural heritage	National Museum, Lagos
Archaeological Museum	Excavated artifacts and relics	Esie Museum, Kwara State
Science & Natural History Museum	Fossils, flora, fauna	Obafemi Awolowo University Museum, Ife

2. DEFINITION OF AN ART GALLERY

Formal Definition

An **art gallery** is a **room or building** where **artworks** such as **paintings, sculptures, drawings, and photographs** are **displayed for public viewing, appreciation, or sale**.

Simplified Meaning

An art gallery is a **showroom of art** — a place where artworks are **exhibited to inspire, educate, or sell**.

TYPES OF ART GALLERIES

1. PUBLIC GALLERY

- Usually part of a **museum** or owned by the **government**.
- Purpose: **Education and preservation**.
- Artworks belong to the gallery (permanent collection).
- Non-profit.
- Example: **National Gallery of Art, Abuja**.

2. COMMERCIAL GALLERY

- Privately owned business (run by art dealers).
- Purpose: **Selling art for profit**.
- Represents living artists and organizes temporary exhibitions.
- Takes a commission (e.g., 40–50%) when artworks are sold.
- Example: **Nike Art Gallery, Lagos** — one of the largest in West Africa.

Key Difference Between Museum and Art Gallery

Feature	Museum	Art Gallery (Commercial)
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Feature	Museum	Art Gallery (Commercial)
Purpose	Preserve and Educate	Sell and Promote Art
Ownership	Public / Non-profit	Private / For-profit
Collection Type	Permanent	Temporary / Rotating
Focus	Historical & Cultural Heritage	Modern / Contemporary Art
Visitors	Scholars, Students, Tourists	Buyers, Collectors, Art Lovers

Illustration – “Museum vs. Gallery”



Visual References:

- **National Museum, Lagos** – Home of the famous *Benin Bronzes*.
- **Nike Art Gallery, Lagos** – Contemporary art showroom.

IMPORTANCE OF MUSEUMS AND GALLERIES

1. **Preservation of Cultural Heritage:** Keeps valuable objects safe from loss or decay.
2. **Education:** Teaches the younger generation about their roots.
3. **Promotion of Art:** Encourages artists and promotes national pride.
4. **Tourism and Economy:** Attracts visitors and generates income.
5. **Cultural Identity:** Helps people connect with their history and traditions.

Without museums and galleries, the story of civilization would fade away.

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS)

1. What are the four main “jobs” or “verbs” of a museum?
2. What is the main purpose of a museum?
3. Define an art gallery.
4. State two differences between a museum and a commercial gallery.
5. Is a commercial gallery “non-profit” or “for-profit”?

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Imagine you own a **500-year-old Ife terracotta head**. Would you take it to a **museum** or a **commercial gallery**? Explain your choice.
 2. Imagine you are a **young artist** with a new painting to sell. Would you go to a museum or a commercial gallery? Why?
 3. Explain why the **preservation function** of museums is essential to Nigeria's history and identity.
-

ADDITIONAL TEACHING AIDS

- **Map of Nigeria** showing locations of major museums (Lagos, Esie, Jos, Benin, Ife).
 - **Photographs** of artifacts displayed in Nigerian museums.
 - **Short video/documentary** on the National Museum, Lagos.
 - **Class Activity:** Students create a "Mini Classroom Museum" by bringing cultural objects (cowries, beads, carvings, local crafts) for exhibition.
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WEEK 12: MUSEUMS AND ART II

TOPIC: HISTORY AND TYPES OF MUSEUMS IN NIGERIA

INTRODUCTION

In the last lesson, we learned that a **museum** is an institution that **acquires, preserves, researches, and displays** objects of cultural, artistic, and scientific value.

This week, we are taking a deeper journey into the **history of museums in Nigeria** — how they started, why they were established, and the **different types of museums** we have today.

Museums are like **time machines** — they allow us to travel into the past through the objects preserved within them. Without museums, many of Nigeria’s ancient artworks like the **Nok Terracottas, Ife Bronzes, and Benin Bronzes** might have been lost forever.

HISTORY OF MUSEUMS IN NIGERIA

1 The Colonial Period and the Problem of Artifact Looting

- During the colonial era (early 1900s), many **European explorers, traders, and administrators** took thousands of Nigeria’s cultural treasures back to Europe.
- Bronze heads, ivory carvings, masks, and terracotta sculptures were shipped abroad, especially after the **Benin Expedition of 1897**, when the **Benin Palace** was raided.
- These artifacts are now displayed in major foreign museums such as:
 - The **British Museum (London)**
 - The **Louvre (Paris)**
 - The **Metropolitan Museum of Art (New York)**

Illustration Idea: A simple diagram showing “Nigeria → Europe” arrows labeled “Benin Bronzes, Ife Heads, Nok Terracottas.”

2 The Pioneer: Kenneth C. Murray

- **Kenneth C. Murray** was a British art teacher and inspector who came to Nigeria in the **1930s**.
- He realized that many ancient artworks were disappearing from Nigeria.
- Murray began collecting and documenting Nigeria’s art to preserve it **within the country**.
- His work led to the creation of the **Nigerian Antiquities Service (NAS)** in **1943**, the first government body responsible for protecting cultural heritage.

Visual Suggestion: A portrait of Kenneth C. Murray with a caption: “Kenneth C. Murray — The father of Nigerian museum culture.”

3 The First Public Museums

- The **first public museum** in Nigeria was established in **Esie, Kwara State** in **1945** to house over **800 soapstone figures** discovered there.
- The **National Museum in Lagos** followed in **1957**, becoming the **central museum of Nigeria**, housing important treasures from **Ife, Nok, Benin**, and **Esie** civilizations.
- Other early museums were later built in **Jos, Benin City, Port Harcourt**, and **Kaduna**.

Illustration:

Map of Nigeria (simplified):

- Lagos 🏛️ National Museum (1957)
 - Esie 🏛️ First Museum (1945)
 - Jos 🏠 Museum of Traditional Architecture
 - Umuahia ✕ War Museum
-

4 The Present-Day Administration

- Today, all national museums are managed by the **National Commission for Museums and Monuments (NCMM)**.
- The NCMM is responsible for:
 - Establishing and maintaining museums and monuments.
 - Preserving Nigeria’s cultural heritage.
 - Conducting research and organizing exhibitions.

Note: The NCMM was established by **Decree No. 77 of 1979** (now an Act of Parliament).

TYPES OF MUSEUMS IN NIGERIA

Museums in Nigeria can be grouped according to the **type of materials** they preserve and the **purpose** they serve.

1 NATIONAL MUSEUMS (ARCHAEOLOGY & ETHNOGRAPHY)

- **Focus:** Preservation of ancient artifacts, cultural relics, and archaeological discoveries.
- **Content:** Sculptures, masks, tools, pottery, royal regalia, and ritual objects.
- **Examples:**

- National Museum, Lagos
- National Museum, Benin City
- National Museum, Jos

Illustration: “Display shelves showing bronze heads, carved masks, ancient tools, and terracotta pottery.”

2 NATURAL HISTORY MUSEUM

- **Focus:** Study and preservation of the natural world — animals, plants, and minerals.
- **Content:**
 - Stuffed animals (Zoological specimens)
 - Dried plants (Herbarium)
 - Rocks, fossils, and minerals (Geology collection)
- **Example:**
 - The **Natural History Museum at Obafemi Awolowo University, Ife.**

Visual Example: “A display case with butterflies, fossils, and mineral rocks labeled ‘Zoology,’ ‘Botany,’ and ‘Geology.’”

3 WAR MUSEUM

- **Focus:** Nigeria’s military and conflict history.
- **Content:** Weapons, vehicles, uniforms, photographs, and documents from past wars.
- **Example:**
 - The **National War Museum, Umuahia (Abia State)** — dedicated to the **Nigerian Civil War (1967–1970)**.
 - It features **Ojukwu’s Bunker, Biafran-made armored cars**, and other historical military relics.

Illustration: “An armored vehicle and Ojukwu’s Bunker labeled: ‘Civil War Artifacts, 1967–1970.’”

4 MUSEUM OF NIGERIAN TRADITIONAL ARCHITECTURE (MOTNA)

- **Focus:** Preservation of traditional architectural forms.
- **Type:** “Open-air” museum — visitors walk through life-size reconstructions of historic Nigerian buildings.
- **Content:**

- Hausa-Fulani huts and city walls.
- Tiv compounds.
- Igbo Mbari houses.
- Benin chiefs' houses.
- **Example:** Located in **Jos**, Plateau State.

Illustration: “Diagram showing traditional Nigerian architecture — round huts with thatched roofs, Mbari house murals, and mud walls.”

IMPORTANCE OF MUSEUMS TO NIGERIA

1. **Cultural Preservation:** Protects our past and prevents cultural extinction.
2. **Education:** Teaches students and the public about history, art, and science.
3. **Tourism:** Attracts visitors and boosts the economy.
4. **National Identity:** Helps citizens connect with their heritage.
5. **Research:** Provides materials for archaeologists, historians, and artists.

Visual Idea: “Pyramid chart showing five layers labeled: Preservation → Education → Tourism → Identity → Research.”

EVALUATION (IN-CLASS QUESTIONS)

1. Who was **Kenneth C. Murray**, and why is he important in Nigerian museum history?
2. Where was the **first public museum** in Nigeria established, and what was its purpose?
3. What does **NCMM** stand for, and what are its responsibilities?
4. Differentiate between a **National Museum** and a **Natural History Museum**.
5. Mention two artifacts you might find in the **War Museum** at Umuahia.

ASSIGNMENT (TAKE-HOME)

1. Describe the **Museum of Nigerian Traditional Architecture (MOTNA)** and explain why it is called an “open-air museum.”
2. **Practical Activity:** Using clay or cardboard, build a **miniature model** of a traditional Nigerian house (round hut, Mbari house, or Tiv compound).
3. Write a short paragraph explaining **why museums are important** to a country’s culture and education.

TEACHER’S NOTE / ILLUSTRATIVE DISPLAY IDEAS

- Use photographs or posters of:
 - Esie soapstone figures
 - Benin bronze heads

- Ife bronze masks
 - Ojukwu's bunker
 - Jos MOTNA huts
 - Draw or project a **timeline** showing "1943 → 1945 → 1957 → Present (NCMM)."
 - Encourage a **museum visit** (physical or virtual) using the NCMM's online resources.
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